

Read this before using the recipes.

This is a patient-created culinary working edition, not medical advice, a treatment, or a substitute for your nephrologist or renal dietitian. CKD stage, dialysis modality, residual kidney function, medications, labs, diabetes, fluid limits, and individual targets vary. Nutrition figures in this book are recipe estimates, not personal limits; brands, substitutions, preparation, and serving size can change them. Check labels and review ingredients, portions, supplements, herbs, and unfamiliar products with your care team. Feedback a dietitian gave the creator on his personal food-rule sheet helped inform this caution-first revision; it was not a formal product review, endorsement, clinical certification, or validation of every recipe.

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RENALWISE

Digital MasterCook Book

CKD Kitchen Freeware Edition v09

200+ Recipes · 33 Chapters · 2 Appendices

FREE SEARCHABLE BROWSER EDITION + PRINTABLE PDF

“Eat like you love food and life whether your kidneys work or not.”

NorthStar Prime · 2026

33 Chapters · 2 Appendices

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Pull up a chair.

Stay awhile.

Introduction & Dedication

Dedication

For everyone who was told "you can't eat that anymore."
And made it anyway.

"One cannot think well, love well, sleep well, if one has not dined well."
— Virginia Woolf

Introduction

This is a cookbook for people whose kidneys don't work.

That sentence should make you sad, and it does, for about three seconds, and then you turn the page and there's a recipe for Taco Bell's \$7 Luxe Box that has 65% less sodium than the drive-thru version and tastes 95% identical, and sadness becomes a luxury you can't afford because you're too busy making chalupa shells from scratch.

"The only time to eat diet food is while waiting for the steak to cook." — Julia Child

You are handed a laminated sheet at the clinic. The sheet says NO. No potassium. No phosphorus. No sodium. No fun. The sheet is medically accurate and spiritually catastrophic. It tells you what you can't have. It never tells you what you *can*.

This book tells you what you can.

"Cooking is like love. It should be entered into with abandon or not at all." — Harriet Van Horne

200+ recipes. Thai street food. Taco Bell dupes. Mango sticky rice. Country fried steak with white gravy. Hot sauces with names that would make your doctor blush. Smoothies that taste like a Caribbean vacation. Gummies that glow in the dark. A Persian ketchup from a food cart in Cornelius, Oregon, that changed everything.

All of it CKD-aware, with portions and labs doing the real safety work. All of it actually good. All of it made by someone who decided the kitchen doesn't quit.

"Tell me what you eat, and I will tell you what you are." — Jean Anthelme Brillat-Savarin

I am steak tacos with fresh pico at midnight. I am chocolate Rice Krispie treats at 2am. I am Tom Kha Gai with too much lime. I am my mother's radiatore pasta salad with white wine vinegar, and I will be that salad until I die, and then I will be the memory of that salad, which is the same thing, because food is memory and memory is food and both are love.

"People who love to eat are always the best people." — Julia Child

A Note on How to Use This Book

"Perfection is achieved, not when there is nothing more to add, but when there is nothing left to take away." — Antoine de Saint-Exupery

This is the working edition. Recipes only. No essays. No equipment lists. No CKD nutrition lectures. Just ingredients, methods, and results.

The full version — with nutrition data per serving, equipment recommendations, ingredient sourcing, clinical notes, and philosophical tangents about consciousness — lives online at northstarprime.com/ckd-kitchen.

This version is for the kitchen counter. It gets flour on it. That's what it's for.

The Emoji Soup Restaurant Menu

(translated from the original trilingual symbolic notation)

The menu predates the restaurant. The restaurant predates the building. The building predates the city. All of this is somehow the fault of a filing error in the Multnomah County Department of Records.

"Item one: a soup. Price: nothing. Description: everything." — The Archaeological Record, Southeast Hawthorne Boulevard, 1987

The Six Languages of the Menu

The original menu is not written in one language. It is written in six: glyph, name, kitchen action, hunger, price, and law. The glyph tells the eye what the dish is. The name gives the mouth something to say. The action tells the cook what must happen. The hunger tells the soul why it came. The price tells the customer what will be exchanged. The law tells everyone what the dish refuses to lie about.

Glyph	Name	Action	Need	Price	Law
	The Bread	tear/rest	first gift	notice	arrives before permission
	The Soup	simmer/wait	origin	nothing	contains everything but explains nothing
	Mango Rice Dream Pop	cook/blend/freeze	soft sweetness	patience	rice must become porridge before it becomes memory
	Mango Habanero Afterfire	ferment/finish	courage with fruit	gloves	fresh fruit comes after the fire learns manners
	The Check	total/return	consequence	exact change	the bill is always itemized, never unfair

Second Menu Board

This menu now reads as a working grammar for the novels, the cookbook, and the sauce lab. A glyph can foreshadow a chapter. A sauce label can become a waiver. A receipt can become the kindest possible accusation.

Glyph	Name	Action	Need	Price	L
	Mercy Butter	soften/spread	ease	one lowered defense	merc melt argu with
	Permit Pickles	brine/file	permission	one honest form	sour becc offici whei with
	Bob's Mushroom Theorem	saute/prove	generosity	one shared plate	the r is nc optic
	The Courier's Spoon	carry/return	direction	fuel and humility	ever deliv deliv the c
	Black Orchard Adobo	char/blend/log	courage in shadow	gloves and honesty	smo mus hide fruit
	Gold Pheasant Peach	gleam/blend/warn	good fortune with teeth	respect	ausg does mea
	Pineapple Thai Basil Lightning	chop/flash/cool	sudden courage	today	light not lefto
	Floccinaucinihilipilification Pudding	set/reflect	worth	one admitted value	the ram price

Appetizers for the Apocalypse

- **The Bread** — Arrives before you order. Warm. Endless. Do not question the bread. The bread is correct.
- **The Bisque** — What it's a bisque OF depends on who's asking and whether they're ready for the answer.
- **Breadsticks of Diminished Fear** — The largest things are always drawn smallest by people who are afraid of them.

Entrees That Remember You

- **The Soup** — There is only one soup. It contains everything. It has always contained everything. You've been eating it your whole life. You just didn't know it had a name.
- **Bob's Mushroom Theorem** — A dish that proves, mathematically, that generosity is the only rational economic strategy. Served with rice. The rice is optional. The proof is not.
- **The Thing You Came Here For** — You don't order this. It orders you. It arrives when you're ready. You are never ready. It arrives anyway.

Desserts That Eat You

- **The Tea of Enlightenment** — Tastes like whatever you need it to taste like. Served at exactly the temperature that makes you tell the truth.
- **Floccinaucinihilipilification Pudding** — The act of estimating something as worthless, served in a ramekin. The pudding is worthless. The ramekin is priceless. The joke is on you. The joke is also the pudding.

The Check

The check never arrives. The meal is free. You pay by remembering what it tasted like and telling someone. This is the only currency the restaurant accepts. This is also how love works, and language, and music, and every other thing that matters.

"There is no sincerer love than the love of food." — George Bernard Shaw

A Few Words Before We Cook

"The secret of success in life is to eat what you like and let the food fight it out inside." — Mark Twain

Medical safety note: This cookbook is a planning aid, not medical advice. Use your prescribed sodium, potassium, phosphorus, protein, and fluid limits; confirm recipes with your nephrologist or renal dietitian, especially if you are on dialysis, using binders, managing diabetes, immunocompromised, pregnant, or taking transplant medications.

Label check: Nutrition estimates are working estimates. Packaged foods, salt substitutes, potassium chloride, phosphate additives, sauces, broths, and restaurant dupes can change the renal math quickly. Check labels and use the limits from your care team.

Evidence language: In this edition, "CKD-aware" means a recipe is built around lower sodium/potassium/phosphorus assumptions as portioned; it does not mean universally safe. National Kidney Foundation guidance emphasizes that sodium, potassium, phosphorus, protein, and fluid targets vary by labs, dialysis status, medications, and care-team instructions. Source: <https://www.kidney.org/kidney-topics/nutrition-and-kidney-disease-stages-1-5-not-dialysis>

But also: make the gumbo. Fry the chicken. Bake the carrot cake. Pour the white gravy over the country fried steak. Squeeze the lime into the Tom Kha. Coat the gummies in nuclear sour dust and eat three before bed.

"Life is uncertain. Eat dessert first." — Ernestine Ulmer

The restrictions are in the *ingredients*, not the *recipes*. Margarine instead of butter. Almond milk instead of whole. Leach the potatoes. Rinse the beans three times. Use the no-salt seasoning. Skip the olives.

Same plate. Same flavor. Same Saturday morning breakfast. Different margarine. Your kidneys can't tell the difference. Your taste buds can't either.

"After a good dinner, one can forgive anybody, even one's own relatives." — Oscar Wilde

Now wash your hands. Put on some music. Open this book to whatever page you land on.

Cook like you love food and life whether your kidneys work or not. Because you do.

"All sorrows are less with bread." — Miguel de Cervantes

Andrew D White Jr. Portland, Oregon 2026
988 — You are not alone. 988 + 11 = 999; 999 is symbolic hope, not a crisis number.

CHAPTER 1

Breakfast Classics

"The waffle iron was patented by Cornelius Swartwout on August 24, 1869."

French Toast, Waffles, Pancakes & More — Morning Done Right

"The waffle iron was patented by Cornelius Swartwout on August 24, 1869."

"All happiness depends on a leisurely breakfast." — John Gunther

Breakfast Intelligence

Before you cook a single thing, internalize these:

Principle	Why It Matters
Eggs are king	High biological value protein, moderate P (~95mg/egg), low Na (~70mg/egg). Two eggs is one example serving; whether it fits depends on the rest of your day and your individualized targets.
White bread > whole wheat	Whole wheat = higher P (phosphorus bound to phytates) and higher K. Brioche, white flour, sourdough — all better choices.
Phosphorus-free baking powder	Rumford aluminum-free. Regular baking powder is loaded with sodium aluminum phosphate. This applies to ALL baked items in this chapter.
K-leach every potato	Hash browns MUST soak 4+ hours in cold water, drain, rinse, squeeze. Removes 40-50% of potassium. Non-negotiable.

Principle	Why It Matters
Turkey sausage > pork sausage	Lower phosphorus, lower sodium per serving. Read labels — some turkey sausage is still injected with sodium phosphate. Buy CLEAN.
Maple syrup is safe	Basically sugar + water + trace minerals. Low K (~40mg/tbsp), low P (~3mg/tbsp), low Na (~2mg/tbsp). Drizzle without guilt.
Cream cheese > butter for frosting	Lower P per tablespoon, better mouthfeel, and it's what cinnamon rolls demand anyway.
Almond milk replaces dairy	Unsweetened almond milk: ~5mg P per cup vs whole milk: ~230mg P per cup. Massive difference.

1. Golden Sunday French Toast

"French toast first appears in the Apicius, a Roman cookbook from the 4th or 5th century AD, where it was called 'Pan Dulcis' — bread soaked in milk and egg, then fried."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Brioche or thick-cut white bread	6 slices (3/4" thick)	NOT whole wheat — brioche is lower P and makes better French toast anyway
Eggs	2 large	~190mg P total for the whole batch, split across servings
Unsweetened almond milk	1/3 cup	Replaces whole milk — ~2mg P vs 75mg
Vanilla extract	1 tsp	
Ground cinnamon	1 tsp	
Nutmeg	1/4 tsp (fresh grated ideal)	
Sugar	1 tbsp	In the custard for caramelization
Salt	Pinch	
Margarine	2 tbsp (for pan)	Lower P than butter

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Pure maple syrup	For serving	CKD-aware — low K/P/Na
Powdered sugar	For dusting (optional)	
Fresh berries	For topping	Strawberries and blueberries are lower-K fruits

Method: 1. Whisk eggs, almond milk, vanilla, cinnamon, nutmeg, sugar, and salt in a wide shallow bowl until uniform. 2. Heat a large skillet or griddle over medium heat. Melt 1 tbsp margarine and swirl to coat. 3. Dip each bread slice into the custard — 15 seconds per side. Let excess drip off. You want saturated, not dripping. 4. Cook 2-3 min per side until deep golden brown and slightly crispy on the edges. The sugars in brioche caramelize beautifully. 5. Add more margarine between batches. Keep finished slices warm on a sheet pan in a 200F oven. 6. Serve stacked, dusted with powdered sugar, drizzled with maple syrup, berries alongside.

Per serving (2 slices + 2 tbsp syrup): ~120mg Na | ~105mg P | ~130mg K

2. Iron-Crisp Waffles

"The first known waffle recipe printed in English appeared in a 1725 London cookbook by Robert Smith, calling for a pint of cream, seven eggs, and a pound of butter."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
All-purpose flour	2 cups	White flour only — lower P than whole wheat
Phosphorus-free baking powder (Rumford)	1 tbsp	CRITICAL — regular baking powder adds ~350mg P per batch
Baking soda	1/2 tsp	
Sugar	2 tbsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Eggs	2 large, separated	Whites whipped = the secret to crispy exterior/fluffy interior
Unsweetened almond milk	1.5 cups	
Avocado oil	1/3 cup	Neutral flavor, high smoke point
Vanilla extract	1 tsp	
White vinegar	1 tbsp	Added to almond milk = "buttermilk" tang, activates baking soda

Method: 1. Add vinegar to almond milk, stir, let sit 5 min (it curdles slightly — that's correct). 2. Whisk flour, baking powder, baking soda, sugar, salt in a large bowl. 3. In a separate bowl, whisk egg yolks, almond milk mixture, oil, vanilla. 4. In a third bowl (or stand mixer), beat egg whites to stiff peaks. This is the move that separates diner waffles from restaurant waffles. 5. Pour wet into dry, stir until JUST combined — lumps are fine, overworking = tough waffles. 6. Fold in whipped egg whites gently. The batter should look like a cloud with flour in it. 7. Preheat waffle iron to medium-high. Lightly oil or spray. Pour batter to fill 2/3 of the iron surface. 8. Cook until steam stops and waffle is deep golden (3-5 min depending on iron). DO NOT open early — you'll tear it. 9. Serve immediately or keep crispy on a wire rack in a 200F oven. Never stack fresh waffles (steam = soggy).

Makes: 4-6 waffles depending on iron size

Per waffle: ~110mg Na | ~95mg P | ~90mg K

3. Cloud-Stack Pancakes

"Otzi the Iceman, the 5,300-year-old mummy found in the Alps in 1991, had traces of ground einkorn wheat in his stomach — possibly the oldest evidence of something resembling a pancake."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
All-purpose flour	1.5 cups	White flour — lower P
Phosphorus-free baking powder (Rumford)	2 tsp	
Baking soda	1/2 tsp	
Sugar	2 tbsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Egg	1 large	

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Unsweetened almond milk	1.25 cups	
White vinegar	1 tbsp	"Buttermilk" conversion
Avocado oil	2 tbsp	In the batter for tender crumb
Vanilla extract	1 tsp	

Berry Compote:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Mixed berries (strawberries + blueberries)	2 cups (fresh or frozen)	Lower-K fruit choices
Sugar	2 tbsp	
Lemon juice	1 tbsp	
Water	2 tbsp	

Method — Pancakes: 1. Add vinegar to almond milk, stir, let sit 5 min. 2. Whisk flour, baking powder, baking soda, sugar, salt in a large bowl. 3. Whisk egg, almond milk mixture, oil, vanilla in a separate bowl. 4. Pour wet into dry. Stir until JUST combined — 10-15 strokes max. The batter should be lumpy. Walk away from it. Overmixed pancakes are rubber discs. 5. Let batter rest 5 min (baking powder activates, bubbles form = fluffier pancakes). 6. Heat griddle or skillet to medium (325F). Lightly oil. 7. Pour 1/4 cup batter per pancake. Wait until bubbles form on the surface AND the edges look set (2-3 min), then flip once. Cook 1-2 min more. 8. One flip only. Every extra flip compresses the pancake. Patience.

Method — Berry Compote: 1. Combine berries, sugar, lemon juice, water in a small saucepan over medium heat. 2. Bring to a simmer, stirring occasionally. Mash some berries with a fork for texture. 3. Cook 8-10 min until syrupy but still chunky. Serve warm over pancakes.

Per serving (3 pancakes + 3 tbsp compote): ~140mg Na | ~90mg P | ~150mg K

4. Soft Landing Eggs Benedict

"Eggs Benedict was allegedly invented in 1894 at the Waldorf Hotel in New York City when a Wall Street broker named Lemuel Benedict ordered 'buttered toast, poached eggs, crisp bacon, and a hooker of hollandaise' to settle his hangover."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
English muffins	2, split and toasted	White flour English muffins — check label, some brands add calcium phosphate
Eggs	4 large (2 for poaching, 2 yolks for hollandaise)	~380mg P total across 4 eggs, split into 2 servings
Turkey bacon or Canadian bacon	4 slices	Turkey bacon preferred — lower Na/P than traditional Canadian bacon
White vinegar	1 tbsp (for poaching water)	
Fresh chives	For garnish	
Paprika	Pinch, for garnish	

CKD Hollandaise:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Egg yolks	2 large	
Margarine	1/2 cup (1 stick), melted and hot	Lower P than butter
Lemon juice	1 tbsp	Fresh — bottled has additives
Cayenne pepper	Pinch	
Salt	1/8 tsp	Traditional hollandaise uses 1/2 tsp+ — this is plenty with the lemon
Water	1 tbsp (warm)	To adjust consistency

Method — Hollandaise (make first, keep warm): 1. Whisk egg yolks + lemon juice in a heatproof bowl over a pot of barely simmering water (double boiler). Whisk constantly until yolks thicken and lighten in color (2-3 min). The bowl should NEVER touch the water. 2. Remove from heat. Slowly drizzle in hot melted margarine while whisking vigorously — a thin

steady stream. It will emulsify into a creamy sauce. 3. Add cayenne, salt, warm water to adjust consistency. It should coat the back of a spoon. 4. Keep warm by leaving the bowl over the pot (heat OFF). Stir occasionally.

Method — Assembly: 1. Heat turkey bacon in a skillet until crispy. Set aside. 2. Bring a wide pot of water to a gentle simmer (NOT a rolling boil — turbulence shreds the whites). Add vinegar. 3. Crack each egg into a small cup. Create a gentle whirlpool with a spoon, then slide the egg into the center. Poach 3-4 min for runny yolk. 4. Remove with a slotted spoon, drain on a paper towel. 5. Toast English muffin halves. Layer: muffin → bacon → poached egg → hollandaise → chives + paprika.

Per serving (2 halves): ~280mg Na | ~230mg P | ~200mg K

5. Sunrise Wrap Burrito

"The breakfast burrito as we know it was popularized in the 1970s in New Mexico, with Tia Sophia's restaurant in Santa Fe often credited as the first to put a complete breakfast inside a flour tortilla."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Low-sodium flour tortillas (10")	2 large	Look for <300mg Na per tortilla — Mission has a low-sodium line
Eggs	4 large, scrambled	
Turkey breakfast sausage	4 oz (2 patties), crumbled	Read label — no sodium phosphate
Bell pepper (red or green)	1/2 cup, diced	Red peppers slightly higher K than green, but both fine in this quantity
White onion	1/4 cup, diced	
Sharp cheddar cheese	1/4 cup, shredded	
Avocado oil	1 tbsp	
Garlic powder	1/4 tsp	
Cumin	1/4 tsp	
Paprika	1/4 tsp	
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	
Salt	Pinch	The sausage and cheese carry enough salt
Hot sauce	To taste	

Optional toppings:

Topping	CKD Notes
Sour cream (1 tbsp)	Lower P than extra cheese
Pico de gallo (2 tbsp)	Moderate K from tomato — small portion OK
Salsa verde	Often lower Na than red salsa — check label

Method: 1. Brown crumbled turkey sausage in a skillet over medium heat until cooked through. Remove, set aside. 2. In the same skillet, add oil. Saute bell pepper and onion until soft (3-4 min). Add garlic powder, cumin, paprika, pepper. 3. Push veggies to one side. Add beaten eggs to the other side. Scramble on medium-low, stirring gently — large soft curds, not rubber. Pull off heat when eggs are STILL slightly wet (carryover cooking finishes them). 4. Mix eggs, sausage, and veggies together. Add cheese while hot so it melts in. 5. Warm tortillas in a dry skillet 15 seconds per side (or 10 seconds in microwave under a damp paper towel). 6. Load filling down the center, fold sides in, then roll from the bottom. Tight but not bursting. 7. Optional: sear the seam side down in a dry skillet for 30 seconds for a crispy seal.

Per burrito: ~350mg Na | ~220mg P | ~280mg K

6. Sunday Gravy Biscuits

"Biscuits and gravy became a staple of the American South during the Revolutionary War era, when wheat flour biscuits served with gravy made from pan drippings provided a cheap, calorie-dense meal for laborers and soldiers."

Flaky CKD Biscuits:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
All-purpose flour	2 cups	White flour — lower P

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Phosphorus-free baking powder (Rumford)	1 tbsp	The single most important swap in CKD baking
Sugar	1 tsp	
Salt	1/2 tsp	
Cold margarine, cubed	1/3 cup	Keep COLD — visible margarine chunks = flaky layers
Unsweetened almond milk	3/4 cup, cold	

Turkey Sausage Gravy:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Turkey breakfast sausage	8 oz	No sodium phosphate on the label
Margarine	2 tbsp	
All-purpose flour	3 tbsp	The roux — equal parts fat and flour
Unsweetened almond milk	2 cups	Whole milk would add ~460mg P. Almond milk adds ~10mg.
Black pepper	1 tsp (generous)	Pepper IS the seasoning in gravy — don't be timid
Garlic powder	1/4 tsp	
Onion powder	1/4 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	The sausage has salt already
Dried sage	1/4 tsp	Optional but traditional

Method — Biscuits: 1. Whisk flour, baking powder, sugar, salt in a large bowl. 2. Add cold cubed margarine. Cut in with a pastry cutter (or two knives, or your hands — fast) until mixture resembles coarse crumbs with pea-sized margarine pieces. Those chunks become flaky layers. 3. Add cold almond milk. Stir with a fork until JUST combined. The dough should be shaggy, not smooth. 4. Turn onto a floured surface. Pat (don't roll) to 1" thick. Fold in half, pat again. Repeat 3 times. This lamination creates layers. 5. Pat to final 1" thickness. Cut with a 2.5" biscuit cutter (or a glass). Press straight down — don't twist (twisting seals the edges and kills the rise). 6. Place on a parchment-lined baking sheet with biscuits touching (they help each other rise). Brush tops with almond milk. 7. Bake at 425F for 12-15 min until golden on top. Let rest 5 min.

Method — Gravy: 1. Brown turkey sausage in a skillet over medium heat, breaking into small crumbles (5-6 min). If the sausage is very lean, add the margarine now to compensate for missing fat. 2. Add margarine to the pan (if not already added). Once melted, sprinkle flour over the sausage. Stir and cook 1-2 min — this is the roux, it should smell nutty, not raw. 3. Slowly pour in almond milk, whisking constantly. The gravy will look thin — keep whisking. It thickens as it simmers (3-5 min). 4. Add pepper (generous), garlic powder, onion powder, sage, salt. Taste and adjust. Good sausage gravy should be peppery. 5. Split biscuits, ladle gravy over both halves. Eat immediately.

Per serving (2 biscuits + 1/2 cup gravy): ~320mg Na | ~170mg P | ~190mg K

7. Kanel Morning Rolls

"The kanelbulle, Sweden's cinnamon roll, is so culturally important that October 4th is officially 'Kanelbullens Dag' (Cinnamon Roll Day) — a national holiday since 1999."

Dough:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
All-purpose flour	3.5 cups	White flour — lower P
Unsweetened almond milk	1 cup, warmed to 110F	
Active dry yeast	2.25 tsp (1 packet)	
Sugar	1/4 cup	Feeds the yeast and sweetens the dough
Egg	1 large	
Margarine	1/4 cup, melted	
Salt	1/2 tsp	

Filling:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Margarine	1/4 cup, softened	Spread on rolled dough
Brown sugar	1/2 cup, packed	
Ground cinnamon	1.5 tbsp	

Cream Cheese Frosting:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Cream cheese	4 oz, softened	Lower P than butter-based frosting
Powdered sugar	1 cup	
Vanilla extract	1 tsp	
Unsweetened almond milk	1-2 tbsp	To adjust drizzle consistency

Method — Dough: 1. Warm almond milk to 110F (not hotter — you'll kill the yeast). Stir in yeast + 1 tsp of the sugar. Let sit 5-10 min until foamy. If it doesn't foam, your yeast is dead — get new yeast. 2. In a large bowl (or stand mixer with dough hook), combine flour, remaining sugar, salt. 3. Add yeast mixture, egg, melted margarine. Mix until a soft dough forms. 4. Knead 8-10 min (by hand) or 5 min (dough hook on medium) until smooth and elastic. The dough should spring back when poked. 5. Place in an oiled bowl, cover with plastic wrap or damp towel. Let rise in a warm spot 1-1.5 hours until doubled.

Method — Assembly: 1. Punch down dough. Roll out on a floured surface to a 16x12" rectangle. 2. Spread softened margarine evenly over the entire surface. 3. Mix brown sugar + cinnamon. Sprinkle evenly over the margarine. Press gently so it sticks. 4. Roll up tightly from the long side (you want a 16" log). Pinch the seam. 5. Cut into 12 equal rolls. Dental floss or unflavored thread works better than a knife (slide under the log, cross the ends, pull to cut — clean slices). 6. Place in a greased 9x13 baking pan, cut side up. Cover and let rise 30-45 min until puffy and touching. 7. Bake at 350F for 22-28 min until golden on top. Center rolls should be set but still soft. 8. Let cool 10 min (not longer — they need to be warm for the frosting).

Method — Frosting: 1. Beat cream cheese until smooth. Add powdered sugar and vanilla. Beat until fluffy. 2. Add almond milk 1 tbsp at a time until you reach a thick but pourable consistency. 3. Spread or drizzle over warm cinnamon rolls. The warmth melts it slightly — that's the point.

Makes: 12 rolls

Per roll: ~190mg Na | ~80mg P | ~85mg K

8. Dawn Patrol Breakfast Sandwich

"The Egg McMuffin was invented by Herb Peterson, a McDonald's franchise owner in Santa Barbara, California, in 1972 — he was trying to create a fast-food version of Eggs Benedict."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
White English muffin	1, split and toasted	Check label — avoid brands with calcium phosphate
Egg	1 large	
Turkey breakfast sausage	1 patty (2 oz)	Or turkey bacon (2 slices)
American cheese	1 slice	Yes, processed — but 1 slice is ~260mg Na, which fits the budget. The meltability matters here.
Margarine	1 tsp (for egg ring)	
Salt	Tiny pinch	
Black pepper	To taste	

Method: 1. Form turkey sausage into a thin patty roughly the diameter of the English muffin. Season with pepper, a tiny bit of garlic powder. Cook in a skillet over medium heat — 3 min per side until cooked through and slightly crispy. Set aside. 2. **The egg ring trick:** Use a metal ring mold (or a clean tuna can with both ends removed) in the same skillet. Grease with margarine. Crack egg into the ring. Pierce the yolk gently with a fork (this is a fast food dupe — flat egg, not a fried egg). Season with salt and pepper. Cook 2 min, flip the ring with the egg in it, cook 1 more min. 3. Toast English muffin halves in the toaster or face-down in a dry skillet. 4. Build: bottom muffin → sausage patty → cheese slice (place on hot sausage so it melts) → egg → top muffin. 5. Wrap in foil or parchment for

1 min. The steam inside melds everything together. This is the step that separates homemade from sad.

Per sandwich: ~380mg Na | ~200mg P | ~170mg K

Compared to McDonald's Egg McMuffin: ~820mg Na, ~300mg P. You just cut sodium in half.

9. Crispy Skillet Hash Browns

"The term 'hash brown' first appeared in print in 1888 in a menu from Dayton, Ohio, described as 'hashed brown potatoes' — referring to the technique of hashing (chopping) and browning."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Russet potatoes	2 large (~1 lb)	MUST BE K-LEACHED — see step 1
Avocado oil	3 tbsp	For crispy pan-fry
Salt	1/4 tsp	After leaching, these need some seasoning back
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	
Onion powder	1/4 tsp	
Garlic powder	1/4 tsp	Optional

Method: 1. **K-LEACH (NON-NEGOTIABLE):** Peel and shred potatoes using a box grater or food processor shredding disc. Place shredded potatoes in a large bowl of cold water. Soak for **minimum 4 hours** — overnight is better. Change the water at least once halfway through. This removes 40-50% of the potassium. Drain, rinse under cold water, then squeeze dry in a clean kitchen towel or cheesecloth. Squeeze **HARD** — the drier they are, the crispier they get. Moisture is the enemy of crunch. 2. Toss the squeezed-dry shreds with salt, pepper, onion powder, garlic powder. 3. Heat avocado oil in a large cast iron or non-stick skillet over medium-high heat. The oil should shimmer. 4. Spread the potatoes in an even thin layer. Press down with a spatula. **DO NOT TOUCH THEM** for 5-6 min. Let the bottom crust form undisturbed. 5. When the bottom is deep golden (lift a corner to check), flip in sections. Press down again. Cook another 4-5 min. 6. The edges should be lacy and shatteringly crispy. The center should be tender. If your hash browns are pale and floppy, your oil wasn't hot enough or your potatoes were too wet.

Per serving (1/2 the batch): ~120mg Na | ~55mg P | ~250mg K (*without leaching this would be ~450mg K — leaching is critical*)

10. Garden Fold Omelette Bar

"The word 'omelette' derives from the French 'alumelle,' meaning thin blade — a reference to the flat shape of the egg dish, which first appeared in French cookbooks in the 1600s."

Base (same for all three):

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Eggs	3 large	~285mg P, ~210mg Na for 3 eggs
Unsweetened almond milk	1 tbsp	Makes eggs silkier
Salt	Pinch	
Black pepper	To taste	
Margarine	1 tbsp (for pan)	

Method (The French Technique — works for all three): 1. Whisk eggs, almond milk, salt, pepper until uniform — no streaks of white. 2. Heat an 8-10" non-stick skillet over medium heat. Add margarine, swirl to coat. 3. Pour in egg mixture. Let it set for 30 seconds without touching. 4. Using a silicone spatula, gently push the edges toward the center while tilting the pan to let raw egg flow to the edges. Repeat around the pan. 5. When the top is **STILL** slightly wet (it finishes cooking from residual heat), add filling to one half. 6. Fold the other half over. Slide onto plate. The inside should be barely set, not dry.

Filling Combo 1: The Western

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Diced ham (low-sodium)	2 tbsp	Use low-sodium deli ham — regular ham is a Na bomb
Bell pepper, diced	2 tbsp	

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
White onion, diced	2 tbsp	
Sharp cheddar, shredded	2 tbsp	

Saute ham, pepper, onion in a separate pan first (2 min). Add to omelette.

Per omelette: ~310mg Na | ~290mg P | ~250mg K

Filling Combo 2: The Mediterranean

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Fresh spinach	Small handful (1/4 cup)	Wilted — raw spinach is HIGH K, but a small wilted amount is acceptable
Sun-dried tomatoes (not in oil)	2 pieces, chopped	Small portion — concentrated K, keep it minimal
Feta cheese, crumbled	1 tbsp	Salty — 1 tbsp keeps Na in check
Fresh basil	3-4 leaves, torn	

Wilt spinach in the pan before adding eggs, or add raw and let the omelette's heat wilt it.

Per omelette: ~290mg Na | ~280mg P | ~270mg K

Filling Combo 3: The Garden

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
White mushrooms, sliced	3-4 mushrooms	Lower K than portobello
Zucchini, diced small	2 tbsp	Low K vegetable
Red bell pepper, diced	2 tbsp	
Fresh herbs (chives, parsley)	1 tbsp, chopped	
Swiss cheese	1 slice, torn	

Saute veggies 3-4 min until tender before adding to omelette.

Per omelette: ~270mg Na | ~275mg P | ~280mg K

11. Candlemas Crepes

"The tradition of eating crepes on Candlemas (February 2) in France dates back to the 5th century, when Pope Gelasius I distributed crepes to pilgrims arriving in Rome — the round golden shape symbolized the sun and the approaching spring."

Crepe Batter:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
All-purpose flour	1 cup	White flour
Eggs	2 large	
Unsweetened almond milk	1.25 cups	
Water	1/4 cup	Thins the batter — crepes need to be thin
Avocado oil	2 tbsp	In the batter for non-stick and tender crepes
Sugar	1 tbsp	For sweet crepes. Omit for savory.
Salt	Pinch	
Vanilla extract	1 tsp	For sweet crepes. Omit for savory.

Method: 1. Blend ALL batter ingredients in a blender for 15 seconds. Scrape sides, blend 5 more seconds. (You can whisk by hand, but blender = perfectly smooth batter.) 2. Refrigerate batter 30 min minimum (1 hour ideal). This lets the gluten relax — no rubbery crepes. 3. Heat an 8-10" non-stick skillet over medium heat. Lightly oil with a paper towel dipped in avocado oil. 4. Pour ~3 tbsp batter into the center, then IMMEDIATELY tilt and swirl the pan in a circle to spread the batter into a thin even layer. Speed matters — you have about 3 seconds before it sets. 5. Cook 1-2 min until the edges lift and the bottom is light golden with brown lace spots. 6. Flip with a thin spatula (or your fingers if you're brave). Cook 30 seconds more. 7. Stack finished crepes with parchment between them to prevent sticking. They'll stay pliable.

Makes: 10-12 crepes

Sweet Fillings:

Strawberry Cream Cheese:

Filling	Amount
Cream cheese, softened	2 oz
Powdered sugar	2 tbsp
Fresh strawberries, sliced	1/2 cup
Maple syrup drizzle	1 tbsp

Spread cream cheese mixture on crepe, layer strawberries, fold into quarters, drizzle syrup.

Cinnamon Sugar: Margarine + cinnamon + sugar. The Parisian street-cart classic.

Savory Fillings:

Ham & Cheese:

Filling	Amount
Low-sodium deli ham	2 slices
Swiss cheese	1 slice
Dijon mustard	1/2 tsp

Layer ham and cheese on crepe, fold into quarters, heat in pan until cheese melts.

Egg & Veggie: Scrambled egg + sauteed bell pepper + onion + herbs. Breakfast crepe.

Per crepe (unfilled): ~55mg Na | ~45mg P | ~40mg K **Per crepe (strawberry cream cheese filling):** ~90mg Na | ~65mg P | ~80mg K

12. Maple Crunch Granola

"Granola was invented in 1863 by Dr. James Caleb Jackson at a health spa in Dansville, New York — he called it 'granula' and it was so hard it had to be soaked overnight before eating."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Old-fashioned rolled oats	3 cups	Oats are moderate P (~150mg/cup) — portion control matters, but homemade avoids phosphate additives
Rice cereal (puffed rice or Rice Krispies)	1 cup	Bulks up the granola with a low-P filler — plus the crunch is excellent
Avocado oil	1/4 cup	
Honey	1/3 cup	CKD-aware sweetener
Brown sugar	2 tbsp	
Vanilla extract	1 tsp	
Ground cinnamon	1 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Unsweetened coconut flakes	1/3 cup	Lower P than almonds/walnuts
Dried cranberries	1/3 cup	Lower K than raisins or dried apricots

What's NOT in here (and why):

Common Granola Ingredient	Why It's Excluded
Almonds/walnuts/cashews	High P (130-160mg per oz) — if you MUST, limit to 1 tbsp sliced almonds
Dried banana chips	High K
Raisins	High K (~300mg per 1/4 cup)
Chocolate chips	Often contain phosphate additives — check label if adding
Store-bought granola	Almost always contains sodium phosphate, calcium phosphate, or other P additives in the ingredient list

Method: 1. Preheat oven to 300F. Line a large sheet pan with parchment. 2. Mix oats and rice cereal in a large bowl. 3. In a small saucepan, warm oil + honey + brown sugar over low heat until sugar dissolves. Stir in vanilla, cinnamon, salt. 4. Pour wet mixture over dry. Toss until every flake is coated. 5. Spread in an even layer on the sheet pan. Press down firmly with a spatula (this creates clusters). 6. Bake 40-45 min, stirring ONCE at the 20-minute mark. The granola should be golden and fragrant. It will still feel soft — it crisps as it cools. 7. Let cool COMPLETELY on the pan without touching it. Seriously. This is how clusters form. 8. Once cool, break into chunks. Fold in coconut flakes and dried cranberries. 9. Store in an airtight container. Lasts 2 weeks at room temperature.

Per 1/2 cup serving: ~60mg Na | ~95mg P | ~110mg K

13. Morning Jar Oats

"Bircher muesli, the direct ancestor of overnight oats, was created around 1900 by Swiss physician Maximilian Bircher-Benner for patients at his sanatorium in Zurich."

Base Recipe:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Old-fashioned rolled oats	1/2 cup	~150mg P per cup, so 1/2 cup = ~75mg P
Unsweetened almond milk	1/2 cup	
Plain yogurt (non-Greek)	2 tbsp	Regular yogurt, NOT Greek — Greek yogurt has nearly double the P
Maple syrup or honey	1 tbsp	
Vanilla extract	1/2 tsp	
Chia seeds	1 tsp	Small amount — chia is moderate P, 1 tsp is fine

Method: 1. Combine all ingredients in a jar or container with a lid. 2. Stir well (or shake with lid on). 3. Refrigerate overnight (minimum 6 hours). 4. In the morning, stir. Add a splash more almond milk if too thick. 5. Eat cold or microwave 1-2 min if you prefer warm.

Flavor variations (mix in before refrigerating or top in the morning):

Variation	Add-ins	Extra CKD Notes
Blueberry Vanilla	1/4 cup blueberries + extra vanilla	Blueberries are one of the lowest-K fruits
Cinnamon Apple	1/4 cup diced apple + 1/2 tsp cinnamon + 1 tsp brown sugar	Apples are renal-aware, ~150mg K per medium apple
Strawberry	1/4 cup sliced strawberries + 1 tsp honey drizzle	
PB&J	1 tbsp peanut butter + 1 tbsp strawberry jam	PB adds ~60mg P per tbsp — occasional treat, not daily
Cranberry Coconut	2 tbsp dried cranberries + 1 tbsp coconut flakes	Low K combo

Per serving (base recipe): ~50mg Na | ~100mg P | ~140mg K

14. North African Skillet Eggs

"Shakshuka likely originated in Ottoman North Africa — the word comes from the Berber or Arabic for 'a mixture,' and the dish traveled across the Middle East before becoming Israel's national breakfast by the mid-20th century."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Eggs	4 large	Poached directly in the sauce
Canned diced tomatoes (no salt added)	1 can (14.5 oz)	NO SALT ADDED is critical — regular canned tomatoes = 400mg+ Na per can. Tomatoes are moderate K, but the portion per serving is controlled.
Red bell pepper	1 medium, diced	
White onion	1 medium, diced	
Garlic	3 cloves, minced	
Avocado oil	2 tbsp	
Cumin	1 tsp	
Paprika	1 tsp	
Smoked paprika	1/2 tsp	The smoky depth that separates OK shakshuka from great shakshuka
Cayenne	1/4 tsp (or to taste)	
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Sugar	1/2 tsp	Cuts tomato acidity
Fresh cilantro or parsley	For garnish	

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Crusty white bread	For serving	For dipping — sourdough or white baguette
Feta cheese	1 tbsp crumbled (optional)	Small portion — adds salt and tang

Method: 1. Heat oil in a deep 10-12" skillet (cast iron ideal) over medium heat. 2. Saute onion and bell pepper until soft (5-6 min). 3. Add garlic, cook 30 seconds until fragrant. Add cumin, paprika, smoked paprika, cayenne, black pepper. Stir and toast spices 1 min — they should bloom in the oil and smell incredible. 4. Add diced tomatoes (with liquid), salt, sugar. Stir and bring to a simmer. Cook 10-12 min, stirring occasionally, until the sauce thickens and reduces slightly. You want a thick sauce, not soup. 5. Taste and adjust seasoning. The sauce should be bold and slightly smoky. 6. Make 4 wells in the sauce with the back of a spoon. Crack one egg into each well. 7. Cover the skillet with a lid. Reduce heat to medium-low. Cook 5-8 min: 5 min for runny yolks, 8 min for set yolks. Check frequently. 8. Remove from heat. Garnish with cilantro/parsley and optional feta crumbles. 9. Serve in the skillet with crusty white bread for scooping. Shakshuka is communal — everyone eats from the pan.

Per serving (2 eggs + 1/2 the sauce): ~250mg Na | ~200mg P | ~380mg K

The K is on the higher side from the tomatoes. If you're on a strict K limit, use 3/4 of the tomato can instead of the full can, and add 2 tbsp water to compensate.

15. Stale-Tortilla Magic Chilaquiles

"Chilaquiles comes from the Nahuatl word 'chilaquilitl,' meaning 'chilis and greens' — the dish was originally an ancient Aztec method for using stale tortillas, predating European contact in the Americas."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Corn tortillas	6-8 (stale or oven-dried)	Cut into triangles and fried/baked — corn tortillas are lower Na than flour
Avocado oil	3 tbsp (for frying chips)	Or bake for a lighter version
Salsa verde (homemade or low-sodium store)	1 cup	Tomatillo-based — LOWER K than red tomato salsa. Check Na on store brands (<300mg per 1/2 cup)
Eggs	2-4, fried or scrambled	Served on top
Queso fresco or feta	2 tbsp, crumbled	Lower Na per oz than cheddar
Sour cream or Mexican crema	2 tbsp	
White onion	2 tbsp, thinly sliced	
Fresh cilantro	For garnish	
Lime	1 wedge per serving	
Avocado	2-3 slices per serving (optional)	Moderate K (~150mg per 1/4 avocado) — small portion OK

Quick CKD Salsa Verde (if making from scratch):

Ingredient	Amount
Tomatillos	6 medium, husked and rinsed
Jalapeno	1, halved and seeded
Garlic	2 cloves
White onion	1/4, chunked
Cilantro	Small bunch
Lime juice	1 tbsp
Salt	1/4 tsp
Water	2-3 tbsp (to thin)

Broil tomatillos, jalapeno, garlic, onion on a sheet pan 5-6 min until charred. Blend with cilantro, lime, salt, water. This salsa is MUCH lower Na than anything in a jar.

Method: 1. **Make chips:** Cut corn tortillas into triangles (6 per tortilla). Either fry in oil until golden and crispy (2-3 min per batch) OR brush with oil and bake at 375F for 12-15 min. 2. Warm salsa verde in a large skillet over medium heat. 3. Add the chips to the salsa. Toss gently to coat. Cook 2-3 min — you want the chips to soften slightly on the outside but stay crispy in the center. This is the soul of chilaquiles: the tension between crisp and sauced. 4. While chips cook in salsa, fry eggs in a separate skillet (sunny side up or over easy — runny yolk is mandatory). 5. Plate the sauced chips. Top with fried eggs. Garnish with crumbled cheese, sour cream, sliced onion, cilantro, lime wedge, avocado slices. 6. Eat immediately. Chilaquiles wait for no one — they go from perfect to mush in 5 minutes.

Per serving (half the batch + 2 eggs): ~290mg Na | ~210mg P | ~320mg K

CKD Breakfast Safety Reference

CKD Principle	Application in This Chapter
Phosphorus-free baking powder	Used in ALL baked items: waffles, pancakes, biscuits, cinnamon rolls. Rumford aluminum-free is the standard. Regular baking powder contains sodium aluminum phosphate — a phosphorus additive with near-100% absorption rate.
White flour > whole wheat	Every recipe specifies all-purpose or brioche. Whole wheat has ~120mg more P per cup and higher K. Refined flour is one of the rare cases where the "less healthy" option is the correct CKD choice.
K-leaching potatoes	Hash browns require 4+ hour cold water soak. Non-negotiable. Removes 40-50% of potassium. Without leaching, a serving of hash browns can hit 500mg+ K.
Turkey sausage > pork sausage	Lower P and Na per ounce. Always check the label for "sodium phosphate" in the ingredients — some turkey sausage brands add it back. If it says phosphate anywhere, put it back on the shelf.
Almond milk replaces dairy	~5mg P per cup vs ~230mg P per cup (whole milk). Used in every recipe that would traditionally call for milk. Unsweetened only — flavored varieties add unnecessary sugar and sometimes phosphate.

CKD Principle	Application in This Chapter
Eggs: 2-3 per meal	Eggs are CKD's best breakfast protein. High biological value, ~95mg P per egg, ~70mg Na per egg. Two eggs is one example serving. A larger serving changes phosphorus and protein totals, so compare it with your individualized targets and the rest of the day.
Maple syrup: check the portion and glucose plan	~40mg K, ~3mg P, ~2mg Na per tablespoon. Basically sugar and water with trace minerals. Use it.
Cream cheese for frosting	28mg P per oz (cream cheese) vs 40mg P per oz (butter). Also lower Na. And it tastes better on cinnamon rolls anyway.

Quick Renal Number Reference — All 15 Recipes

#	Recipe	Na (mg)	P (mg)	K (mg)
1	French Toast (2 slices + syrup)	120	105	130
2	Waffles (1 waffle)	110	95	90
3	Pancakes (3 + compote)	140	90	150
4	Eggs Benedict (2 halves)	280	230	200
5	Breakfast Burrito (1)	350	220	280
6	Biscuits & Gravy (2 + gravy)	320	170	190
7	Cinnamon Roll (1)	190	80	85
8	Breakfast Sandwich (1)	380	200	170
9	Hash Browns (1/2 batch, leached)	120	55	250
10a	Omelette — Western	310	290	250
10b	Omelette — Mediterranean	290	280	270
10c	Omelette — Garden	270	275	280
11	Crepe (strawberry cream cheese)	90	65	80
12	Granola (1/2 cup)	60	95	110
13	Overnight Oats (base)	50	100	140
14	Shakshuka (2 eggs + sauce)	250	200	380
15	Chilaquiles (half batch + 2 eggs)	290	210	320

General CKD daily targets for reference: Na <2,000mg | P <800-1,000mg | K varies by labs (typically 2,000-3,000mg). These are breakfast numbers — plan your other meals accordingly.

CHAPTER 2
American Soul Food

“Comfort has no restrictions.”

Country Fried Steak, Fried Chicken, Mac & Cheese, Gumbo, BBQ, Breakfast

"Comfort has no restrictions."

"One cannot think well, love well, sleep well, if one has not dined well."
— Virginia Woolf

FAMILY FAVORITES

Bob, Susan, and Stephanie recipes gathered into the Comfort chapter.

BOB'S RECIPES

Bob's Split Pea Soup

"No one who cooks, cooks alone." — Laurie Colwin

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Green split peas	1 cup, rinsed	Moderate K — rinse well, and the serving size controls it
Low-sodium chicken broth	4 cups	NOT regular broth
Turkey bacon	4 strips, chopped	Bob's version would have ham. Turkey bacon keeps the smoke.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Onion	1 medium, diced	
Carrots	2, diced	Moderate K — small amount across 6 servings
Celery	2 stalks, diced	
Garlic	3 cloves, minced	
Dried thyme	1 tsp	
Bay leaf	1	
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Apple cider vinegar	1 tsp (finish)	Brightens everything at the end

Method: 1. Cook turkey bacon in Dutch oven until crispy. Remove, leave drippings. 2. Sauté onion + carrots + celery in drippings 5 min. 3. Add garlic 1 min. 4. Add split peas + broth + thyme + bay leaf + pepper. 5. Bring to boil. Reduce to low simmer. Cover. 6. Cook 45-60 min, stirring occasionally, until peas dissolve into thick soup. 7. Remove bay leaf. Stir in vinegar + salt. 8. Serve topped with crumbled turkey bacon. 9. Make enough for six. Give five bowls away.
Per serving (6 servings): ~180mg Na | ~130mg P | ~350mg K

Bob's Box - "The Costco Run & Wine Pairing"

Costco runs. Good wine. Enough for everyone.

Compartment	What Goes In	Why
1 — Cheese	Aged cheddar, Brie wedge, or Kirkland Manchego — wine demands real cheese	Bob knows wine. Wine demands a cheese board. Costco's cheese section is elite.
2 — Crackers	Costco water crackers or fig & olive crisps	The cracker that doesn't compete with the wine or the cheese.
3 — Nuts	Marcona almonds or Costco roasted cashews (1/4 cup)	The wine pairing nut. Marcona > regular almonds. Bob knows.
4 — Fruit	Red grapes + dried apricots + fresh figs (when in season)	Classic wine accompaniments. Grapes with wine is redundant and perfect.
5 — Meat	Costco Columbus salami or prosciutto (thin-sliced, rolled)	The charcuterie lane. Wine + cured meat = civilization.
6 — Sweet	Dark chocolate (70%+) squares + Kirkland chocolate covered almonds	The wine closer. Dark chocolate + a good red = the end of the evening.

Wine note: Bob pairs. Red wine is lower-K than white (Andrew's CKD note if sharing). A 4oz glass is manageable. Bob would know the vintage, the region, and the story behind the bottle before the cork is pulled.

Bob's Theorem applied: This box costs ~\$5 to fill from Costco bulk — but it pairs with a \$40 bottle he already has. Bob would fill 10 boxes and hand them out with a wine recommendation card tucked in. That's who he is.

Box style: No-frills clear Gladware. Function over form. Bob doesn't need a sticker. Bob IS the sticker.

BOB'S SPECIALS

"Generosity is the only rational economic strategy." — Bob's Theorem

Bob's Ultra-Fresh Sweet & Spicy Ceviche

"Raw fish cured in citrus. No heat required. The acid does the cooking. The chili does the rest."

Base (works with any seafood):

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Fresh seafood (pick one or mix):		
Wild shrimp, peeled + deveined	1 lb	Andrew's #1 — lowest P seafood
Wild salmon, sushi-grade, 1/2" dice	1 lb	Wild only — never farmed
Wild cod or tilapia, 1/2" dice	1 lb	Mild, clean, takes the marinade well
Scallops, quartered	1 lb	Sweet + luxurious

The Cure (sweet + spicy + ultra fresh):

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Lime juice	1 cup (8-10 limes)	The house fix — best fresh squeezed, not bottled
Lemon juice	1/4 cup	Brightens the lime
Fresh mango, small dice	1/2 cup	Sweet counterpoint
Fresh pineapple, small dice	1/4 cup	More sweet acid
Red onion, finely diced	1/4 cup	Rinse in cold water first to tame raw bite
Jalapeño	1, seeded, minced	Seeds out = sweet heat, seeds in = war
Serrano	1, minced	The real spice — add half, taste, then decide
Habanero	1/4, minced (optional — for the brave)	Bob would want this in there
Fresh cilantro	1/2 cup, rough chopped	
Cucumber, peeled, seeded, diced	1/2 cup	Cool + crunch
Avocado	1, diced (add at the end)	Moderate K — worth it for texture
Olive oil	1 tbsp	Silky finish
Honey	1 tbsp	The sweet in sweet & spicy
Salt	1/4 tsp	

Method: 1. Cut seafood into 1/2" pieces. Place in glass bowl (never metal — acid reacts). 2. Pour lime + lemon juice over seafood. Every piece must be submerged. Cover. 3. Refrigerate **minimum 30 min** (shrimp) to **2 hours** (firm fish). The acid "cooks" the protein — flesh turns opaque. 4. Drain about half the citrus juice (too much = rubbery). 5. Fold in mango, pineapple, cucumber, onion, jalapeño, serrano, cilantro, honey, olive oil. 6. Add habanero if Bob's ghost is watching. 7. Add avocado last — fold gently so it doesn't mush. 8. Serve immediately in small bowls or on tostadas. Or eat it with a spoon standing at the counter.

Per serving (4 servings): ~130mg Na | ~180mg P | ~350mg K

Makes 4 servings.

Bob's Drumstick Ice Cream Cone Dupe

"The ice cream truck isn't coming. But this is better anyway."

Chocolate-Dipped Waffle Cone:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Sugar cones (store-bought)	6	Low P, low Na — read label for phosphate additives
Semi-sweet chocolate chips	1/2 cup	
Coconut oil	1 tsp	Thins the chocolate for dipping
Chopped peanuts	3 tbsp	Moderate P — small amount for the crunch coating

CKD Vanilla Ice Cream Filling:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Heavy cream	1 cup	Moderate P — portion controlled across 6 cones
Unsweetened almond milk	1 cup	Cuts the dairy P in half
Sugar	2/3 cup	
Vanilla extract	2 tsp	Real vanilla
Egg yolks	3	
Pinch of salt		

The Magic Shell Top:

Ingredient	Amount
Semi-sweet chocolate chips	1/2 cup
Coconut oil	2 tbsp

Method: 1. **Ice cream:** Heat cream + almond milk + sugar until steaming. Temper into yolks. Return to heat, stir to 170F. Strain, add vanilla. Chill overnight. Churn in ice cream maker. 2. **Prep cones:** Melt 1/2 cup chocolate + 1 tsp coconut oil. Dip inside rim of each cone in chocolate (seals the bottom so it doesn't leak). Roll outer rim in chopped peanuts. Set upside down on parchment. Freeze 10 min. 3. **Fill:** Scoop ice cream into prepared cones. Pack it tight. Round the top into a dome. Freeze 1 hour until firm. 4. **Magic shell:** Melt 1/2 cup chocolate + 2 tbsp coconut oil. Let cool 2 min (still liquid but not screaming hot). 5. **Dip:** Dip the ice cream dome into magic shell. It hardens on contact (the coconut oil is the trick). Immediately press a few more chopped peanuts into the wet chocolate. 6. Eat immediately or wrap individually in plastic and freeze.

Per cone: ~110mg Na | ~95mg P | ~140mg K — That's a real Drumstick at half the phosphorus.

Makes 6 cones. \$0.80 each.

Bob's Mushroom Theorem

A dish that proves, mathematically, that generosity is the only rational economic strategy.

Ingredient	Amount
Mushrooms	As many as you can carry
Rice	1 cup
Margarine	Some
Garlic	4 cloves
Thyme	Fresh

Ingredient	Amount
The knowledge that you're making this for someone else	Required

Method: Cook the mushrooms. Cook the rice. Combine them. Put them on two plates. Give one away. The plate you gave away tastes better than the plate you kept. This is not a metaphor. This is thermodynamics.

Proof: Let G = generosity, R = return. For all $G > 0$, R approaches ∞ as the number of plates given away increases. The limit does not exist because there is no upper bound on what comes back when you feed someone without asking for anything. ■

SUSAN'S KITCHEN

"After a good dinner, one can forgive anybody, even one's own relatives." — Oscar Wilde

Susan's Cornbread with Hot Dogs

It's exactly what it sounds like. It's perfect.

The Original (Susan's Way): Cut hot dogs into coins. Pour cornbread batter over them in a cast iron skillet. Bake until golden. Eat with mustard. Don't explain it to anyone. Don't apologize.

CKD Version:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Turkey hot dogs	4, sliced into coins	Lower Na than beef franks
Cornbread batter (GF cornbread recipe, Ch 11)	1 batch	Rumford BP, almond milk, margarine
Yellow mustard	For serving	Lowest Na condiment

Method: Grease cast iron skillet. Scatter hot dog coins across the bottom. Pour cornbread batter over them. Bake 400F 20-25 min until golden. Flip onto cutting board. The hot dogs are embedded in the bottom like fossils. Cut into wedges. Dip in mustard. Remember.

Susan's Cream of Mushroom Everything

She put cream of mushroom soup in things that had no business containing cream of mushroom soup. It worked every time.

The Original: 1 can Campbell's Cream of Mushroom + literally any protein + rice or noodles = dinner.

CKD Version — The Susan Casserole Formula:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Homemade cream of mushroom soup (recipe #2 above)	2 cups	Not the can. The can has 870mg Na per cup.
Chicken thighs, cooked and shredded	1 lb	
Jasmine rice, cooked	2 cups	
Frozen green beans	1 cup	Frozen is fine here — Susan would insist
Sharp cheddar, shredded	1/2 cup (on top)	
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	

Method: Mix mushroom soup + chicken + rice + green beans in a baking dish. Top with cheddar. Bake 375F 20 min until bubbly. This is Susan's dinner. The mushroom soup is the glue. The recipe is the love.

Per serving (4 servings): ~190mg Na | ~180mg P | ~360mg K (vs canned version: ~900mg Na)

Susan's Sprite with Splenda

A beverage that exists because Susan said it did.

The Original: Sprite. Splenda. Stir. Serve. That's it. That's the recipe.

CKD Note: Sprite is actually one of the more renal-aware sodas — no phosphoric acid (that's Coke/Pepsi), moderate K. Adding Splenda cuts sugar if you're watching glucose. Susan was accidentally ahead of her time.

The CKD upgrade (if you want one): Sparkling water + fresh lime juice + Splenda or stevia. Same vibe. Zero sodium. Susan would say the

original was fine and she'd be right.

Susan's Tuna Noodle Casserole

The Midwest's answer to everything.

The Original: Egg noodles + canned tuna + cream of mushroom soup + frozen peas + crushed potato chips on top.

CKD Version:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Egg noodles (or GF rice noodles)	8 oz, cooked	
Canned tuna in water	1 can (5oz), drained and rinsed	Andrew doesn't like canned fish — sub shredded chicken for him. Lauren gets the tuna.
Homemade cream of mushroom soup (recipe #2)	1.5 cups	
Frozen peas	1/2 cup	Moderate K — small amount is fine
Sharp cheddar	1/4 cup, shredded	
Panko breadcrumbs	1/3 cup	Replaces potato chips — still crunchy
Margarine	1 tbsp (melted, tossed with panko)	
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	

Method: Mix noodles + tuna (or chicken) + mushroom soup + peas in baking dish. Top with cheddar + buttered panko. Bake 375F 20 min. The panko gets golden. The cheese bubbles. Susan nods.

Susan's Hamburger Helper (From Scratch)

Because Susan's version came from a box and it was still good and that's okay.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Ground turkey or chicken	1 lb	No pork. Lower P than beef.
Elbow pasta	8 oz, cooked	
No-salt-added tomato paste	2 tbsp	
Low-sodium beef broth	1 cup	
Unsweetened almond milk	1/2 cup	
Sharp cheddar	1/2 cup, shredded (stir in at end)	
Onion powder	1 tsp	
Garlic powder	1 tsp	
Paprika	1/2 tsp	
Costco no-salt seasoning	1 tsp	
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	

Method: Brown meat, drain fat. Add tomato paste, stir 1 min. Add broth + almond milk + all seasonings. Simmer 5 min. Add cooked pasta + cheddar. Stir until melted and creamy. Serve in bowls. Tell no one it's homemade. Let them think it came from a box. Susan would.

Per serving (4 servings): ~200mg Na | ~190mg P | ~320mg K

Susan's Jell-O "Salad"

It's not a salad. It never was. Midwest calls it a salad anyway.

The Original: Lime Jell-O + cottage cheese + crushed pineapple + Cool Whip. Called "salad" at potlucks. Brought in a Pyrex dish with tin foil. Nobody questions it.

CKD Version:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Lime Jell-O	1 small box	Low K/P/Na — one of the safest CKD desserts
Boiling water	1 cup	

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Cold water	1/2 cup	
Crushed pineapple, drained	1/2 cup (canned, drained well)	Draining removes K
Whipped topping (Cool Whip or coconut whipped cream)	1 cup	

Method: Dissolve Jell-O in boiling water. Add cold water. Chill until partially set (~45 min). Fold in drained pineapple + whipped topping. Refrigerate until firm. Cut into squares. Call it salad. Bring it in a Pyrex dish. Cover with tin foil. Susan's spirit is in the tin foil.

Susan's Meatloaf

Every Midwest mom's meatloaf is different. Every Midwest mom's meatloaf is the same.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Ground turkey	1.5 lbs	Susan used beef. We use turkey. She'd understand.
Breadcrumbs	1/2 cup	
Egg	1	
Onion, finely diced	1/2 cup	
Garlic powder	1 tsp	
Costco no-salt seasoning	1 tsp	
Worcestershire sauce	1 tbsp	Small amount = controlled Na
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	

Glaze:

Ingredient	Amount
No-salt-added tomato paste	2 tbsp
Brown sugar	1 tbsp
Yellow mustard	1 tsp
Apple cider vinegar	1 tsp

Method: Mix everything (except glaze) with your hands. Don't overmix — tough meatloaf is a crime. Shape into loaf on sheet pan or in loaf pan. Mix glaze, brush on top. Bake 375F 45-50 min until 165F internal. Rest 10 min before slicing. Serve with mashed potatoes (K-leached, recipe in Ch 1). The glaze caramelizes and gets sticky and sweet and Susan would say "it's ready" without checking the temperature because she always knew.

Per serving (6 servings): ~190mg Na | ~170mg P | ~280mg K

Susan's Totino's Pizza Rolls (From Scratch)

Invented 1968 by Jeno Paulucci in Duluth, Minnesota. 290+ billion sold since. Wonton wrapper version.

Filling:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Turkey pepperoni, diced small	1/4 cup	Lower Na than regular pepperoni
No-salt-added tomato paste	2 tbsp	
Water	2 tbsp	
Italian seasoning	1/2 tsp	
Garlic powder	1/4 tsp	
Mozzarella, shredded	1/2 cup	Fresh mozz diced small works too
Black pepper	Pinch	

Wrappers:

Option	Notes
Wonton wrappers	Easiest — buy at Fred Meyer/Asian aisle
Egg roll wrappers, cut into 3" squares	Thicker, crunchier
Homemade: flour + water + salt dough, rolled thin	Control everything

Method: 1. Mix tomato paste + water + Italian seasoning + garlic powder into a thick sauce. 2. Lay wonton wrappers flat. Drop 1 tsp sauce + a few pepperoni pieces + pinch of mozzarella in center. 3. Wet edges with finger

dipped in water. Fold corner to corner (triangle) or bring all corners to center (bundle). Press to seal. 4. **Bake:** 400F on parchment, brush with olive oil, 12-15 min until golden and blistered. 5. **Or fry:** 350F oil, 2 min per side until golden and puffy. 6. Let cool 2 min. The inside is molten. Susan knew this and ate them immediately anyway.

Makes ~30 rolls. Per 5 rolls: ~140mg Na | ~65mg P | ~80mg K (vs Totino's: ~400mg Na per 6 rolls)

Lauren's Ham & Cheese Hot Pockets / Toaster Strudels

"The after-school food that Lauren elevated to a lifestyle."

Dough (makes 8 pockets):

Ingredient	Amount
All-purpose flour	2 cups
Cold margarine, cubed	1/2 cup
Cream cheese	2 oz, cold
Cold water	3-4 tbsp
Salt	1/2 tsp

Ham & Cheese Filling:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Deli turkey (sub for ham — or use real ham for Lauren, she's not CKD)	4 oz, chopped	Turkey for Andrew, ham for Lauren
Havarti, shredded	1/2 cup	Lauren's cheese
Mozzarella, shredded	1/4 cup	
Dijon mustard	1 tsp	Inside the pocket
Black pepper	Pinch	

Method: 1. **Dough:** Pulse flour + salt + margarine + cream cheese in food processor until pea-sized. Add cold water until dough holds. Wrap, chill 30 min. 2. Roll dough thin. Cut into rectangles (~4x6"). 3. Spoon filling onto one half. Fold over. Crimp edges with fork. Poke top twice with fork (steam vents). 4. **Egg wash:** Brush with beaten egg. 5. **Bake:** 400F on parchment, 18-22 min until deep golden and puffed.

Toaster Strudel version: Same recipe but thinner dough, pipe cream cheese icing on top after baking (2 oz cream cheese + 1/4 cup powdered sugar + splash of almond milk, whisked). The icing is the move.

Per pocket: ~180mg Na | ~95mg P | ~100mg K

Girl Scout Samoa Cookie Dupe

"Caramel. Coconut. Chocolate. The cookie that funds an empire."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Shortbread base:		
All-purpose flour	1.5 cups	
Margarine, softened	1/2 cup	
Powdered sugar	1/3 cup	
Vanilla	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Caramel-coconut topping:		
Caramels (unwrapped)	25 pieces (~8oz)	Or homemade: sugar + margarine + cream
Unsweetened almond milk	2 tbsp	Thin the caramel
Shredded coconut, toasted	2 cups	Toast in dry skillet until golden
Salt	Pinch	
Chocolate drizzle:		
Semi-sweet chocolate chips	1/2 cup	
Coconut oil	1 tsp	

Method: 1. **Shortbread:** Cream margarine + sugar + vanilla. Mix in flour + salt. Roll to 1/4" thick. Cut 2" rounds. Use a small cutter or bottle cap to punch center hole (the Samoa ring). Bake 325F 12-14 min until just barely golden. Cool completely. 2. **Caramel-coconut:** Melt caramels with almond milk in saucepan over low heat, stirring constantly. Fold in toasted coconut. Work fast — it sets up. 3. **Assemble:** Spoon caramel-coconut

onto each cookie ring, pressing to coat the top and sides. Set on parchment. 4. **Chocolate:** Melt chocolate + coconut oil. Dip bottoms of cookies in chocolate. Then drizzle stripes across the top. Refrigerate 15 min to set. 5. Try not to eat them all while they're setting. You will fail. That's okay.

Per cookie (makes ~20): ~55mg Na | ~30mg P | ~45mg K

"The shared meal elevates eating from a mechanical process to a ceremony." — Wendell Berry

CKD Considerations

RENAL CHECK – Mushroom Farm & Susan's Kitchen
K (Potassium): LOW-MED (mushrooms are moderate K, but per-serving amounts are controlled)
P (Phosphorus): LOW-MED (homemade cream of mushroom = no phosphate preservatives from cans)
Na (Sodium): LOW (homemade everything, no canned soups, low-sodium broth)
NOTE: The cream of mushroom soup recipe (#2) replaces canned in ALL Susan recipes.
One batch of homemade = 140mg Na/serving. One can of Campbell's = 870mg Na/serving.
Susan's recipes live on. The sodium doesn't.

"There is no sincerer love than the love of food." — George Bernard Shaw

STEPHANIE’S CLASSICS

*“Tell me what you eat, and I will tell you what you are.
— Brillat-Savarin”*

S.O.S., Beijing Beef, Empanadas & Stroganoff

"Tell me what you eat, and I will tell you what you are." — Brillat-Savarin

S.O.S. — Mashed Potatoes with Hamburger Gravy
Originally "Creamed Chipped Beef on Toast" — U.S. military mess halls, WWII era. Soldiers called it S.O.S. The name stuck longer than the war.

K-Leached Mashed Potatoes:		
Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Russet potatoes	2 lbs, peeled, 1" cubes	LEACH: soak 2-4 hours in cold water, drain, rinse, boil in fresh water, drain again
Unsweetened almond milk	1/2 cup, warmed	
Margarine	3 tbsp	
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	

Hamburger Gravy:		
Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Ground beef (90/10)	1 lb	Mom used beef. We use beef.
All-purpose flour	3 tbsp	
Low-sodium beef broth	2 cups	
Onion powder	1/2 tsp	
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	
Worcestershire sauce	1 tsp	
Black pepper	1/2 tsp (generous)	
Salt	1/4 tsp	

Method: 1. Brown ground beef in skillet, breaking into small crumbles. Drain most fat, keep 2 tbsp. 2. Sprinkle flour over meat + fat. Stir 1 min. 3. Slowly add broth, whisking. Add all seasonings. 4. Simmer until thick and bubbling, 4-5 min. 5. Mash the leached potatoes with almond milk + margarine + seasonings. 6. Pile potatoes on plate. Ladle hamburger gravy over the top. The gravy goes on the potatoes. The potatoes go in your mouth. Nothing else matters.
Per serving (4 servings): ~220mg Na | ~210mg P | ~350mg K

Mom's Beijing Beef (Panda Express Dupe)
Panda Express dupe. Crispy flank steak in sweet ginger-tomato sauce.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Flank steak	1 lb, sliced thin against the grain	
Cornstarch	1/4 cup (for coating)	
Avocado oil	For frying (1" deep)	
Bell peppers (red + green)	1 each, cut into 1" pieces	
Onion	1/2, cut into wedges	
Dried red chili peppers	4-6 (for wok toss, not eating)	

Beijing Sauce:		
Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
No-salt-added tomato paste	2 tbsp	
Rice vinegar	2 tbsp	
Low-sodium soy sauce	1 tbsp	Small amount — the sauce is sweet-forward
Brown sugar	3 tbsp	The sweetness IS the dish
Garlic	3 cloves, minced	
Ginger	1" piece, minced	
Sesame oil	1 tsp	
Cornstarch slurry	1 tbsp cornstarch + 2 tbsp water	

Method: 1. Slice steak thin. Toss in cornstarch until fully coated. 2. Fry in 1" of oil at 375F, 2-3 min per batch until crispy. Drain on rack. 3. Mix all sauce ingredients (except slurry) in a bowl. 4. Hot wok: stir-fry peppers + onion + dried chilies 2 min. 5. Add sauce. Bring to bubble. Add cornstarch slurry. Stir until thick and glossy. 6. Toss in crispy beef. Coat everything. Serve immediately over jasmine rice. 7. The beef stays crispy for about 4 minutes. Eat fast. Mom did.
Per serving (4 servings): ~250mg Na | ~200mg P | ~380mg K

Mom's Green Chile Beef Empanadas
Green chile + beef + cream cheese in crispy dough.
Filling:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Ground beef (90/10)	1 lb	
Canned green chiles (diced, mild or hot)	1 can (4oz)	Low K, low Na
Onion	1/2, finely diced	
Garlic	3 cloves, minced	
Cumin	1 tsp	
Chili powder	1/2 tsp	
Cream cheese	2 oz	Bounds the filling, adds richness
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	

Dough (or shortcut):	
Ingredient	Amount
All-purpose flour	2.5 cups
Cold margarine, cubed	1/2 cup
Cold water	6-8 tbsp
Salt	1/2 tsp
Egg wash	1 egg beaten with 1 tbsp water

Shortcut: Use Goya discos (frozen empanada dough) — Mom would understand.
Method: 1. **Filling:** Brown beef + onion. Add garlic 1 min. Add chiles + spices. Stir in cream cheese until melted and combined. Cool 15 min. 2. **Dough:** Pulse flour + salt + margarine in food processor until pea-sized. Add cold water 1 tbsp at a time until dough holds together. Wrap, chill 30 min. Roll thin, cut 5" circles. (Or: use Goya discos.) 3. **Assemble:** Spoon 2 tbsp filling onto each circle. Fold in half. Crimp edges with fork. 4. **Bake:**

Brush with egg wash. Bake 400F on parchment-lined sheet, 18-22 min until golden. 5. **Or fry:** 350F oil, 3 min per side until golden and blistered.

Per empanada (makes ~14): ~130mg Na | ~75mg P | ~110mg K

The green chiles + cream cheese inside the crispy shell is the move. Mom knew.

Mom's Beef Stroganoff

"Egg noodles. Sour cream. Beef. Mushrooms. Nothing else needed to happen."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Beef sirloin or top round	1 lb, sliced into thin strips	
Egg noodles (wide)	8 oz	Or GF rice noodles
White mushrooms	8 oz, sliced	
Onion	1 medium, sliced thin	
Garlic	3 cloves, minced	
Margarine	2 tbsp	
All-purpose flour	2 tbsp	
Low-sodium beef broth	1.5 cups	
Sour cream	1/2 cup	Stir in OFF HEAT — boiling curdles it
Worcestershire sauce	1 tbsp	
Dijon mustard	1 tsp	Mom's secret — most people skip this
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Fresh parsley	For garnish	

Method: 1. Season beef strips with pepper + salt. Sear in hot skillet with 1 tbsp margarine, 2 min per side. Remove. Don't crowd — do batches. 2. Same pan: add remaining margarine. Sauté mushrooms 5 min until golden. Add onion 3 min. Add garlic 1 min. 3. Sprinkle flour over vegetables. Stir 1 min. 4. Add broth + Worcestershire + mustard. Simmer until thickened, 4-5 min. 5. Return beef to pan. Simmer 2 min. 6. **REMOVE FROM HEAT.** Stir in sour cream. (If you add sour cream to boiling liquid it breaks. Mom learned this once and never forgot.) 7. Serve over egg noodles. Garnish with parsley. The sauce should coat everything like velvet.

Per serving (4 servings): ~240mg Na | ~220mg P | ~400mg K

"Cooking is at once child's play and adult joy. And cooking done with care is an act of love." — Craig Claiborne

CKD Considerations

RENAL CHECK – Mom's Classics
K (Potassium): MED (leached potatoes, controlled portions)
P (Phosphorus): MED (beef is moderate P – portion to 4oz per serving)
Na (Sodium): LOW (homemade everything – no canned soups, no packets)
NOTE: Mom used regular salt, regular butter, regular everything. We use margarine, almond milk, low-sodium broth, leached potatoes. Same food. Same taste. Different math.

"People who love to eat are always the best people." — Julia Child

BREAKFAST

1. Country Fried Steak & Gravy

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Cube steak	4 pieces (4-5oz each)	Tenderized beef — Andrew's #1 protein
All-purpose flour	1 cup	
Egg	1, beaten	
Unsweetened almond milk	1/4 cup	Mixed with egg for wash
Garlic powder	1 tsp	
Onion powder	1 tsp	
Paprika	1 tsp	

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Cayenne	1/4 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	Minimal — the gravy adds flavor
Avocado oil	For frying (1/2" deep)	

White Country Gravy:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Pan drippings	3 tbsp	From frying the steak
All-purpose flour	3 tbsp	
Unsweetened almond milk	1.5 cups	Instead of whole milk — lower P
Black pepper	1/2 tsp (generous)	The pepper IS the gravy
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Garlic powder	1/4 tsp	

Method: 1. Season flour with garlic powder, onion powder, paprika, pepper, cayenne, salt 2. Dip steaks in egg/milk wash, then dredge in seasoned flour. Double-dredge for extra crispy (egg wash again, flour again) 3. Fry in avocado oil (350F) 3-4 min per side until deep golden. Drain on wire rack. 4. **Gravy:** Keep 3 tbsp drippings in pan. Whisk in flour, cook 1 min. Slowly add almond milk, whisking constantly. Simmer until thick (3-4 min). Season with pepper + salt + garlic powder. 5. Serve steak with gravy poured over. Pair with CKD mashed potatoes (below).

2. Brown Gravy (Mushroom)

Ingredient	Amount
Margarine	2 tbsp
White mushrooms, sliced	1 cup
All-purpose flour	2 tbsp
Low-sodium beef broth	1.5 cups
Worcestershire sauce	1 tsp
Black pepper	1/2 tsp
Garlic powder	1/4 tsp
Onion powder	1/4 tsp

Method: Saut mushrooms in margarine 5 min. Add flour, stir 1 min. Gradually add broth, whisking. Add Worcestershire + spices. Simmer until thick. Serve over mashed potatoes, steak, or chicken.

3. Hearty Breakfast Plate

Component	CKD Version
Eggs	Scrambled (2 eggs, cooked in avocado oil) — moderate P, 2 is fine
Bacon	Turkey bacon (lower Na/P than pork bacon) — 2 strips max
Hash browns	LEACHED potatoes: shred, soak in cold water 2+ hours, rinse, squeeze dry, then fry. Leaching removes ~50% of potassium.
Toast	Sourdough, lightly toasted, with margarine
Grits	CKD-aware as portioned — low K/P/Na. Cook with almond milk + margarine. Add sharp cheddar.
Biscuits	Homemade with phosphorus-free baking powder (see below)
Gravy	White country gravy (recipe above)

4. Cloud Biscuits

Ingredient	Amount
All-purpose flour	2 cups
Phosphorus-free baking powder (Rumford)	1 tbsp
Sugar	1 tsp
Salt	1/2 tsp
Cold margarine, cubed	1/3 cup
Unsweetened almond milk	3/4 cup

Method: Mix flour + BP + sugar + salt. Cut in cold margarine until pea-sized. Add milk, stir until just combined (DON'T overmix). Pat to 1" thick, cut rounds. Bake 425F 12-15 min until golden top.

MAINS

5. Golden Skillet Fried Chicken

The big one. Fried chicken is usually a CKD disaster (phosphate-injected meat, high-Na brine). Homemade fixes everything.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Chicken thighs or drumsticks	8 pieces	FRESH, not injected/marinated — check label for "enhanced"
Unsweetened almond milk	1 cup	Buttermilk sub (add 1 tbsp vinegar, let sit 10 min)
All-purpose flour	1.5 cups	
Cornstarch	1/4 cup	Extra crunch
Paprika	1 tbsp	
Garlic powder	1 tsp	
Onion powder	1 tsp	
Cayenne	1/2 tsp	
Black pepper	1 tsp	
Dried thyme	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/2 tsp	Way less than KFC
Avocado oil	For deep frying (3-4" deep)	

Method: 1. Soak chicken in almond milk "buttermilk" for 1 hour minimum (overnight better) 2. Mix flour + cornstarch + ALL spices in a bowl 3. Remove chicken from milk, dredge in flour mix. Press firmly. Let sit on rack 15 min (this sets the coating) 4. Heat oil to 325F (NOT 350 — lower temp = juicier interior, crispier exterior, less oil absorption) 5. Fry in batches, don't crowd. 14-16 min total, turning once. Internal temp 165F. 6. Rest on wire rack 5 min before serving. DO NOT rest on paper towels (traps steam, gets soggy).

Per 2 pieces: ~180mg Na, ~220mg P, ~350mg K (vs KFC: ~1,200mg Na per 2 pieces)

6. Velvet Mac & Cheese

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Elbow pasta (or GF)	8 oz	
Cream cheese	4 oz	Lower P than making roux with milk
Sharp cheddar, shredded	1 cup	Andrew's preferred cheese
Smoked gouda, shredded	1/2 cup	Andrew's preferred — adds smoky depth
Unsweetened almond milk	1/2 cup	
Margarine	2 tbsp	
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	
Paprika	1/4 tsp	
Dry mustard	1/4 tsp	Secret ingredient — lifts the cheese flavor
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Panko breadcrumbs	1/3 cup (optional topping)	

Method: 1. Cook pasta 1 min SHORT of al dente. Drain. 2. In same pot: melt margarine, add cream cheese + almond milk, stir until smooth 3. Add shredded cheddar + gouda, stir until melted 4. Add garlic powder, paprika, mustard, pepper, salt 5. Add pasta, fold gently 6. **Optional baked:** Transfer to baking dish, top with panko + paprika, bake 375F 15 min until golden bubbling top

Why cream cheese base: Traditional mac uses a flour roux + lots of milk = higher phosphorus. Cream cheese gives the SAME creamy texture with lower P. The smoked gouda adds the depth that the missing parmesan would have provided.

7. Bayou Sunday Gumbo

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Avocado oil	1/4 cup	For the roux
All-purpose flour	1/4 cup	For the roux

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Onion	1, diced	The trinity
Celery	2 stalks, diced	The trinity — moderate K, small amount
Bell pepper	1 green, diced	The trinity
Garlic	4 cloves	
Chicken thighs	1 lb, boneless, cubed	
Andouille sausage	6 oz, sliced	Watch Na — use sparingly or sub chicken sausage
Low-sodium chicken broth	4 cups	NOT regular broth
No-salt-added diced tomatoes	1 can (14oz)	
Okra	1 cup, sliced	Thickener + vegetable — low K
Bay leaves	2	
Dried thyme	1 tsp	
Cayenne	1/2 tsp	
Paprika	1 tsp	
File powder	1 tsp (optional — sassafras leaf, traditional)	
Hot sauce (homemade)	To taste	

Method: 1. **THE ROUX:** Oil + flour in heavy pot over medium heat. Stir CONSTANTLY 20-30 min until dark chocolate brown. This is the soul of gumbo. Do not walk away. Do not answer the phone. Stir. 2. Add trinity (onion, celery, bell pepper). Stir 5 min. 3. Add garlic, stir 1 min. 4. Add broth SLOWLY (it will bubble violently). Stir smooth. 5. Add tomatoes, bay leaves, thyme, cayenne, paprika. 6. Add chicken + sausage. Simmer 30 min. 7. Add okra. Simmer 15 min more. 8. Remove bay leaves. Serve over jasmine rice with hot sauce + file powder.

Per serving: ~350mg Na (vs restaurant gumbo: 1,500mg+), ~250mg P, ~450mg K

8. Big Easy Jambalaya

Ingredient	Amount
Jasmine rice (dry)	1.5 cups
Chicken thighs, cubed	1 lb
Andouille or chicken sausage	6 oz, sliced
Shrimp	8 oz, peeled (optional — Andrew likes shrimp)
Onion	1, diced
Bell pepper	1, diced
Celery	2 stalks, diced
Garlic	4 cloves
No-salt-added diced tomatoes	1 can (14oz)
Low-sodium chicken broth	2.5 cups
Cajun seasoning (homemade — see below)	2 tbsp
Bay leaf	1
Hot sauce	To taste

Homemade CKD Cajun Seasoning (NO SALT):

Spice	Amount
Paprika	2 tbsp
Garlic powder	1 tbsp
Onion powder	1 tbsp
Cayenne	1 tsp
Black pepper	1 tsp
Dried oregano	1 tsp
Dried thyme	1 tsp
White pepper	1/2 tsp

Method: 1. Season chicken with Cajun seasoning. Brown in oil 4 min. Remove. 2. Brown sausage 3 min. Remove. 3. Saut trinity 5 min. Add garlic 1 min. 4. Add tomatoes + broth + remaining Cajun seasoning + bay leaf. Bring to boil. 5. Add rice + chicken + sausage. Cover tightly. Reduce

to LOW. 6. Cook 20-25 min without lifting lid. 7. Add shrimp in last 5 min (they cook fast — don't overcook). 8. Remove bay leaf. Fluff with fork. Serve with hot sauce.

BBQ / COOKOUT

9. Backyard Smokehouse Ribs

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Beef back ribs or beef short ribs	1 rack (~2.5 lbs)	Beef over pork — Andrew's preference. Lamb ribs also work.
Dry Rub (NO SALT):		
Brown sugar	2 tbsp	
Paprika	1 tbsp	
Garlic powder	1 tsp	
Onion powder	1 tsp	
Cumin	1 tsp	
Chili powder	1 tsp	
Black pepper	1 tsp	
Cayenne	1/2 tsp	
Mustard powder	1/2 tsp	

CKD BBQ Sauce:

Ingredient	Amount
No-salt-added tomato paste	3 tbsp
Water	3 tbsp
Brown sugar	2 tbsp
Apple cider vinegar	2 tbsp
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp
Onion powder	1/2 tsp
Smoked paprika	1 tsp
Cayenne	1/4 tsp
Worcestershire	1 tsp
Liquid smoke	1/2 tsp

Method (Oven — no smoker needed): 1. Remove membrane from back of ribs 2. Rub both sides generously with dry rub. Wrap in foil. 3. Bake 300F for 2.5-3 hours until tender 4. Unwrap. Brush with BBQ sauce. 5. Broil 3-4 min or grill over high heat 2-3 min per side until caramelized 6. Rest 10 min. Cut between bones. Serve with extra sauce.

Store-bought BBQ sauce: 300-600mg Na per 2 tbsp. This homemade version: ~40mg Na per 2 tbsp.

10. Double-Rinse Mashed Potatoes

THE trick that makes mashed potatoes CKD-possible

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Russet potatoes	2 lbs, peeled and cubed 1"	
Unsweetened almond milk	1/2 cup, warmed	
Margarine	3 tbsp	
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	

THE LEACHING METHOD (critical): 1. Peel potatoes. Cut into small 1" cubes (more surface area = more K removed) 2. Soak in a large bowl of cold water for **MINIMUM 2 hours** (4 hours better, overnight best) 3. **DRAIN. RINSE. REFILL** with fresh cold water at least once during soaking 4. Drain AGAIN. Place in pot with fresh cold water. 5. Boil 15-20 min until fork-tender. 6. DRAIN. (You're throwing away the K-loaded water) 7. Mash with almond milk + margarine + seasonings

The science: Raw potatoes have ~900mg K per cup. Leaching (soaking + double-boiling) removes 40-50% of potassium. Final mashed potatoes: ~450-500mg K per cup. A reasonable serving (1/2 cup) = ~225-250mg K. That's manageable.

For both gravies: Pour white or brown gravy over the leached mashed potatoes. The whole plate together is a CKD-legal country dinner.

11. Backyard Baked Beans Dupe

Baked beans are EXTREMELY high-K (600mg+ per cup). This version uses a trick.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Canned white beans (cannellini)	1 can (15oz), DRAINED AND RINSED x3	Rinsing removes 30-40% of K + Na
No-salt-added tomato paste	2 tbsp	
Water	1/4 cup	
Brown sugar	2 tbsp	
Apple cider vinegar	1 tbsp	
Yellow mustard	1 tsp	
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	
Onion powder	1/2 tsp	
Smoked paprika	1/2 tsp	
Liquid smoke	1/4 tsp	
Turkey bacon	2 strips, chopped and cooked	
Cayenne	Pinch	

Method: 1. DRAIN + RINSE beans 3 times (critical for K reduction) 2. Mix tomato paste + water + brown sugar + vinegar + mustard + spices 3. Combine beans + sauce + bacon in oven-safe dish 4. Bake 350F 25-30 min until thick and bubbly

Per 1/2 cup: ~280mg K (vs regular baked beans: 400mg+). The triple-rinse is the difference.

12. Pulled Beef or Chicken (Slow Cooker)

Ingredient	Amount
Beef chuck roast or boneless chicken thighs	3-4 lbs
Homemade Cajun seasoning (above)	2 tbsp
Garlic powder	1 tsp
Onion, quartered	1
Apple cider vinegar	2 tbsp
Low-sodium beef or chicken broth	1/2 cup
CKD BBQ sauce (above)	For serving

Method: Rub meat with seasoning. Place in slow cooker with onion + vinegar + broth. Cook LOW 8-10 hours (beef) or 5-6 hours (chicken). Shred with two forks. Toss with BBQ sauce. Serve on sourdough buns with coleslaw.

DATE NIGHT

13. Steak Dinner (Andrew's Ultimate Meal)

Component	CKD Version
Steak	Ribeye or NY strip (6-8oz), seasoned with salt + pepper + garlic powder ONLY. Cast iron sear: avocado oil screaming hot, 3-4 min per side for medium-rare. Rest 5 min.
Compound butter	Margarine softened + minced garlic + fresh herbs (thyme, rosemary) + squeeze of lemon. Form into log, chill, slice medallion on top of resting steak.
Mashed potatoes	K-leached recipe above, piped through star tip for fancy presentation
Asparagus	Moderate K — 6 spears max. Roast 400F 12 min with olive oil + garlic.
Wine	Small glass (4oz). Red wine is lower K than white.

14. Shrimp Scampi

Ingredient	Amount
Large shrimp, peeled	1 lb
Olive oil	2 tbsp
Margarine	2 tbsp
Garlic	6 cloves, minced
Dry white wine	1/3 cup (or sub low-Na chicken broth)
Lemon juice	2 tbsp
Red pepper flakes	1/4 tsp

Ingredient	Amount
Fresh parsley	2 tbsp, chopped
GF or regular pasta (or rice)	8 oz

Method: Cook pasta. Heat oil + margarine. Saut garlic 1 min. Add shrimp, cook 2 min per side. Add wine + lemon + pepper flakes. Simmer 2 min. Toss with pasta. Top with parsley.

Shrimp is actually one of the LOWEST phosphorus proteins. Lower P than chicken. Andrew's #3 protein choice and perfect for date night.

15. Lobster Tail (Special Occasion)

Ingredient	Amount
Lobster tails	2 (6-8oz each)
Margarine, melted	3 tbsp
Garlic	2 cloves, minced
Lemon juice	1 tbsp
Paprika	1/4 tsp
Fresh parsley	Garnish

Method: Split lobster tails down the top. Gently pull meat up and rest on top of shell (butterfly style). Mix margarine + garlic + lemon + paprika. Brush over meat. Broil 8-10 min until meat is opaque and slightly charred on edges. Serve with remaining garlic margarine for dipping + lemon wedges.

STATE FAIR / SPECIAL OCCASION

16. Rosemary-Crusted Lamb Chops with Mint Jelly

Andrew requested. Lauren's favorite.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Rack of lamb (or 8 individual loin chops)	~2 lbs	Fresh, not pre-marinated — check for sodium phosphate
Panko breadcrumbs	1/2 cup	
Fresh rosemary, minced	1 tbsp	
Fresh thyme, minced	1 tbsp	
Garlic, minced	3 cloves	
Olive oil	2 tbsp	Binds the crust
Dijon mustard	1 tbsp	Thin coat — adhesive for crumbs
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	Lamb is naturally flavorful — needs less

Homemade Mint Jelly (not that neon abomination):

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Fresh mint leaves, packed	1 cup	
Apple juice (unsweetened)	1 cup	Lower K than grape juice
Sugar	1/4 cup	
Apple cider vinegar	2 tbsp	
Unflavored gelatin	1 packet (1/4 oz)	

Method — Lamb: 1. Season chops with salt + pepper. Let sit 20 min at room temp. 2. Mix breadcrumbs + rosemary + thyme + garlic + olive oil in a bowl. 3. Sear chops in screaming hot cast iron with avocado oil — 2 min per side. Remove. 4. Brush thin layer of Dijon on the meat side (not the bone). 5. Press herb-crumb mixture firmly onto the mustard. 6. Roast 400F for 12-15 min (medium-rare 130F internal). Rest 5 min.

Method — Mint Jelly: 1. Bring apple juice + vinegar + sugar to a boil. Stir until sugar dissolves. 2. Remove from heat. Add mint leaves. Steep 15 min (like tea). 3. Strain out mint. Return liquid to low heat. 4. Bloom gelatin in 2 tbsp cold water (1 min), then whisk into warm liquid. 5. Pour into small jar. Refrigerate 2+ hours until set. 6. Serve a spoonful alongside each chop. The color is natural pale green — real mint, not dye.

Per serving (2 chops + 1 tbsp jelly): ~160mg Na | ~190mg P | ~280mg K

17. Green Spark Chimichurri

Two versions. Both slap. Put it on anything that used to be alive.

Classic Green Chimichurri:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Fresh flat-leaf parsley, finely chopped	1 cup	Low K herb — the base
Fresh cilantro, finely chopped	1/2 cup	Optional — some people have the gene
Garlic, minced	4 cloves	
Red wine vinegar	3 tbsp	
Extra virgin olive oil	1/2 cup	The carrier
Dried oregano	1 tsp	
Red pepper flakes	1/2 tsp	
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	Barely any — the vinegar does the work

Red Chimichurri (variation):

Additional/Swap	Amount	CKD Notes
Roasted red pepper (jarred, drained + rinsed)	1/2 cup, finely diced	Rinse to cut Na from brine
Smoked paprika	1 tsp	Replaces some red pepper flakes
Fresh parsley	Reduce to 1/2 cup	Red pepper takes center stage

Method (both versions): 1. Combine all chopped herbs + garlic in a bowl. 2. Add vinegar + oil + spices. Stir. 3. That's it. No blender. No food processor. Knife and a cutting board. This is Argentine, not French. 4. Let sit 30 min minimum before serving — the flavors need to meet each other. 5. Keeps 5-7 days in the fridge. Gets better on day 2.

Pairs with: Steak (recipe #13), lamb chops (#16), grilled chicken, shrimp, roasted vegetables, eggs. Honestly — a spoon.

Per 1 tbsp (green): ~15mg Na | ~5mg P | ~20mg K **Per 1 tbsp (red):** ~20mg Na | ~6mg P | ~25mg K

18. County Fair Corn Dogs

Midway classic. Turkey dog, homemade batter, stick included. Dignity optional.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Turkey hot dogs	8	Lower Na/P than beef franks — still check label
All-purpose flour	1 cup	
Yellow cornmeal	3/4 cup	
Sugar	2 tbsp	
Phosphorus-free baking powder (Rumford)	1 tbsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Egg	1	
Unsweetened almond milk	3/4 cup	
Honey	1 tbsp	Helps browning
Avocado oil	For deep frying (3-4" deep)	
Wooden skewers or chopsticks	8	

Method: 1. Pat hot dogs VERY dry with paper towels. Insert sticks. Dust lightly with flour (batter won't stick to wet dogs). 2. Whisk flour + cornmeal + sugar + baking powder + salt. 3. Whisk egg + almond milk + honey. Combine wet into dry. Batter should be thick enough to coat — add flour if too thin. 4. Heat oil to 350F. Pour batter into a tall glass for easy dipping. 5. Dip each dog, twirl to coat evenly. Straight into oil. 6. Fry 3-4 min, turning once, until deep golden brown. 7. Drain on wire rack. Serve with yellow mustard (lowest Na condiment at the fair).

Per corn dog: ~280mg Na | ~95mg P | ~120mg K

19. Midway Funnel Cake

Fried dough with powdered sugar at a carnival. What exactly was the kidney problem here? Right — there wasn't one.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
All-purpose flour	1.5 cups	
Egg	1	
Sugar	2 tbsp	
Unsweetened almond milk	1 cup	Lower P than whole milk
Vanilla extract	1 tsp	
Phosphorus-free baking powder (Rumford)	1 tsp	
Salt	Pinch	
Avocado oil	For deep frying (1.5" deep)	
Powdered sugar	For dusting	

Method: 1. Whisk flour + sugar + baking powder + salt. 2. Beat egg + almond milk + vanilla. Pour into dry. Whisk until smooth — should be pourable like thin pancake batter. 3. Heat oil to 375F in a wide skillet or Dutch oven. 4. Pour batter into a squeeze bottle or funnel (or a zip-lock bag with the corner snipped). 5. Drizzle batter in a circular/crisscross pattern into hot oil. Work fast. 6. Fry 1-2 min per side until golden. Flip carefully with tongs + spatula. 7. Drain on wire rack. Blizzard of powdered sugar on top. Serve immediately.

Per funnel cake (1/4 batch): ~85mg Na | ~55mg P | ~70mg K — A lower-estimated-mineral dessert option; confirm the portion and ingredients against your plan.

20. Midway Fried Cookie Bites

The state fair food that shouldn't work but does. Surprisingly low in everything that matters.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Oreos	12	Regular, not double-stuf — P is in the filling
Pancake mix (just-add-water kind)	1 cup	Check label — avoid brands with sodium aluminum phosphate
Water	2/3 cup	Or per pancake mix instructions
Vanilla extract	1/2 tsp	
Avocado oil	For deep frying (2" deep)	
Powdered sugar	For dusting	

Method: 1. Heat oil to 350F. 2. Mix pancake batter with water + vanilla. Should coat a spoon thickly. 3. Freeze Oreos 15 min first (they hold up better in the fryer). 4. Dip each Oreo in batter, fully coating. Let excess drip off. 5. Fry 2-3 min, flipping once, until golden and puffed. 6. Drain on wire rack. Dust with powdered sugar while hot. 7. Eat within 5 minutes. These do not age well. They age like milk.

Per 2 deep fried Oreos: ~180mg Na | ~40mg P | ~55mg K

21. State Fair Turkey Legs

The food that makes you feel like Henry VIII at a Renaissance fair.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Turkey legs (drumsticks)	4 (~1 lb each)	Fresh, not pre-brined — this is critical
CKD Carnival Dry Rub:		
Smoked paprika	1 tbsp	
Brown sugar	1 tbsp	
Garlic powder	1 tsp	
Onion powder	1 tsp	
Black pepper	1 tsp	
Cumin	1/2 tsp	
Cayenne	1/4 tsp	
Chili powder	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/2 tsp	Split across 4 legs — minimal per serving

Method (Oven — no smoker needed): 1. Pat turkey legs dry. Coat generously with dry rub on all sides. Press it in. 2. Wrap each leg

individually in foil. 3. Bake 300F for 2.5 hours (low and slow — collagen breaks down, meat falls off the bone). 4. Unwrap. Brush with a thin coat of CKD BBQ sauce (recipe #9) if desired. 5. Broil 4-5 min until skin is dark and crispy, turning once. 6. Rest 5 min. Grab by the bone. Walk around your yard like you own the kingdom.

Smoker version: 250F for 3-4 hours over apple or cherry wood. Skip the foil. Spritz with apple juice every hour.

Per turkey leg: ~220mg Na | ~250mg P | ~380mg K — Turkey is LOWER in P than chicken breast, ounce for ounce.

22. Sweet-Salty Kettle Corn

Sweet, salty, crunchy, and one of the most kidney-friendly snacks on earth. Not a typo.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Popcorn kernels	1/3 cup	Plain popcorn: 1mg Na, 30mg P, 30mg K per cup
Avocado oil	3 tbsp	
Sugar	2 tbsp	Added right in the pot
Salt	1/4 tsp	Total. For the whole batch.

Method: 1. Heat oil in a large pot with a lid over medium-high. Toss in 3 test kernels. 2. When test kernels pop, add ALL remaining kernels + sugar + salt at once. 3. Shake the pot continuously (lid cracked for steam). The sugar caramelizes ON the kernels as they pop. 4. When popping slows to 2 seconds between pops, dump immediately into a large bowl. 5. Toss. Let cool 2 min (the sugar coating hardens). Eat by the fistful.

Per 3 cups: ~75mg Na | ~30mg P | ~35mg K — This is basically free food on a renal diet. Snack without guilt.

23. Street-Corner Elote

Grilled corn, creamy sauce, spice, lime. The cotija sub is the only detour — everything else is authentic.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Ears of corn, husked	6	Corn is moderate K — 1 ear is fine per serving
Avocado oil mayonnaise	3 tbsp	Lower Na than regular mayo
Cream cheese, softened	2 tbsp	Cotija substitute — similar tang, way less Na/P
Lime juice	2 tbsp	
Chili powder	1 tsp	
Smoked paprika	1/2 tsp	
Garlic powder	1/4 tsp	
Cayenne	1/4 tsp	
Fresh cilantro, chopped	2 tbsp	
Lime wedges	For serving	

Why cream cheese instead of cotija: Cotija has ~400mg Na per ounce. Cream cheese has ~85mg Na per ounce. Same creamy crumble effect when you dollop it on. Your tongue won't know. Your labs will.

Method: 1. Grill corn directly over high heat (or broil), turning every 2-3 min until charred in spots all around. ~8-10 min total. 2. Mix mayo + cream cheese + lime juice + chili powder + paprika + garlic powder + cayenne in a bowl. 3. While corn is hot, brush or smear the cream mixture all over each ear. 4. Sprinkle with extra chili powder + cilantro. Squeeze lime over the top. 5. Insert a stick or skewer in the bottom if you want the full street vendor experience.

Per ear: ~95mg Na | ~80mg P | ~240mg K

24. Lauren's Prosciutto & Brie Board (Date Night Fondue Prep)

"Twenty-four cheeses in the fridge at once. This is not a phase."

Component	What	Notes
Prosciutto	4 oz, thin-sliced, draped in rosettes	Lauren's favorite. The fancy fold matters.

Component	What	Notes
Brie	4 oz wedge, room temp 30 min	Let it breathe. Cold Brie is a crime.
Havarti	3 oz, sliced	Creamy, mild, Lauren-approved
Fresh mozzarella	4 oz, torn by hand	Burrata if New Seasons has it
Accompaniments	Marcona almonds, fig jam, honeycomb, Raincoast Crisps, champagne grapes, cornichons	The supporting cast

Assembly: Arrange on a slate or wooden board. Brie center stage. Prosciutto draped like fabric. Mozzarella torn, not sliced. Almonds scattered. Fig jam in a tiny bowl. Honeycomb broken, not cut. The board should look like it belongs in a magazine Lauren would actually buy.

CKD note for Andrew: Cheese is moderate-P. If sharing this board, Andrew sticks to 2-3 oz total cheese + prosciutto and loads up on crackers + fruit.

PIZZA

Saturday Supreme Pizza

The supreme was invented by Pizza Hut in 1958. "Supreme" just means "everything on it." The only pizza where olives are acceptable. — Andrew

Component	CKD Version
Dough	GF pizza dough (recipe in Ch 11) OR store-bought (check Na — Trader Joe's is lowest)
Sauce	Fresh blender marinara (recipe in Ch 8) — NOT jarred
Cheese	Shredded mozzarella (2/3 cup — controlled P)
Turkey pepperoni	15-20 slices — lower Na than pork pepperoni
Turkey sausage	1/4 cup crumbled, browned — homemade breakfast sausage (Ch 3)
Bell peppers	1/4 cup mixed colors, diced
Red onion	2 tbsp, thinly sliced
Mushrooms	1/4 cup, sliced
Black olives	2 tbsp sliced — the ONE place olives are allowed

Method: Stretch dough on oiled sheet pan or pizza stone. Spread sauce thin (1/3 cup — too much = soggy). Layer cheese, then ALL toppings. Bake 450F directly on stone/lowest rack, 12-15 min until crust is golden and cheese bubbles. The supreme doesn't hold back and neither should you.

Per 2 slices: ~280mg Na | ~180mg P | ~300mg K

Experimental Pizza Lab

The Breakfast Pizza Scrambled eggs + turkey sausage + sharp cheddar + hot sauce drizzle on pizza dough. Bake. Eat at noon. Call it breakfast.

The Mac & Cheese Pizza CKD mac & cheese (Ch 1) spread on pizza dough as the "sauce." Extra cheddar on top. Bake. The carb-on-carb crime that tastes like a warm hug.

The Taco Pizza Seasoned ground turkey + nacho cheese sauce (Ch 8) instead of marinara. Top with shredded lettuce + pico de gallo + sour cream AFTER baking. Taco Bell on a crust.

The Thai Peanut Pizza Peanut sauce (from PB&J chapter) as base instead of marinara. Chicken thighs + bean sprouts + cilantro + lime + sriracha drizzle. Southeast Asian decoder pizza.

The Dessert Pizza Sugar cookie dough pressed into pizza pan. Bake 350F 12 min. Spread cream cheese frosting. Top with fresh fruit (strawberries, blueberries, kiwi slices). Drizzle honey. The Vorathic Rainbow Dessert Pizza if you use all the colors.

The Hot Sauce Gauntlet Pizza 8 slices. Each slice gets a DIFFERENT hot sauce from the NorthStar lineup (Ch 9). Slice 1: Baby's Bathwater (mild). Slice 8: The Final Session (500K SHU). Eat in order. The pizza that's also a dare.

The Nothing Pizza Dough. Olive oil. Salt. Garlic. That's it. No sauce. No cheese. No toppings. Focaccia energy. The pizza equivalent of Recipe #42 — it orders you.

CKD Considerations for Soul Food

The reason these foods are "banned" is that RESTAURANT/PROCESSED versions are sodium and phosphorus bombs. Homemade versions with CKD substitutions are dramatically safer:

Swap	Why
Homemade seasoning → store packets	Eliminates 500-1000mg Na per serving
Margarine → butter	Lower P
Almond milk → whole milk	Lower P
Phosphorus-free baking powder → regular	Eliminates phosphorus additive
Leached potatoes → regular	Cuts K by 40-50%
Triple-rinsed canned beans → straight from can	Cuts K by 30-40%
Homemade BBQ sauce → store-bought	Cuts Na by 80%
Fresh chicken → "enhanced"/injected chicken	Eliminates sodium phosphate injection

The thesis: You don't have to eat like you're dying. You eat like you're LIVING. The restrictions are in the INGREDIENTS, not the RECIPES. Same plate, same flavors, same Saturday morning breakfast — different margarine, different milk, leached potatoes. Your kidneys can't tell the difference. Your taste buds can't either.

CHAPTER 3

Chicken & Protein Mains

"The KitchenAid grinder attachment earns its keep tonight."

Chicken Sausage Spaghetti, Chicken Tinga, Chicken Cacciatore, Steak Tacos w/ Pico

Plus: From-Scratch Sausage Grinding & Sauce Canning

"The KitchenAid grinder attachment earns its keep tonight."

1. Grinder-Night Chicken Sausage Spaghetti

From-Scratch Chicken Sausage (KitchenAid Grinder)

Making your own sausage = total sodium/phosphorus control. No preservatives, no mystery meat.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Chicken thighs, boneless skinless	2 lbs	Cut into 1" cubes, partially freeze 30 min (grinds better cold)
Garlic	4 cloves, minced	Mix into meat
Fresh basil	2 tbsp, chopped	
Fresh parsley	2 tbsp, chopped	
Dried oregano	1 tsp	
Fennel seeds	1 tsp, lightly crushed	THE Italian sausage flavor
Red pepper flakes	1/2 tsp	
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Paprika	1 tsp	
Salt	1/2 tsp (total — vs 800mg+ per link in store-bought)	
Olive oil	1 tbsp	

KitchenAid Grinder Method: 1. Cut chicken into 1" cubes. Spread on sheet pan, freeze 20-30 min (firm but not solid) 2. Set up KitchenAid with grinder attachment, medium plate 3. Mix all seasonings in a bowl 4. Feed

chicken through grinder into a large bowl 5. Add seasoning mix to ground chicken. Mix with hands until evenly distributed (don't overmix — gets tough) 6. Form into patties, links (using casings if you have them), or just crumble directly into the pan

Cooking: Brown sausage in skillet over medium-high, breaking into chunks, 6-8 min.

Per 4oz serving: ~120mg Na (vs store-bought ~600mg), ~180mg P, ~250mg K

Sunday Red Sauce (Canning-Ready)

Makes ~4 pints — can in mason jars for shelf storage

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
No-salt-added crushed tomatoes	1 can (28oz)	Lowest sodium option
No-salt-added tomato paste	2 tbsp	Concentrate flavor without more liquid K
Olive oil	2 tbsp	
Onion	1 medium, diced	
Garlic	6 cloves, minced	
Fresh basil	1/4 cup, torn	Add at end
Dried oregano	1 tsp	
Dried thyme	1/2 tsp	
Sugar	1 tsp	Balances acidity
Red pepper flakes	1/4 tsp	
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp only	
Bay leaf	1	Remove before canning

Method: 1. Saut?? onion in olive oil 5 min until soft 2. Add garlic, cook 1 min 3. Add tomato paste, stir 1 min (caramelizes) 4. Add crushed tomatoes, all dried spices, sugar, bay leaf 5. Simmer LOW 30-45 min, stirring occasionally 6. Remove bay leaf. Add fresh basil. 7. Taste — adjust salt/sugar/pepper

Canning (water bath method): 1. Sterilize mason jars + lids in boiling water 10 min 2. Add 1 tbsp lemon juice per pint jar (REQUIRED for acidity/safety) 3. Ladle hot sauce into hot jars, leave 1/2" headspace 4. Wipe rims. Apply lids + rings finger-tight 5. Process in boiling water bath: pints 35 min, quarts 40 min 6. Remove, cool undisturbed 12 hours. Check seal (lid shouldn't flex) 7. Sealed jars store 12-18 months at room temp

Per 1/2 cup sauce: ~45mg Na, ~30mg P, ~280mg K

Assembly

Cook spaghetti per package (no salt in the water — you don't need it). Toss with red sauce + crumbled chicken sausage. Top with a little shredded mozzarella if desired (small amount).

2. Smoky Chicken Tinga

Mexican shredded chicken in smoky chipotle tomato sauce — served in tacos, tostadas, or over rice

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Chicken thighs, boneless	1.5 lbs	Thighs stay moist when braised
No-salt-added diced tomatoes	1 can (14oz)	
Chipotle pepper in adobo	2 peppers + 1 tbsp sauce	From the can you added to cart
Onion	1 medium, sliced	
Garlic	4 cloves	
Oregano	1 tsp	Mexican oregano if available
Cumin	1/2 tsp	
Bay leaf	1	
Oil	1 tbsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Lime juice	1 tbsp (finish)	

Method: 1. Sear chicken thighs in oil 3 min per side (browning = flavor). Remove. 2. Same pan: cook onion 5 min. Add garlic 1 min. 3. Add diced tomatoes, chipotles + adobo sauce, oregano, cumin, bay leaf 4. Nestle chicken back in. Bring to simmer. 5. Cover. Low heat 25-30 min until chicken shreds easily 6. Remove chicken. Shred with two forks. 7. Return shredded chicken to sauce. Simmer uncovered 5 min to thicken 8. Remove bay leaf. Finish with lime juice.

Serve in: Guerrero corn tortillas, over rice, on tostadas, or in a bowl with sour cream + cilantro + pickled onion

Per serving (4 servings): ~200mg Na, ~190mg P, ~380mg K

3. Hunter's Chicken Cacciatore

Italian hunter's chicken — braised with tomatoes, olives, capers, peppers

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Chicken thighs, bone-in skin-on	4 pieces (~2 lbs)	Bone-in = more flavor. Remove skin after browning to cut fat if desired
No-salt-added crushed tomatoes	1 can (14oz)	
Bell pepper	1, sliced	Any color
Onion	1, sliced	
Garlic	4 cloves, sliced	
Black olives	1/4 cup, sliced	OPTIONAL — Andrew: skip (dislikes olive flavor)
Capers	1 tbsp, rinsed	RINSE to reduce sodium
Dry white wine	1/4 cup (or sub chicken broth)	Alcohol cooks off
Dried oregano	1 tsp	
Dried basil	1 tsp	
Red pepper flakes	1/4 tsp	
Fresh parsley	Garnish	
Oil	2 tbsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	

Method: 1. Season chicken lightly with salt + pepper. Brown skin-side down in oil 5 min. Flip 3 min. Remove. 2. Same pan: cook onion + bell pepper 5 min 3. Add garlic 1 min 4. Deglaze with wine, scrape up browned bits 5. Add crushed tomatoes, oregano, basil, red pepper flakes 6. Nestle chicken back in, skin-side up 7. Add capers (skip olives per Andrew preference) around chicken 8. Cover. Simmer 30-35 min until chicken is 165F and falling off bone 9. Garnish with parsley

Serve over: Spaghetti, rice, or with crusty bread

Per serving (4 servings): ~250mg Na, ~220mg P, ~420mg K

4. Midnight Steak Tacos with Pico de Gallo

The Steak

Ingredient	Amount
Flank steak	1 lb
Lime juice	2 tbsp
Garlic	3 cloves, minced
Cumin	1 tsp
Chili powder	1 tsp
Paprika	1/2 tsp
Oil	1 tbsp
Salt	1/4 tsp
Black pepper	1/2 tsp

Marinate steak minimum 30 min (overnight better). Grill or cast-iron sear over HIGH heat 4-5 min per side for medium. Rest 5 min. Slice THIN against the grain.

Fresh Pico de Gallo

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Fresh tomato	1 medium, diced small	Moderate K — one tomato across 4 servings = controlled

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
White onion	1/4 cup, finely diced	Low K
Cilantro	1/4 cup, chopped	
jalapeño	1, seeded and minced	Seeds out = less heat, the pepper amount is nutritionally tiny
Lime juice	2 tbsp	
Salt	Pinch	

Mix everything. Let sit 15 min for flavors to meld. Best fresh, same day.

Per 1/4 cup pico: ~80mg K, ~8mg P, ~25mg Na

Assembly

Guerrero corn tortillas (warmed on dry skillet 30 sec per side) → sliced steak → pico → squeeze of lime → optional sour cream drizzle

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Hot sauce recipes are in the Hot Sauces chapter — 30+ sauces across three lineups.

6. FROM-SCRATCH SAUSAGE GRINDING & STORAGE

KitchenAid Grinder Setup

1. Attach grinder to KitchenAid stand mixer
2. Use **medium grinding plate** for Italian-style sausage (coarse for breakfast, fine for hot dogs)
3. Keep meat COLD — partially freeze 20-30 min before grinding
4. Cut into 1" cubes that fit the feed tube
5. Run through once for standard texture, twice for smoother

Sausage Flavors to Grind

Italian Sweet (chicken or turkey)

Fennel seeds + garlic + basil + parsley + paprika + black pepper

Italian Hot

Same as sweet + red pepper flakes + cayenne

Breakfast Style (Andrew's Favorite — Costco/Inesto's Clone)

"The link that makes the whole plate make sense."

Ingredient	Amount
Chicken thighs, boneless	2 lbs, cubed + partially frozen
Sage (dried, rubbed)	1 tbsp
Thyme (dried)	1 tsp
Black pepper	1 tsp
Brown sugar	1 tbsp
Nutmeg	1/4 tsp
Costco no-salt seasoning blend	1 tsp (or sub garlic powder 1/2 tsp + onion powder 1/2 tsp)
Cayenne	1/4 tsp
Salt	1/2 tsp
Maple syrup	1 tsp (optional — maple breakfast sausage variant)

Grind chicken through medium plate. Mix in all seasonings by hand. Form into 2oz patties or links. Pan-fry in avocado oil 3-4 min per side until 165F.

Per 2oz patty: ~80mg Na | ~90mg P | ~130mg K (vs Costco/store: ~400mg Na)

Sausage Gravy (Biscuits & Gravy)

Ingredient	Amount
Chicken breakfast sausage (above)	4 patties, crumbled
All-purpose flour	3 tbsp
Unsweetened almond milk	2 cups
Black pepper	1/2 tsp (generous)

Ingredient	Amount
Garlic powder	1/4 tsp
Salt	1/4 tsp

Method: Brown crumbled sausage in skillet. Add flour, stir 1 min. Slowly add almond milk, whisking. Simmer until thick. Season. Serve over CKD biscuits (recipe in soul food chapter).

Thanksgiving Turkey-Sausage Stuffing

"The stuffing that earns the bird's respect."

Ingredient	Amount
Chicken or turkey breakfast sausage (above)	1 lb, crumbled and browned
Sourdough bread, cubed and dried	6 cups
Onion, diced	1 medium
Celery, diced	2 stalks
Margarine	3 tbsp
Low-sodium chicken broth	1.5 cups
Fresh sage	1 tbsp, chopped
Fresh thyme	1 tsp
Black pepper	1/2 tsp
Salt	1/4 tsp
Egg	1, beaten

Method: Sauté onion + celery in margarine 5 min. Combine with bread cubes, browned sausage, herbs, pepper. Toss with broth + egg until evenly moist. Transfer to greased baking dish. Bake 375F 30-35 min until golden top. The sausage makes this — every bite has sage and thyme and meat.

Per serving (8 servings): ~180mg Na | ~140mg P | ~200mg K

Mexican Chorizo Style

Chili powder + paprika + cumin + oregano + garlic + vinegar

Thai Basil (fusion)

Thai basil + lemongrass (minced fine) + garlic + ginger + lime zest + chili flakes

Storage

- **Fresh (fridge):** Use within 3 days in sealed container
- **Frozen patties:** Form into 3oz patties, separate with parchment, freeze in ziplock. Good 3 months.
- **Vacuum sealed:** If you get a vacuum sealer, frozen sausage keeps 6+ months
- **Casings (optional):** Natural hog casings from the butcher counter. Soak 30 min in water, feed onto grinder stuffing tube, fill while grinding. Twist into links every 5-6".

CKD Advantage of Homemade Sausage

	Store-Bought (per link)	Homemade (per link)
Sodium	500-800mg	80-120mg
Phosphorus	200-350mg	150-180mg
Preservatives	Nitrites, phosphates, MSG	NONE
Cost	\$1.50-2.50/link	~\$0.80/link

You control EVERYTHING. No hidden sodium phosphate (a common meat preservative that's a kidney killer). No nitrites. No mystery.

CKD Considerations

RENAL CHECK — Chicken Mains
K (Potassium): MED (no-salt-added tomato products, controlled portions)
P (Phosphorus): LOW-MED (homemade sausage = no phosphate preservatives)
Na (Sodium): LOW (homemade everything, no-salt-added canned goods)
Protein: GOOD (chicken thighs = quality renal protein)

"The KitchenAid earned its spot on the counter tonight. Every link is a ceremony."

Tex-Mex & Fast Food Dupes

“Cravings don’t negotiate.”

Renal-Aware Fast Food at Home

"Cravings don't negotiate."

Why Taco Bell Dupes?

Taco Bell is one of the most CKD-hostile fast food chains: high sodium (1000-2000mg per item), high phosphorus (cheese, beans, processed meat), high potassium (tomatoes, beans, guac). A single Crunchwrap Supreme has more sodium than most people on a renal diet should eat in an ENTIRE DAY.

These dupes recreate the flavor and experience with renal-aware substitutions.

The Recipes

1. Bellbreaker Crunchwrap

The original: ~1,300mg sodium, ~400mg phosphorus **The dupe:** ~450mg sodium, ~180mg phosphorus

Component	Original	CKD Dupe
Tortilla	12" flour tortilla	12" low-sodium flour tortilla (Mission low-sodium)
Meat	Seasoned ground beef	Ground turkey + homemade taco seasoning (cumin, paprika, garlic, onion powder, oregano — NO packet mix, packets are sodium bombs)
Nacho cheese	Nacho cheese sauce	Homemade cheese sauce: cream cheese + a little cheddar + milk + paprika, melted (cream cheese is lower P than processed cheese)
Sour cream	Regular sour cream	Regular sour cream (actually CKD-okay in small amounts)
Tostada shell	Flat tostada	Baked corn tortilla round (lower sodium than store tostada)
Lettuce	Iceberg	Iceberg (fine — low K, low P)
Tomato	Diced tomato	SKIP or use 1 tbsp max (tomatoes are high-K) — sub with diced bell pepper for crunch+color

Assembly: Tortilla flat → meat → cheese sauce → tostada shell → sour cream → lettuce → pepper. Fold edges in, flip seam-down, toast in dry skillet 2 min per side.

Per serving: ~450mg Na, ~180mg P, ~280mg K

2. Soft-Crunch Gordita

Component	CKD Dupe
Outer flatbread	Low-sodium flour tortilla, warmed
Spicy ranch	Avocado oil mayo + a pinch of cayenne + garlic powder + dried dill
Inner taco shell	Regular hard taco shell (moderate sodium, 1 is okay)
Meat	Turkey taco meat (same seasoning as above)
Three cheese blend	Small amount of cheddar + cream cheese blend (portion control)
Lettuce	Iceberg shredded

3. Borderline Mexican Pizza

Component	CKD Dupe
Pizza "crust"	Two flour tortillas, brushed with oil, baked crispy at 400F for 5 min
Beef layer	Turkey taco meat
Bean layer	SKIP refried beans (very high K+P) — use a thin layer of cream cheese as the "glue" instead
Pizza sauce	1 tbsp low-sodium marinara (not more — tomato = K)
Cheese	Small amount of shredded cheddar
Toppings	Diced green onion (low K), diced bell pepper, a few black olive slices

Bake assembled pizza at 400F for 8-10 min until cheese melts and tortilla is crispy.

4. Griddle-Melt Chicken Quesadilla

Component	CKD Dupe
Tortilla	Low-sodium flour tortilla
Chicken	Plain grilled chicken breast, shredded (no pre-marinated — marinades are sodium bombs)
Cheese	Cream cheese + small amount of mozzarella (lower P than cheddar)
Creamy jalapeño sauce	Avocado oil mayo + a few drops of jalapeño hot sauce + garlic powder

Cook in skillet with light oil spray, 3 min per side until golden and cheese melts.

5. Five-Layer Beef Burrito

Component	CKD Dupe
Tortilla	Large low-sodium flour tortilla
Beef	Turkey taco meat
Beans	SKIP (too high K+P) — add extra rice instead
Rice	White rice (renal-aware, low K when cooked)
Sour cream	Regular sour cream, 2 tbsp
Nacho cheese	Homemade cream cheese sauce

6. Big Bell Nachos

Component	CKD Dupe
Chips	Unsalted tortilla chips (or low-sodium)
Beef	Turkey taco meat
Beans	SKIP
Cheese	Homemade cream cheese sauce drizzled
Sour cream	Dollop
Tomato	1 tbsp max diced, or sub diced bell pepper
Green onion	Small amount (low K)

7. Cinnamon Cloud Bites

Component	CKD Dupe
Dough	Bisquick (phosphorus-free baking powder version) + milk + sugar, rolled into balls
Filling	Cream cheese + powdered sugar + vanilla
Coating	Cinnamon sugar (Ceylon cinnamon — Cinnamon Cloud crossover!)

Scoop dough, press flat, add cream cheese filling, seal into ball, deep fry at 350F for 2-3 min until golden. Roll in cinnamon sugar while warm.

8. Baja Storm Freeze

The original: Mountain Dew Baja Blast + ice **The CKD issue:** Phosphoric acid in Mountain Dew is a phosphorus source + high sugar + fluid counts

Component	CKD Dupe
Base	Sprite Zero or 7UP Zero (no phosphoric acid, unlike Dew)
Color	Blue food coloring + green food coloring (2 drops each for the teal)
Flavor	Lime juice (1 tbsp) + a few drops of pineapple extract
Freeze	Blend with ice, serve in clear cup

Fluid note: This counts toward daily fluid restriction. Make it a treat, not a daily thing. ~8oz serving.

The Master Taco Seasoning (make a jar, use for everything)

Spice	Amount	Notes
Cumin	3 tbsp	The backbone
Paprika	2 tbsp	Color + mild heat
Garlic powder	1 tbsp	Not garlic salt!
Onion powder	1 tbsp	Not onion salt!
Oregano	1 tsp	Mexican oregano if you can find it

Spice	Amount	Notes
Cayenne	1/2 tsp	Adjust to heat preference
Black pepper	1 tsp	
Coriander	1/2 tsp	Optional — adds authenticity

NO SALT in this mix. The whole point is controlling sodium yourself. Store in a jar. Use 2 tbsp per pound of meat + 1/4 cup water, simmer until absorbed.

Masa Press Lab: Tortilla Press Technique + Four Masa Harina Colors

White, yellow, blue, and red masa harina behave like siblings, not clones. The press is simple; the hydration is the craft.

Tortilla Press Setup

Tool	Best Setup	Why It Matters
Tortilla press	Cast iron or aluminum press on a stable counter	Even pressure. Do not crank the handle like a clamp; press in stages.
Liners	Cut a zip-top freezer bag into two thick plastic sheets	Better than flimsy wrap. Peels cleanly without tearing the masa.
Scale	35g balls for street tacos, 45-50g for 6 inch tortillas	Consistent balls make consistent cook times.
Comal or skillet	Dry cast iron, carbon steel, or heavy nonstick	No oil for tortillas. Heat and steam create the puff.
Towel warmer	Clean towel in a covered bowl or tortilla keeper	Steam finishes the tortilla and keeps it flexible.

Master Press Technique

- Hydrate by feel, not just by the cup.** Start with the recipe amount below, mix with your hand, then add warm water 1 tsp at a time until the dough feels like soft Play-Doh. It should not crumble at the edges or smear wet onto your palm.
- Rest the dough.** Cover 20-30 minutes. Masa harina keeps drinking water after mixing. Blue and red masa usually need the full 30 minutes.
- Re-check hydration after resting.** Pinch a golf-ball-size piece and flatten it between your palms. Cracked edge = add water. Sticky surface = dust in 1 tsp masa harina and wait 5 minutes.
- Roll smooth balls.** No cracks before pressing. A cracked ball becomes a cracked tortilla.
- Press in two light passes.** Place the ball slightly behind center, close press gently, open, rotate the plastic 180 degrees, press again. This keeps the tortilla round and avoids one thick edge.
- Peel plastic from tortilla, not tortilla from plastic.** Hold the tortilla flat on your palm and pull the plastic away slowly. If it tears, the dough is too wet, too dry, or unrested.
- Cook hot and fast.** Preheat until a drop of water skates. Cook side 1 for 20-30 seconds, flip, cook side 2 for 45-60 seconds, flip again and press gently with a spatula for 15-30 seconds. Puff is the win.
- Steam stack immediately.** Move each tortilla into a towel-lined bowl and cover. Ten minutes in its own steam makes it bend instead of crack.

Heat Target

Medium-high is usually right: about 425-475F surface heat. Too cool gives pale, dry tortillas. Too hot burns spots before the center sets. The first tortilla is the test tortilla; adjust before making the whole batch.

White Masa Harina Tortillas

Ingredient	Amount	Notes
White masa harina	2 cups	Clean baseline flavor; best for tacos and enchiladas.
Warm water	1 1/2 cups, plus 1-3 tbsp as needed	Warm tap water hydrates faster than cold.
Fine salt	1/4 tsp optional	Skip or reduce for stricter sodium days.
Avocado oil	1 tsp optional	Not traditional; helps flexibility for beginners.

Method: Mix, rest 20 minutes, portion into 12 balls, press, cook hot, steam stack. Best use: everyday taco, quesadilla, enchilada dip-and-roll.

Yellow Masa Harina Tortillas

Ingredient	Amount	Notes
Yellow masa harina	2 cups	More roasted-corn aroma and deeper color.
Warm water	1 2/3 cups, plus 1-2 tbsp as needed	Yellow often drinks slightly more water than white.
Fine salt	1/4 tsp optional	Optional.
Avocado oil	1 tsp optional	Useful if making tostadas or reheating later.

Method: Same as white, but rest 25 minutes. Best use: crunchy tacos, tostadas, tortilla chips, breakfast chilaquiles.

Blue Masa Harina Tortillas

Ingredient	Amount	Notes
Blue masa harina	2 cups	Earthier, nuttier, more dramatic on camera.
Warm water	1 3/4 cups, plus 1-4 tbsp as needed	Blue masa usually needs more hydration and longer rest.
Fine salt	1/4 tsp optional	Optional.
Lime juice	1/2 tsp optional	Brightens flavor; keep tiny so the dough does not tighten.

Method: Mix thoroughly, rest 30 minutes, press slightly thicker than white masa, cook 5-10 seconds longer per side. Best use: steak tacos, photo plates, tostadas, three-color tortilla flights.

Red Masa Harina Tortillas

Ingredient	Amount	Notes
Red corn masa harina	2 cups	If you have true red masa harina, use it straight.
Warm water	1 2/3 to 1 3/4 cups	Hydrate like blue masa: patient and warm.
Fine salt	1/4 tsp optional	Optional.
Avocado oil	1 tsp optional	Helps flexibility.

If you only have white or yellow masa: make red adobo masa with 2 cups masa harina, 1 2/3 cups warm water, 1 tbsp mild chile powder or paprika, 1 tsp annatto or achiote powder, 1/4 tsp cumin, and 1 tsp vinegar. Rest 30 minutes. This is not true red corn, but it gives the red taco-shop look and a gentle chile aroma.

Tostadas, Chips, and Taco Shells

Cook tortillas first, then crisp them. Raw pressed masa does not become a good chip. For tostadas, dry cooked tortillas uncovered 20-30 minutes, then fry at 350F until rigid and lightly browned, or brush with oil and bake at 375F for 10-14 minutes, flipping once. For crunchy taco shells, fry a cooked tortilla 10 seconds flat, fold with tongs, then hold open in the oil until crisp.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Cause	Fix
Cracked edge after pressing	Dough too dry or unrested	Knead in water 1 tsp at a time; rest 10 more minutes.
Sticks to plastic	Dough too wet	Dust in masa harina 1 tsp at a time; wait 5 minutes.
No puff	Heat too low, tortilla too dry, or first side cooked too long	Raise heat; cook first side only until dry spots appear.
Hard after cooking	Overcooked or left uncovered	Shorten cook time and steam stack immediately.
One side thick	Ball centered wrong or one heavy press	Place ball slightly behind center; press, rotate, press again.

RENAL CHECK - Masa Press Lab
K (Potassium): LOW-MED by portion; corn is usually manageable in small tortillas.
P (Phosphorus): LOW-MED; avoid phosphate-added packaged tortillas when possible.
Na (Sodium): CONTROLLED; salt is optional and can be skipped.
Fluid: Water in dough mostly cooks off, but count beverages served with the meal.

MEXICAN RESTAURANT DUPES

9. Carne Asada Fry Plate

Origin: San Diego, CA — emerged from taco shops in the 1990s as border-town street food. Now a stadium staple from Petco Park to backyard parties.

Component	CKD Dupe
Fries	Russet potatoes, peeled, cut into fries, soaked in water 4+ hours (K-leaching — pulls out ~50% potassium), drained, patted dry, fried in avocado oil at 375F until crispy
Carne asada	Flank steak marinated in Master Carne Asada Marinade (Recipe 14 below), grilled hot and fast, sliced thin against the grain
Nacho cheese	Homemade cheese sauce (Ch 8 recipe — cream cheese + cheddar + milk + paprika)
Sour cream	Regular sour cream, 2 tbsp
Pico de gallo	2 tbsp max — diced tomato + white onion + cilantro + lime juice + pinch of salt (portion-controlled for K)
Guacamole	1/4 avocado mashed with lime juice + cilantro + pinch of garlic powder (small portion — avocado is high-K, but 1/4 is manageable)

Assembly: Fries on plate → sliced carne asada → drizzle cheese sauce → dollops of sour cream + guac → scatter pico. Eat immediately.

Per serving: ~480mg Na | ~200mg P | ~520mg K

10. Sizzle Plate Carne Asada

Origin: The standard plate at every taqueria from Tijuana to East LA — meat, rice, beans, tortillas. Simple. Complete.

Component	CKD Dupe
Carne asada	Flank steak, Master Marinade (Recipe 14), grilled, sliced against the grain
Spanish rice	White rice cooked with 1 tbsp no-salt-added tomato sauce + cumin + garlic powder + onion powder + avocado oil. Low-sodium chicken broth or water as liquid
Refried beans	Canned pinto beans — drain, rinse 3x thoroughly (removes ~40% sodium + potassium), mash in skillet with avocado oil + cumin + garlic powder. No lard
Tortillas	Guerrero corn tortillas (corn, water, lime — 3 ingredients, low sodium)
Pico de gallo	2 tbsp, same as Recipe 9

Plate it: Steak sliced fanned on one side, rice + beans side by side, two warm corn tortillas, pico on top of the meat. Lime wedge on the side.

Per serving: ~440mg Na | ~220mg P | ~580mg K

11. Green-Chile Chicken Enchiladas

Origin: Enchiladas predate the Spanish conquest — Aztec markets in Tenochtitlan served tortillas dipped in chili sauce. The cream-cheese filling twist is Tex-Mex, circa 1960s-70s.

Component	CKD Dupe
Tortillas	Guerrero corn tortillas, lightly fried in avocado oil to soften (5 seconds per side)
Filling	Shredded chicken breast (poached or baked, no marinade packets) + 2 oz cream cheese per 4 enchiladas, mixed together
Enchilada sauce	1 can (8 oz) no-salt-added tomato sauce + 1 tbsp chili powder + 1 tsp cumin + 1/2 tsp garlic powder + 1/2 tsp oregano + 1/4 tsp cayenne + 1/4 cup water. Simmer 10 min
Cheese topping	Shredded cheddar, light layer (~1 oz per 2 enchiladas — portion control keeps P in check)

Assembly: Dip each softened tortilla in warm enchilada sauce. Fill with chicken-cream cheese mixture, roll seam-down in baking dish. Pour remaining sauce over top, sprinkle cheddar. Bake 375F for 20 min until bubbly.

Makes 4 enchiladas (2 per serving).

Per serving (2 enchiladas): ~390mg Na | ~210mg P | ~420mg K

12. Mazatlan Fajita Burrito

Origin: Named for Mazatlan Mexican Restaurant — the kind of neighborhood spot where the burrito is the size of your forearm and one

order is two meals. Sinaloan port-city energy, Pacific coast heat.

Component	CKD Dupe
Tortilla	Large (12") flour tortilla (regular — one tortilla's sodium is acceptable in context)
Chicken	Boneless skinless chicken thighs (more flavor than breast, similar renal profile), sliced thin, seasoned with homemade fajita seasoning: 1 tsp cumin + 1 tsp chili powder + 1 tsp paprika + 1/2 tsp garlic powder + 1/2 tsp onion powder + 1/2 tsp oregano. Grilled or pan-seared in avocado oil, high heat
Peppers + onions	Sliced bell peppers (green + red) + white onion, sauteed in avocado oil until charred edges, still crisp
Rice	White rice, plain or Spanish-style (same as Recipe 10)
Cheese	Shredded cheddar or Monterey Jack, ~1 oz
Sour cream	2 tbsp inside the wrap

Assembly: Warm tortilla on dry skillet. Layer: rice down the center → chicken → peppers and onions → cheese → sour cream. Fold bottom up, sides in, roll tight. Cut in half on the bias. Serve with a lime wedge.

Per serving (1 burrito): ~520mg Na | ~240mg P | ~490mg K

13. Lauren's Warm Campechana

Origin: Campechana is a Gulf Coast Mexican seafood cocktail from Campeche/Veracruz — traditionally served cold in a copa. Lauren's version is served warm, which changes the whole character. The heat opens up the citrus and softens the seafood without making it rubbery.

Component	CKD Dupe
Shrimp	1/2 lb medium shrimp, peeled and deveined, poached in lightly salted water until just pink (~3 min), chopped
Crab	4 oz imitation crab (surimi) — lower phosphorus than real crab, or use real lump crab if budget allows (portion-control for P)
Cocktail sauce base	1 cup no-salt-added tomato sauce + 1 tbsp lime juice + 1 tsp hot sauce (or to taste) + 1/2 tsp cumin. Warm in saucepan over medium heat
Avocado	1/4 avocado, diced (portion-controlled for K)
Vegetables	2 tbsp diced white onion + 2 tbsp diced cucumber + 1 tbsp diced jalapeno (seeded) + 2 tbsp chopped cilantro
Citrus	Juice of 1 lime, plus wedges for serving

Assembly: Warm the tomato sauce base in a saucepan. Add chopped shrimp and crab, stir gently, heat through 2 min (do not boil — keeps the seafood tender). Remove from heat, fold in onion, cucumber, jalapeno, cilantro, avocado, lime juice. Serve warm in a bowl or copa glass with tostadas or low-sodium crackers on the side.

The "warm not cold" move: Heating the cocktail base first and adding the seafood to it — instead of chilling everything — blooms the cumin and lime, gives it a soup-adjacent comfort without losing the bright acidity. Lauren's call.

Per serving: ~380mg Na | ~190mg P | ~450mg K

14. Citrus Fire Carne Asada Marinade

Origin: Every taqueria has a version. The lime-soy-cilantro trinity is northern Mexico meets Pacific Rim — the soy sauce arrived via Chinese immigrants in Baja California in the 1800s and never left.

Ingredient	Amount	Notes
Lime juice	1/4 cup (fresh)	The acid — tenderizes + brightens. Andrew's sour/citrus preference lives here
Low-sodium soy sauce	2 tbsp	Umami depth without the sodium bomb of regular soy (~50% less Na)
Garlic	4 cloves, minced	Fresh, not powder — marinade wants the moisture
Cilantro	1/4 cup, chopped	Stems included — that's where the flavor hides
Cumin	1 tsp	Warmth
Chili powder	1 tsp	Heat + color
Avocado oil	2 tbsp	Carries the fat-soluble flavors into the meat
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	No salt needed — the soy and lime do the work

Method: Whisk everything together. Place flank steak in a zip-lock bag or glass dish, pour marinade over, coat all surfaces. Refrigerate minimum 2

hours, overnight is better. Remove from fridge 30 min before grilling.

Grilling: Hottest part of the grill (or cast iron screaming hot with avocado oil). 4-5 min per side for medium-rare on a 1-inch flank steak. Rest 5 min. Slice thin, against the grain, on the bias.

Yield: Enough for 1.5-2 lbs flank steak (4 servings).

Per serving (marinade contribution only): ~180mg Na | ~30mg P | ~90mg K

CKD Considerations (every recipe)

RENAL CHECK – Taco Bell CKD Dupes (Recipes 1-8)
K (Potassium): LOW-MED (beans removed, tomato minimized)
P (Phosphorus): LOW-MED (cream cheese over cheddar, no processed cheese)
Na (Sodium): LOW (no-salt seasoning, low-sodium tortillas)
Fluid: Count beverages toward daily limit
Protein: MODERATE (turkey is good renal protein)

RENAL CHECK – Mexican Restaurant Dupes (Recipes 9-14)
K (Potassium): MED (K-leached potatoes, portion-controlled avocado/tomato, triple-rinsed beans)
P (Phosphorus): LOW-MED (cream cheese sauces, cheddar portion-controlled, fresh proteins over processed)
Na (Sodium): LOW-MED (low-sodium soy in marinade, no-salt-added tomato sauce, homemade seasoning throughout)
Fluid: Campechana broth counts toward daily limit
Protein: MODERATE-HIGH (flank steak, chicken thighs, shrimp – all quality renal proteins)

"The Drive-Thru closed. Your kitchen opened."

REESER'S BURRITO DUPES

Reeser's Fine Foods has been making frozen burritos in Topeka, Kansas since 1969 — the same year as the moon landing.

15. Reeser's Red Hot Beef Burrito

"Reeser's first plant opened at 31st and Topeka Blvd — a building that had been a dairy. By the mid-1970s they were shipping a million burritos a week across the Great Plains."

The original: Gas station legend. Red chile sauce, seasoned beef, processed cheese, flour tortilla. ~900mg sodium, ~350mg phosphorus per burrito. **The dupe:** ~380mg sodium, ~160mg phosphorus

Component	Original	CKD Dupe
Tortilla	10" flour tortilla	10" low-sodium flour tortilla
Meat	Seasoned ground beef	Ground turkey, browned and drained, seasoned with Master Taco Seasoning (2 tbsp per lb)
Red chile sauce	Processed red chile sauce (sodium bomb + phosphate additives)	Homemade CKD red chile sauce (see below)
Cheese	Processed cheese food	Cream cheese (2 tbsp per burrito) — lower P than processed cheese, melts smooth

Homemade CKD Red Chile Sauce:

Ingredient	Amount	Notes
No-salt-added tomato sauce	1 cup (8 oz can)	Controls sodium — regular tomato sauce has 600mg+ Na per cup
Chili powder	1 tbsp	The heat backbone
Cumin	1 tsp	Warmth + earthiness
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	Not garlic salt
Onion powder	1/2 tsp	Depth
Cayenne	1/4 tsp	Adjust up for more heat — the original is SPICY
Water	2 tbsp	Thin to saucy consistency

Whisk all together in a small saucepan, simmer 5 min. Makes enough for 4-5 burritos.

Method: Spoon ~3 tbsp turkey down the center of the tortilla. Drizzle 2 tbsp red chile sauce over the meat. Add 2 tbsp cream cheese in small dollops. Fold bottom up, sides in, roll tight. Wrap individually in foil. **Bake at 375F for 20 min OR microwave unwrapped on a plate for 2 min**, flipping halfway.

Per serving (1 burrito): ~380mg Na | ~160mg P | ~290mg K

16. Reeser's BBQ Beef Burrito

"Reeser's BBQ variant showed up in the early 1980s — Kansas is barbecue country, and someone in Topeka figured if you could put red chile in a tortilla, you could put KC-style sweet smoke in one too."

The original: Sweet-tangy BBQ sauce, seasoned beef, flour tortilla. ~850mg sodium, ~330mg phosphorus. **The dupe:** ~360mg sodium, ~155mg phosphorus

Component	Original	CKD Dupe
Tortilla	10" flour tortilla	10" low-sodium flour tortilla
Meat	Seasoned ground beef	Ground turkey, browned and drained, seasoned with Master Taco Seasoning (light hand — 1 tbsp per lb, the BBQ sauce carries the flavor)
BBQ sauce	Processed BBQ sauce (high-fructose corn syrup + sodium + phosphates)	Homemade CKD-aware BBQ sauce (see below)
Cheese	Processed cheese food	Cream cheese (2 tbsp per burrito)

Homemade CKD-Aware BBQ Sauce:

Ingredient	Amount	Notes
No-salt-added ketchup OR no-salt-added tomato paste	1/2 cup ketchup or 3 tbsp paste + 1/4 cup water	Tomato paste is more concentrated — either works
Brown sugar	2 tbsp (packed)	The KC-style sweetness
Apple cider vinegar	1 tbsp	Tang — the soul of BBQ sauce
Smoked paprika	1 tsp	Smoke without the sodium of liquid smoke
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	
Onion powder	1/2 tsp	
Worcestershire sauce	1/2 tsp	Just a whisper — Worcestershire has sodium but 1/2 tsp across the whole batch is negligible
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	
Cayenne	Pinch	Optional heat

Whisk all together in a small saucepan, simmer 5-8 min until thickened slightly. Makes enough for 4-5 burritos.

Method: Same as Recipe 15. Spoon ~3 tbsp turkey down the center, drizzle 2 tbsp BBQ sauce, add 2 tbsp cream cheese. Fold, roll, wrap in foil. **Bake at 375F for 20 min OR microwave unwrapped 2 min**, flipping halfway.

Per serving (1 burrito): ~360mg Na | ~155mg P | ~280mg K

17. Reeser's Bean & Cheese Burrito

"The bean and cheese is the oldest burrito format in the Americas — pre-Columbian Mesoamerican people wrapped beans in corn flatbreads centuries before flour tortillas existed. Reeser's just figured out how to freeze it and sell it at a Shell station."

The original: Refried beans, processed cheese, flour tortilla. ~780mg sodium, ~300mg phosphorus, ~450mg potassium. **The dupe:** ~340mg Na, ~150mg P, ~310mg K

Component	Original	CKD Dupe
Tortilla	10" flour tortilla	10" low-sodium flour tortilla
Beans	Refried beans (high Na, high K, high P)	Triple-rinsed pinto beans, mashed (see K-management note below)
Cheese	Processed cheese food	Cream cheese (2 tbsp) + small amount of shredded cheddar (~1 tbsp) for flavor contrast

Bean Prep — K-Management Protocol:

- Start with canned pinto beans (low-sodium if available, but regular works because you're rinsing)
- Drain ALL liquid — the canning liquid is where most of the sodium hides
- Rinse under cold running water in a colander for 30 seconds
- Soak in fresh cold water for 5 minutes
- Drain and rinse again — two more times (three total rinses)

6. **This triple-rinse removes approximately 40% of potassium and 40-50% of sodium**
7. Mash beans in a skillet with 1 tsp avocado oil + 1/2 tsp cumin + 1/4 tsp garlic powder. Add water 1 tbsp at a time to reach refried consistency
- CKD Note on Beans:** Beans are the most misunderstood renal food. The National Kidney Foundation updated guidance — properly prepared beans CAN fit a renal diet. The triple-rinse + portion control (1/4 cup per burrito) keeps K and P in the safe zone. Don't skip the rinse steps.
- Method:** Spoon ~1/4 cup mashed beans down the center. Add 2 tbsp cream cheese in dollops + sprinkle of cheddar. Fold, roll, wrap in foil.
- Bake at 375F for 20 min OR microwave unwrapped 2 min**, flipping halfway.
- Per serving (1 burrito):** ~340mg Na | ~150mg P | ~310mg K

MEAL PREP: Reeser's Freezer Stash

"Reeser's whole business model was: make it once, freeze it, eat it later. Your kitchen can do the same thing — minus the phosphate preservatives."

- Batch Size:** 20 burritos (mix and match any of Recipes 15-17)
- What You Need:** - 20 low-sodium flour tortillas (10") - 2 lbs ground turkey (for ~12-14 meat burritos) - 2 cans pinto beans (for ~6-8 bean burritos) - 1 block cream cheese (8 oz = 16 tbsp, covers all 20) - 1 batch red chile sauce + 1 batch BBQ sauce (or double one if you have a favorite) - 20 sheets of aluminum foil (~12" squares) - Gallon freezer bags or a large freezer bin - A Sharpie
- Assembly Line Method:**
- Cook all protein first.** Brown 2 lbs turkey in a large skillet, drain, season with Master Taco Seasoning. Set aside. Prep beans (triple-rinse, mash, season) in a second skillet. Set aside.
 - Make both sauces.** Red chile and BBQ — 10 min total.
 - Set up the line:** Tortillas laid out flat (work in batches of 5) → protein/beans → sauce → cream cheese → fold → wrap.
 - Fill each burrito:** ~3 tbsp filling + ~2 tbsp sauce + ~2 tbsp cream cheese. Don't overfill — they need room to fold without tearing.
 - Roll tight:** Bottom up, sides in, roll away from you. Tight = no air pockets = no freezer burn.
 - Wrap in foil:** Place burrito seam-down on foil square, wrap snugly. Fold foil ends under.
 - Label with Sharpie:** Write the flavor + date directly on the foil. ("RH 4/12" = Red Hot, April 12th. "BBQ 4/12". "B&C 4/12".)
 - Flash freeze:** Lay flat on a sheet pan in a single layer, freeze 2 hours until solid.
 - Store:** Transfer to gallon freezer bags or stack in a freezer bin. Remove as much air as possible from bags.

Method	From Frozen	From Fridge
Oven (best texture)	Remove foil. Place on baking sheet. 375F for 25-30 min, flipping once at 15 min. Tortilla gets slightly crispy.	375F for 15-18 min
Microwave (fastest)	Remove foil (!). Wrap in damp paper towel. Microwave 2.5-3 min, flipping halfway. Let stand 1 min.	1.5-2 min
Air Fryer	Remove foil. 350F for 12-15 min, flipping once.	350F for 8-10 min

Freezer Life: 3 months at 0F or below. After 3 months they're still safe but quality drops — the tortilla gets tough and the filling dries out. Label your date and rotate stock.

Thaw Option: Move from freezer to fridge the night before — thaw overnight, then reheat from fridge temps for faster/more even heating.

Yield per batch: - ~60 min total prep + assembly - 20 burritos = roughly 2-3 weeks of grab-and-go meals - Total cost: ~\$15-20 for 20 burritos (\$0.75-1.00 each vs. \$1.50-2.00 at the gas station, and yours won't destroy your kidneys)

RENAL CHECK — Reeser's Burrito Dupes (Recipes 15-17)
K (Potassium): LOW-MED (triple-rinsed beans, no raw tomato, cream

cheese over processed cheese)
P (Phosphorus): LOW (cream cheese base, no phosphate additives — the additives in gas station burritos are the real P danger)
Na (Sodium): LOW (low-sodium tortillas, no-salt-added tomato sauce, homemade seasoning throughout)
Fluid: Minimal fluid content — these are grab-and-go solid meals
Protein: MODERATE (turkey is quality renal protein, beans add plant protein without the P load of processed meat)

"The Drive-Thru closed. Your kitchen opened."

Baja Blast Zero + Chicken Chalupa + Grilled 5-Layer Burrito + Crunchy Taco

Every sauce. Every component. Every ingredient. Built for the renal kitchen.

"\$7 at Taco Bell could put you in the ER. \$7 at home keeps you alive AND full."

Item	Sodium	Phosphorus	Potassium
Chicken Chalupa Supreme	~800mg Na	~350mg P	~400mg K
Beefy 5-Layer Burrito	~1,100mg Na	~400mg P	~500mg K
Crunchy Taco	~310mg Na	~200mg P	~200mg K
Baja Blast (medium)	~65mg Na	~50mg P (phosphoric acid)	~10mg K
BOX TOTAL	~2,275mg Na	~1,000mg P	~1,110mg K

That's MORE than the entire daily sodium limit in ONE MEAL.

THE HOMEMADE DUPE: EVERY COMPONENT		
ITEM 1: Chicken Chalupa Supreme		
The Chalupa Shell		
Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
All-purpose flour	1 cup	Fine
Baking powder	1 tsp	Use PHOSPHORUS-FREE (Rumford aluminum-free)
Salt	1/4 tsp	Minimal — the original shell has ~400mg Na alone
Warm water	1/3 cup	Counts toward fluid
Oil for frying	Enough to shallow-fry	Canola or vegetable

Method: Mix flour + baking powder + salt. Add warm water, knead 2 min until smooth. Rest 15 min. Divide into 4 balls. Roll each into oval, ~6". Fry in 1" oil at 350F for ~45 seconds per side until puffed and golden. Drain on paper towels. Shape over a rolling pin while warm to form the taco-boat shape.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Chicken breast	1 large, diced small	Good renal protein
Homemade taco seasoning	1.5 tbsp (see master recipe)	NO PACKET — packets are 500mg+ Na each
Water	2 tbsp	To simmer seasoning into chicken
Oil	1 tsp	For cooking

Method: Dice chicken into 1/2" pieces. Cook in oil over medium-high 4-5 min. Add seasoning + water, stir until absorbed and chicken is coated.

The Toppings

Topping	Amount	CKD Notes
Lettuce	1/4 cup shredded iceberg	Low everything — safe
Sour cream	1 tbsp	Fine in small amounts

Topping	Amount	CKD Notes
Cheese	1 tbsp shredded cheddar	Small portion keeps P low
Tomato	1 tbsp diced	OR skip and use diced bell pepper — tomato = K

Chalupa Assembly

Shell → chicken → sour cream → cheese → lettuce → tomato/pepper

Per chalupa: ~180mg Na, ~150mg P, ~200mg K (vs original's 800/350/400)

ITEM 2: Grilled Five-Layer Burrito

The Components

Layer	Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Tortilla	Low-sodium flour tortilla (10")	1	Mission low-sodium has ~300mg Na vs standard ~600mg
Layer 1: Beef	Ground turkey + taco seasoning	2 oz	Turkey is lower P than beef
Layer 2: Beans	SKIP	—	Beans are very high K + P. Replace with:
Layer 2 ALT: Rice	White rice, cooked	2 tbsp	Low-K, acts as the "filler" layer
Layer 3: Sour cream	Regular sour cream	1.5 tbsp	The creamy layer
Layer 4: Cheese	Nacho cheese sauce (homemade)	1 tbsp	See sauce recipes below
Layer 5: Cheese	Shredded cheddar	1 tbsp	Small amount

Assembly & Grilling

1. Lay tortilla flat
2. Spread sour cream across center third
3. Layer: rice → meat → nacho cheese → shredded cheese
4. Fold bottom up, sides in, top down (burrito fold)
5. Place seam-down in dry skillet or panini press
6. Grill 2 min per side until golden brown and cheese melts
7. Cut in half diagonally

Per burrito: ~380mg Na, ~180mg P, ~250mg K (vs original's 1,100/400/500)

ITEM 3: Crunchy Taco

The Shell

Option	CKD Notes
Store-bought hard taco shell	~120mg Na per shell — acceptable
OR: Fry your own corn tortilla	Lower sodium, crispier

The Filling

Component	Amount	CKD Notes
Turkey taco meat	2 oz	Same seasoning as above
Lettuce	2 tbsp shredded iceberg	
Cheese	1 tbsp shredded cheddar	Small portion
Sour cream	1 tsp	Optional
Hot sauce	Dash	See CKD hot sauce below

Per taco: ~200mg Na, ~120mg P, ~150mg K (vs original's 310/200/200 — close but still lower)

ITEM 4: Baja Blast Zero

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Sprite Zero	12 oz	No phosphoric acid (Mountain Dew HAS phosphoric acid — that's why we sub)
Blue food coloring	2 drops	
Green food coloring	1 drop	
Lime juice	1 tsp	That citrus tang

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Pineapple extract	2-3 drops	OR 1 tbsp pineapple juice (adds ~15mg K)
Ice	Fill cup	

Method: Mix Sprite Zero + food coloring + lime + pineapple in glass with ice. Stir. That's it. Looks and tastes like Baja Blast, zero phosphoric acid.

Per serving: ~40mg Na, ~0mg P (vs Dew's ~50mg phosphoric acid P), ~15mg K

Fluid note: This is 12+ oz of fluid. Counts toward daily limit.

ITEM 5: Cinnamon Twists Dupe

The important trick: use Mexican *duros de harina* or wheat twist pellets. Do not use dry rotini pasta; pasta stays hard and unpleasant. Duros puff in hot oil in seconds.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Duros de harina / wheat twist pellets	1 cup dry pellets	Check label; choose low-sodium pellets with no phosphate additives.
Neutral oil	2 inches in a small pot	Avocado, canola, or vegetable oil.
Granulated sugar	1/3 cup	Coating.
Ceylon cinnamon	1 1/2 tsp	Cinnamon Cloud crossover; use Ceylon for the house standard.
Fine salt	Pinch optional	Optional; skip for tighter sodium days.

1. Mix sugar, cinnamon, and optional tiny pinch of salt in a large bowl.
2. Heat oil to 350-365F. Test one pellet: it should puff within 3-5 seconds.
3. Fry a small handful at a time. They expand hard and fast, so do not crowd the pot.
4. Remove as soon as fully puffed, usually 10-20 seconds. Drain briefly on a rack or paper towel.
5. While still hot, toss in cinnamon sugar until every ridge is coated.
6. Cool completely before bagging. Store airtight up to 3 days.

Air fryer note: raw duros are unreliable in an air fryer. If avoiding deep frying, buy plain puffed duros/chicharrones de harina and warm them 1-2 minutes before tossing with cinnamon sugar.

Per small handful: sodium depends on pellet label; homemade coating keeps phosphorus additives out and avoids the heavy restaurant sodium load.

ALL THE SAUCES (Lower-Sodium Dupes)

Taco Bell Creamy jalapeño Sauce

Ingredient	Amount
Avocado oil mayo (Primal Kitchen)	3 tbsp
Pickled jalapeño juice	1 tsp (from a jar of jalapeños)
Minced pickled jalapeño	1 tsp
Garlic powder	1/4 tsp
Cumin	Pinch
Cayenne	Pinch
Lime juice	1/2 tsp

Mix and refrigerate 30 min for flavors to meld. Keeps 1 week.

Taco Bell Nacho Cheese Sauce

Ingredient	Amount
Cream cheese	2 oz (1/4 block)
Unsweetened almond milk	3 tbsp
Cheddar cheese, shredded	2 tbsp
Paprika	1/4 tsp
Garlic powder	1/8 tsp
Cayenne	Pinch
Turmeric	Pinch (for yellow color)

Microwave cream cheese 20 sec. Add milk, stir smooth. Add cheddar, microwave 15 sec, stir. Add spices. Adjust thickness with milk.

Why cream cheese base: Velveeta/processed cheese = very high phosphorus + sodium. Cream cheese is lower P and you control the sodium.

Taco Bell Red Sauce

Ingredient	Amount
Tomato paste	1 tbsp (small amount = controlled K)
Water	3 tbsp
Cumin	1/4 tsp
Chili powder	1/4 tsp
Garlic powder	1/8 tsp
Onion powder	1/8 tsp
Cayenne	Pinch
Vinegar	1/2 tsp

Whisk everything together. Simmer 2 min. Thin, pourable, tastes exactly like the packets.

Why small tomato paste: Tomato is high-K, but 1 tbsp of paste across 4 servings = ~30mg K per serving. Controlled.**

Taco Bell Hot Sauce (packet dupe)

Ingredient	Amount
Cayenne pepper	1/2 tsp
Cumin	1/4 tsp
Garlic powder	1/4 tsp
Onion powder	1/4 tsp
Vinegar	2 tbsp
Water	1 tbsp
Tomato paste	1/2 tsp
Sugar	1/4 tsp

Blend or whisk. Store in small squeeze bottle. Dime-sized squirts on tacos.

Taco Bell Chipotle Sauce

Ingredient	Amount
Avocado oil mayo (Primal Kitchen)	2 tbsp
Chipotle pepper in adobo	1 pepper, minced (canned — use one pepper, not the whole can)
Adobo sauce	1/2 tsp
Lime juice	1/2 tsp
Garlic powder	Pinch

Mix. Smoky, creamy, a little spicy. One canned chipotle pepper goes a long way.

Taco Bell Avocado Ranch

Ingredient	Amount
Avocado oil mayo (Primal Kitchen)	2 tbsp
1/4 avocado	Mashed smooth
Lime juice	1 tsp
Garlic powder	1/8 tsp
Dried dill	1/8 tsp
Dried chives	1/8 tsp
Onion powder	Pinch

Mix smooth. Use within 2 days (avocado browns).
K note: 1/4 avocado = ~180mg K. Use sparingly or skip for stricter K limits.

CKD LUXE BOX TOTAL vs ORIGINAL

Nutrient	Original \$7 Luxe Box	CKD Dupe Box	Reduction
Sodium	~2,275mg	~800mg	65% less
Phosphorus	~1,000mg	~450mg	55% less
Potassium	~1,110mg	~615mg	45% less

Nutrient	Original \$7 Luxe Box	CKD Dupe Box	Reduction
Cost	\$7.00 + tax + gas	~\$5-6 in ingredients (feeds 2)	Cheaper
Flavor	Taco Bell	95% identical	Worth it

MEAL PREP VERSION

Make a batch on Sunday, eat Taco Bell all week: 1. Cook 2 lbs turkey taco meat with seasoning. Portion into 4 containers. 2. Make all sauces. Store in squeeze bottles. 3. Fry 8 chalupa shells. Store in airtight container with paper towels. 4. Shred lettuce, cheese. Store separately. 5. Make Baja Blast mix (minus the Sprite) as a concentrate. Add Sprite when serving.

Assembly time per meal: 5 minutes. Faster than the drive-thru.

CKD Considerations

RENAL CHECK — \$7 Luxe Box CKD Dupe
K (Potassium): MODERATE (bell pepper over tomato, no beans, controlled avocado)
P (Phosphorus): LOW-MED (cream cheese sauces, no processed cheese, turkey over beef)
Na (Sodium): LOW (no-salt seasoning, low-sodium tortillas, homemade sauces)
Fluid: Baja Blast = 12+ oz fluid — TRACK IT
Protein: GOOD (chicken + turkey = quality renal protein)

"The whole box. Every sauce. Every crunch. Your kidneys don't even know."

10 Wings. 10 Sauces. Zero Compromise.

"The best questions come after the fourth wing." -- Sean Evans, sort of

THE WINGS (Base Recipe)

Baked Crispy Wings -- Universal Base for All 10 Rounds

In 1964, Teressa Bellissimo at the Anchor Bar in Buffalo, NY deep-fried leftover wings and tossed them in cayenne hot sauce, accidentally inventing the "Buffalo wing" -- previously, wings were considered throwaway parts only fit for stock. (Source: The New Yorker, 1980)

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Note
Chicken wing sections (flats + drums)	3 lbs (~24 pieces)	Good protein source; rinse and pat dry
Baking powder (aluminum-free)	1 Tbsp	Low Na; creates crispiness without frying
Garlic powder	1 tsp	Low K alternative to fresh garlic
Onion powder	1 tsp	Lower K than raw onion
Smoked paprika	1 tsp	Negligible minerals
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	Negligible minerals
Olive oil spray	light coating	Heart-healthy fat

Method:

- Pat wings completely dry with paper towels. Moisture is the enemy of crispiness.
- Toss wings in a large bowl with baking powder, garlic powder, onion powder, smoked paprika, and black pepper until evenly coated.
- Arrange wings on a wire rack set over a rimmed baking sheet. Single layer, no touching.
- Refrigerate uncovered for 1 hour (or up to overnight) to dry the skin further.
- Preheat oven to 425 F (220 C).
- Spray wings lightly with olive oil.
- Bake 25 minutes. Flip each wing. Bake another 20-25 minutes until skin is golden and crackling.
- Toss 4-6 wings at a time in the sauce of your chosen round.

Yield: ~24 wings (serves 4-6, ~4-6 wings per person)

Per Serving (6 plain wings, no sauce):

Na	P	K
95 mg	145 mg	180 mg

THE LINEUP

Wing #1: "The Handshake" (Mild) -- Frank's RedHot Dupe ~450 Scoville Heat Units

Frank's RedHot was created in 1920 in New Iberia, Louisiana by Adam Estillette and Jacob Frank, using aged cayenne peppers -- the same sauce was used in the original 1964 Anchor Bar Buffalo wing recipe. (Source: McCormick & Company archives)

Sauce Ingredients:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Note
Cayenne pepper, ground	2 Tbsp	Negligible minerals at this amount
White vinegar	1/2 cup	Na-free acid base
Water	1/4 cup	--
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	Low K
Unsalted butter	2 Tbsp	Low Na; adds classic buffalo richness
Honey	1 tsp	Low mineral sweetener to round flavor

Method:

- Whisk cayenne, vinegar, water, and garlic powder in a small saucepan over medium heat.
- Bring to a simmer and cook 5 minutes, stirring occasionally.
- Remove from heat. Whisk in butter until melted and emulsified.
- Stir in honey. Let cool 5 minutes before tossing with wings.

Per Serving (sauce only, ~2 Tbsp):

Na	P	K
5 mg	12 mg	35 mg

Wing #2: "Smoky Crossroads" (Mild-Medium) -- Cholula Dupe ~1,000 Scoville Heat Units

Cholula hot sauce is named after the city of Cholula, Puebla, Mexico -- a city continuously inhabited for over 2,500 years, making it one of the oldest still-living cities in the Americas. Its Great Pyramid has a larger base than Giza's. (Source: INAH, Mexico)

Sauce Ingredients:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Note
Arbol chiles, dried	6 whole	Low Na heat source
Piquin chiles, dried	1 Tbsp	Concentrated heat, negligible minerals
White vinegar	1/3 cup	Na-free
Water	1/4 cup	--
Cumin, ground	1/2 tsp	Negligible minerals
Oregano, dried	1/2 tsp	Negligible minerals
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	Low K
Onion powder	1/4 tsp	Low K

Method:

- Toast arbol and piquin chiles in a dry skillet over medium heat for 60 seconds, turning frequently. Remove stems.
- Soak toasted chiles in hot water for 15 minutes. Drain.
- Blend soaked chiles with vinegar, water, cumin, oregano, garlic powder, and onion powder until smooth.
- Strain through a fine-mesh sieve for a pourable consistency.
- Simmer strained sauce in a small pot for 5 minutes to meld flavors.

Per Serving (sauce only, ~2 Tbsp):

Na	P	K
3 mg	10 mg	45 mg

Wing #3: "Red Line" (Medium) -- Tapatio Dupe ~3,000 Scoville Heat Units

Tapatio hot sauce was created in 1971 by Jose-Luis Saavedra, Sr. in a small warehouse in Maywood, California. The name "Tapatio" is a colloquial term for people from Guadalajara, Jalisco -- Saavedra's

hometown. It remained family-owned for over 50 years. (Source: Los Angeles Times, 2011)

Sauce Ingredients:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Note
Arbol chiles, dried	10 whole	Low Na heat source
Guajillo chiles, dried	2 whole	Mild, fruity backbone; low Na
White vinegar	1/3 cup	Na-free
Water	3 Tbsp	--
Garlic powder	1 tsp	Low K
Cumin, ground	1/4 tsp	Negligible
Oregano, dried	1/4 tsp	Negligible
Smoked paprika	1/4 tsp	Negligible

Method:

- Remove stems and most seeds from arbol and guajillo chiles.
- Toast in a dry skillet 60-90 seconds. Soak in hot water 15 minutes. Drain.
- Blend chiles with vinegar, water, garlic powder, cumin, oregano, and smoked paprika.
- Strain through a fine-mesh sieve.
- Simmer 5 minutes in a small saucepan. It should coat a spoon.

Per Serving (sauce only, ~2 Tbsp):

Na	P	K
4 mg	14 mg	55 mg

Wing #4: "Rooster Walk" (Medium-Hot) -- Sriracha Dupe ~2,200 Scoville Heat Units

Sriracha sauce is named after Si Racha, a coastal town in Chonburi Province, Thailand. David Tran, a Vietnamese-Chinese refugee, began bottling his version in Los Angeles in 1980 using a van. His rooster logo represents his Chinese zodiac birth year. (Source: Bon Appetit, 2009)

Sauce Ingredients:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Note
Red Fresno chiles, fresh	8 oz (~8 chiles)	Fresh chiles = lower Na than bottled sauce
Garlic cloves	4	Moderate K; small amount per serving
White vinegar	1/4 cup	Na-free
Honey	1 Tbsp	Low mineral sweetener
Water	2 Tbsp	--

Method:

- Stem and roughly chop Fresno chiles (keep seeds for heat).
- Blend chiles, garlic, vinegar, honey, and water until a coarse paste forms.
- Transfer to a saucepan. Simmer on low heat 10 minutes, stirring often.
- Let cool slightly, then blend again until smooth.
- Strain if you want classic smooth texture, or leave chunky for rustic style.
- Rest in the fridge 24 hours for flavors to marry -- this step matters.

Per Serving (sauce only, ~2 Tbsp):

Na	P	K
6 mg	18 mg	70 mg

Wing #5: "Habanero Sunrise" (Hot) -- Tabasco Habanero Dupe

~7,000 Scoville Heat Units

The Tabasco pepper gets its name from the Mexican state of Tabasco, but the sauce has been produced exclusively on Avery Island, Louisiana since 1868. Avery Island is actually a salt dome -- a geological column of rock salt pushing up through the earth -- which the McIlhenny family has mined since the Civil War. (Source: Smithsonian Magazine, 2007)

Sauce Ingredients:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Note
Habanero peppers, fresh	4 (about 2 oz)	Extreme heat; wear gloves
Mango, fresh	1/2 cup diced	Moderate K -- portion controlled
White vinegar	1/4 cup	Na-free
Lime juice, fresh	2 Tbsp	Low Na acid; moderate K in small qty
Honey	1 Tbsp	Low mineral sweetener
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	Low K
Ground mustard	1/4 tsp	Negligible

Method:

1. Stem and halve habaneros (keep seeds for full heat, remove some to dial back).
2. Roast habaneros and mango under the broiler for 5-7 minutes until charred.
3. Blend roasted habaneros, mango, vinegar, lime juice, honey, garlic powder, and mustard until smooth.
4. Simmer in a saucepan 5 minutes.
5. Strain for a smooth, pourable hot sauce.

Per Serving (sauce only, ~2 Tbsp):

Na	P	K
4 mg	10 mg	85 mg

Wing #6: "Black Label Smoke" (Hotter) -- El Yucateco Dupe ~11,600 Scoville Heat Units

El Yucateco was founded in 1968 in Merida, Yucatan by Priamo Gamboa. Its distinctive green and black label sauces use habaneros grown in the Yucatan Peninsula, where the chile is native -- archaeologists have found domesticated habanero seeds in Yucatecan sites dating to 8,500 years ago. (Source: Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 2014)

Sauce Ingredients:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Note
Habanero peppers, fresh	6 (about 3 oz)	Wear gloves; ventilate kitchen
Chipotle chile in adobo	1 chile only	Watch Na -- use only the chile, not the adobo liquid
White vinegar	1/4 cup	Na-free
Lime juice, fresh	1 Tbsp	Low Na
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	Low K
Cumin, ground	1/4 tsp	Negligible
Smoked paprika	1 tsp	Smoky depth
Water	2 Tbsp	--

Method:

1. Char habaneros in a dry cast iron skillet over high heat, turning, until blistered on all sides (~5 minutes).
2. Stem the charred habaneros.
3. Blend habaneros, chipotle chile, vinegar, lime juice, garlic powder, cumin, smoked paprika, and water.
4. Strain through a fine-mesh sieve, pressing with a spoon to extract all liquid.
5. Simmer 5 minutes. The color should be deep brownish-red with visible smoke wisps.

Per Serving (sauce only, ~2 Tbsp):

Na	P	K
25 mg	12 mg	75 mg

Wing #7: "Aardvark's Garden" (Very Hot) -- Secret Aardvark Dupe

~15,000 Scoville Heat Units

Secret Aardvark Habanero Hot Sauce was born in Portland, Oregon in 2004, created by Scott Moritz. It became a cult favorite at Portland food carts before going national. The name came from a childhood nickname -- Moritz's friends called him "Aardvark" because he had a long nose. (Source: Portland Mercury, 2016)

Sauce Ingredients:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Note
Habanero peppers, fresh	6 (about 3 oz)	Wear gloves
Roasted red bell pepper	1 medium	Moderate K; roasting concentrates flavor
White vinegar	1/4 cup	Na-free
Mustard powder	1 tsp	Secret Aardvark's signature tang
Cumin, ground	1/2 tsp	Negligible
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	Negligible
Garlic powder	1 tsp	Low K
Onion powder	1/2 tsp	Low K
Honey	2 tsp	Balances heat with sweetness

Method:

1. Roast bell pepper directly over a gas flame or under broiler until fully charred. Steam in a covered bowl 10 minutes, then peel and seed.
2. Stem and halve habaneros.
3. Blend roasted bell pepper, habaneros, vinegar, mustard powder, cumin, black pepper, garlic powder, onion powder, and honey until very smooth.
4. Simmer in a saucepan 10 minutes on low, stirring frequently.
5. Do not strain -- the roasted pepper body is what gives this sauce its signature thickness.

Per Serving (sauce only, ~2 Tbsp):

Na	P	K
8 mg	16 mg	95 mg

Wing #8: "Caliente Doble" (Extremely Hot) -- Hot Ones Los Calientes Dupe

~36,000 Scoville Heat Units

"Hot Ones" debuted on YouTube's First We Feast channel in March 2015. Host Sean Evans intentionally chose to avoid celebrity-friendly softball questions, instead using progressively hotter wings to break down guests' media-trained composure. The show has generated over 4 billion total views. (Source: The New York Times, 2019)

Sauce Ingredients:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Note
Habanero peppers, fresh	6 (about 3 oz)	High heat base
Serrano peppers, fresh	4	Medium heat layering
Passionfruit pulp (frozen)	3 Tbsp	Moderate K; tropical tang
Pineapple, fresh	2 Tbsp minced	Moderate K in small amount
White vinegar	3 Tbsp	Na-free
Lime juice, fresh	1 Tbsp	Low Na
Garlic powder	1 tsp	Low K
Smoked paprika	1/2 tsp	Depth
Ground cumin	1/4 tsp	Negligible

Method:

1. Stem and roughly chop habaneros and serranos.
2. Dry-roast all chiles in a cast iron skillet until blistered.
3. Blend roasted chiles with passionfruit pulp, pineapple, vinegar, lime juice, garlic powder, smoked paprika, and cumin.
4. Simmer 10 minutes in a saucepan. The fruit sugars will caramelize slightly.
5. Blend again for a silky finish. Strain only if you want a thinner pour.

Per Serving (sauce only, ~2 Tbsp):

Na	P	K
5 mg	14 mg	110 mg

Wing #9: "Beyond Reason" (Savage) -- Da Bomb Beyond Insanity Dupe

~135,600 Scoville Heat Units

Da Bomb Beyond Insanity, made by Original Juan Specialty Foods in Kansas City, has become the most feared sauce on "Hot Ones" -- nearly every guest breaks down at this stage. The sauce uses habanero pepper extract, a concentrated capsaicin isolate, which is why it hits harder than sauces with higher Scoville ratings that use whole peppers. (Source: First We Feast, 2020)

Sauce Ingredients:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Note
Habanero peppers, fresh	8 (about 4 oz)	Maximum whole-pepper heat
Cayenne pepper, ground	2 Tbsp	Concentrated burn
Ghost pepper powder (bhut jolokia)	1 tsp	Extreme heat -- measure carefully
White vinegar	1/4 cup	Na-free
Garlic powder	1 tsp	Low K
Chipotle powder	1/2 tsp	Smoky undertone
Unsweetened apricot preserves	1 Tbsp	Low Na fruit binder; moderate K
Water	2 Tbsp	--

Method:

1. Stem habaneros. For maximum heat, keep all seeds and membranes.
2. Blend habaneros, cayenne, ghost pepper powder, vinegar, garlic powder, chipotle powder, apricot preserves, and water until completely smooth.
3. Simmer on low 15 minutes. The kitchen will become hostile -- run the vent hood.
4. Strain through a fine-mesh sieve for a dense, extract-like consistency.
5. Let cool fully before use. This sauce should coat a spoon and drip slowly.

WARNING: This sauce is not for casual consumption. Taste with a toothpick first.

Per Serving (sauce only, ~1 Tbsp -- you will not want more):

Na	P	K
4 mg	10 mg	65 mg

Wing #10: "The Last Prayer" (Extinction Level) -- The Last Dab Dupe

~2,000,000+ Scoville Heat Units

Pepper X, bred by Ed Currie of PuckerButt Pepper Company, was confirmed by Guinness World Records in October 2023 as the world's hottest pepper at 2.69 million Scoville Heat Units, dethroning Currie's own Carolina Reaper (1.64M SHU). Currie spent over 10 years crossbreeding peppers to create it. He reportedly cramped for over 3 hours after eating one raw. (Source: Associated Press, October 2023)

Sauce Ingredients:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Note
Carolina Reaper peppers, dried	3 whole	Handle with nitrile gloves only
Habanero peppers, fresh	4	Supporting heat floor
Ghost pepper powder (bhut jolokia)	2 tsp	Layered superhot
White vinegar	1/4 cup	Na-free
Mustard powder	1/2 tsp	Tang and complexity
Garlic powder	1 tsp	Low K
Turmeric, ground	1/4 tsp	Inflammation-support; golden color
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	Activates turmeric's curcumin
Ginger, ground	1/4 tsp	Low K
Honey	2 tsp	Last-dab sweetness
Water	2 Tbsp	--

Method:

1. Rehydrate dried Carolina Reapers in hot water for 20 minutes. Drain. Remove stems only -- keep every seed.
2. Stem and halve fresh habaneros.
3. Blend rehydrated Reapers, habaneros, ghost pepper powder, vinegar, mustard powder, garlic powder, turmeric, black pepper, ginger, honey, and water.
4. Simmer on low heat 15 minutes. Do not lean over the pot. Do not breathe directly above it. Seriously.
5. Blend once more until completely homogenous.
6. Strain for a velvety, neon-orange sauce.
7. Apply with a toothpick or the back of a spoon -- a "dab" is the correct serving unit.

WARNING: This sauce is weapons-grade. Have plain rice, bread, and full-fat yogurt standing by. Capsaicin is fat-soluble, not water-soluble -- water will make it worse.

Per Serving (sauce only, ~1 tsp -- that is plenty):

Na	P	K
2 mg	5 mg	20 mg

CKD Considerations

Capsaicin and Kidneys -- The Good News

Capsaicin (the compound that makes peppers hot) has shown potential studied in kidney-related research properties in peer-reviewed research. A 2012 study in the Journal of Agricultural and Food Chemistry found capsaicin may reduce renal oxidative stress. Hot peppers are also naturally very low in sodium, potassium, and phosphorus per serving -- making them one of the most potentially compatible with an individualized CKD plan flavor amplifiers available.

Key Reminders:

- **Sodium:** Every sauce in this lineup is homemade specifically to avoid the 200-500+ mg Na per serving found in commercial hot sauces. None exceed 25 mg Na per serving.
- **Potassium:** Wing #8 (Caliente Doble) has the highest K at 110 mg per serving due to passionfruit and pineapple. If you are on strict K restriction, swap the fruit for extra vinegar and a pinch of citric acid.
- **Phosphorus:** All sauces stay well under 50 mg P per serving. The wings themselves are the primary P source (~145 mg for 6 wings). Track your daily total accordingly.
- **Portion control is built in:** The hotter the sauce, the less you use. Wing #10 is measured in teaspoons, not tablespoons.
- **Hydration:** Spicy food increases thirst. If you are on a fluid restriction, have your allotted fluids nearby and sip -- do not chug.
- **Acid reflux:** If you experience GERD, start at Wing #1 and respect your ceiling. There is no shame in a five-wing streak.
- **No commercial sauces were used.** Every recipe avoids the hidden sodium, phosphate preservatives, and potassium chloride found in store-bought hot sauces.

Daily Targets (general CKD guidance -- individual plans vary):

Nutrient	Daily Target
Sodium (Na)	< 2,000 mg
Potassium (K)	2,000-3,000 mg (varies by stage)
Phosphorus (P)	800-1,000 mg

"If you can't stand the heat, get out of the kitchen -- but if you built the kitchen yourself, you set the thermostat." -- a thing someone should have said to Harry Truman

Wilbur Scoville, the pharmacist who invented the Scoville Organoleptic Test in 1912, measured pepper heat by diluting chile extract with sugar water until a panel of five tasters could no longer detect the burn. The entire modern hot sauce industry rests on five people's tongues from 112 years ago. (Source: Journal of the American Pharmaceutical Association, 1912)

Southeast Asian

“The wok doesn’t ask questions.”

Tom Kha, Pad Thai, Pad Gra Prao, Papaya Salad, Beef Salad, Spring Rolls, Pho, Banh Mi

Southeast Asian Comfort Food

"The food cart vibes. The clinic-approved numbers."

CKD NOTES FOR THAI/VIETNAMESE COOKING

The good news: Thai and Vietnamese cuisines are NATURALLY closer to CKD-aware than most Western food: - Rice-based (low K, low P) - Fresh herbs (cilantro, basil, mint = almost zero K/P/Na) - Lime juice instead of salt for brightness - Protein is portion-controlled by design (small amounts of meat, lots of vegetables/noodles)

The traps: - **Fish sauce** = VERY high sodium (~1,400mg Na per tbsp). Use sparingly, dilute, or sub with low-sodium soy sauce + lime - **Soy sauce** = high sodium (~900mg Na per tbsp). Use low-sodium version - **Tomatoes** in some dishes = high K - **Coconut water** = high K (but coconut CREAM/MILK is fine) - **Bean sprouts** = moderate K — use small amounts - **Peanuts** = moderate P — garnish only, not handfuls - **Potassium in broth** — bone broth concentrates K. Use homemade with controlled simmer time.

The CKD sauce trinity:

Sauce	Original	CKD Swap
Fish sauce	1 tbsp = 1,400mg Na	1 tsp low-sodium soy + 1/2 tsp lime juice + pinch sugar
Soy sauce	1 tbsp = 900mg Na	Low-sodium soy sauce (Kikkoman low-sodium = 575mg/tbsp) — use 1 tsp max
Oyster sauce	1 tbsp = 490mg Na	1 tsp oyster sauce + 1 tsp water (dilute by half)

THE RECIPES

1. Lime-Coconut Tom Kha Gai

Andrew's comfort soup — creamy, sour, aromatic, warming

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Coconut milk (full-fat canned)	1 can (13.5oz)	Fine — coconut MILK/CREAM is low K
Chicken breast	6 oz, sliced thin	Good renal protein
Galangal (or ginger)	6 slices	Inflammation-support, low everything
Lemongrass	2 stalks, smashed and cut into 2" pieces	Aromatic, zero K/P/Na
Kaffir lime leaves	4-5 leaves	Aromatic
Mushrooms (white button)	1/2 cup sliced	Low-K mushroom variety
Cherry tomatoes	4-5, halved	Small amount = controlled K
Thai chilies	2-3, smashed	Heat without sodium
Lime juice	2-3 tbsp	THE sour element — replaces some fish sauce need
Fish sauce sub	1 tsp low-sodium soy + 1/2 tsp lime + pinch sugar	~190mg Na vs 1,400mg
Sugar	1 tsp	Balances sour
Cilantro	Garnish	
Water or chicken broth	1 cup	Low-sodium broth if using

Method: 1. Bring coconut milk + water to gentle simmer 2. Add galangal, lemongrass, lime leaves, chilies. Simmer 5 min (infuse aromatics) 3. Add chicken. Cook 5 min until white throughout 4. Add mushrooms + tomatoes. Cook 2 min 5. Remove from heat. Add lime juice + fish sauce sub + sugar 6. Taste — adjust sour (more lime) and salt (tiny bit more soy) to preference 7. Garnish with cilantro, serve with jasmine rice

Per serving (2 servings): ~250mg Na, ~180mg P, ~350mg K. Safe and gorgeous.

2. Tamarind Street Pad Thai

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Rice noodles (flat, dried)	4 oz	Soak in room-temp water 30 min. LOW-K.
Chicken or shrimp	4 oz	
Egg	1	Moderate P — one egg per batch is fine
Bean sprouts	Small handful	Moderate K — small amount
Green onion	2 stalks, cut into 1" pieces	Low K
Garlic	2 cloves, minced	
Oil	2 tbsp	

Pad Thai Sauce (CKD version):

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Tamarind paste	1 tbsp	The REAL Pad Thai flavor — low K/P/Na
Sugar	1 tbsp	
Low-sodium soy sauce	2 tsp	~380mg Na (vs 3 tbsp fish sauce = 4,200mg)
Lime juice	1 tbsp	
Rice vinegar	1 tsp	
Sriracha or chili flakes	To taste	

Method: 1. Mix sauce ingredients in small bowl 2. Drain soaked noodles 3. Heat oil in wok over high heat. Cook protein 3-4 min, remove 4. Scramble egg in same wok, break up 5. Add noodles + sauce. Toss 2-3 min until noodles are soft and coated 6. Add protein back, bean sprouts, green onion. Toss 1 min 7. Garnish: crushed peanuts (1 tbsp — P control), lime wedge, cilantro

Per serving: ~400mg Na, ~200mg P, ~300mg K

3. Holy Basil Chicken Stir-Fry

The street food king — fast, spicy, aromatic

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Ground chicken or turkey	8 oz	
Thai basil leaves	1 packed cup	Holy basil if you can find it — zero K/P concern
Thai chilies	3-5, minced	Adjust heat to preference
Garlic	4 cloves, minced	
Shallot	1 small, sliced	Low K
Green beans	1/2 cup, cut into 1" pieces	Low K vegetable
Oil	2 tbsp	

Sauce:

Ingredient	Amount
Low-sodium soy sauce	1 tbsp
Oyster sauce	1 tsp
Sugar	1 tsp
Water	1 tbsp

Method: 1. Wok screaming hot + oil 2. Garlic + chilies + shallot — 30 seconds until fragrant 3. Add ground meat — break up, cook 3-4 min until browned 4. Add green beans + sauce. Stir-fry 2 min 5. Kill heat. Toss in basil leaves. They wilt in 10 seconds from residual heat 6. Serve over jasmine rice with a fried egg on top (optional)

Per serving: ~380mg Na, ~190mg P, ~280mg K

4. Green Papaya Crunch Salad

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Green papaya, shredded	2 cups	GREEN (unripe) papaya is LOW-K. RIPE papaya is HIGH-K. Green only!
Carrot, shredded	1/4 cup	Small amount = controlled K
Green beans	4-5, cut into 1" pieces	Low K

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Cherry tomatoes	4, quartered	Small amount
Thai chilies	2-3, to taste	
Garlic	2 cloves	
Lime juice	2 tbsp	
Low-sodium soy sauce	1 tsp	Sub for fish sauce
Sugar	1 tbsp	
Peanuts	1 tbsp, crushed	Garnish only — P control
Dried shrimp	1 tsp (optional)	Tiny amount for umami

Method: Pound garlic + chilies in mortar. Add green beans + tomatoes, lightly bruise. Add papaya + carrot. Add lime + soy sub + sugar. Toss. Top with peanuts.

5. Waterfall Beef Salad

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Flank steak or sirloin	6 oz	Grill medium-rare, slice thin against grain
Shallot	2 small, sliced thin	Low K
Cilantro	1/4 cup	
Mint leaves	1/4 cup	
Green onion	2 stalks, sliced	
Toasted rice powder	1 tbsp	Toast dry rice in pan, grind — the SECRET ingredient
Thai chilies	2, sliced	

Dressing:

Ingredient	Amount
Lime juice	3 tbsp
Low-sodium soy sauce	1 tbsp
Sugar	1 tsp
Chili flakes	1/2 tsp

Method: Grill steak. Rest 5 min. Slice thin. Toss with shallot, herbs, dressing, rice powder. Serve over rice or lettuce cups.

The toasted rice powder is what makes this dish. It adds a nutty, smoky crunch that's unmistakable.

6. Fresh Spring Rolls

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Rice paper wrappers	8 sheets	Soak one at a time in warm water 15 sec
Rice vermicelli	4 oz, cooked	Low K
Shrimp	8 medium, cooked, halved lengthwise	OR chicken breast, sliced
Lettuce	8 leaves	
Fresh herbs	Mint, cilantro, Thai basil — a few leaves per roll	
Cucumber	1/2, cut into matchsticks	Low K
Carrot	1 small, julienned	Small amount

Peanut Dipping Sauce (CKD version):

Ingredient	Amount
Peanut butter	2 tbsp
Hoisin sauce	1 tbsp (moderate Na — use sparingly)
Water	2 tbsp
Lime juice	1 tsp
Sriracha	1/2 tsp
Crushed peanuts	1 tsp garnish

Assembly: Wet rice paper. Lay lettuce, noodles, protein, herbs, cucumber, carrot in center. Fold bottom up, sides in, roll tight. Serve with peanut sauce.

7. Clear-Broth Pho Bo

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Rice noodles (banh pho, flat)	4 oz dry	Low K base
Beef sirloin	4 oz, sliced paper-thin	Slice while partially frozen for thin cuts
Broth (the key):		
Water	6 cups	NOT bone broth (concentrates K). Build flavor with spices.
Low-sodium beef broth	2 cups	Or 2 tsp beef Better Than Bouillon low-sodium
Star anise	2 whole	THE pho spice
Cinnamon stick	1	
Cloves	3	
Ginger	2" piece, charred under broiler	Char = deeper flavor
Onion	1/2, charred	Char it
Fish sauce sub	2 tsp low-sodium soy + 1 tsp lime	
Sugar	1 tsp	

Garnish plate:

Item	CKD Notes
Bean sprouts (small amount)	Moderate K
Thai basil	Safe
Lime wedges	Safe
jalapeño slices	Safe — capsaicin is fine
Cilantro	Safe
Hoisin + sriracha	1 tsp each max — Na control

Method: 1. Char ginger and onion under broiler 5 min per side 2. Simmer water + broth + charred aromatics + spices for 30 min minimum (1 hour better) 3. Strain broth. Return to pot. Season with soy sub + sugar 4. Cook noodles separately per package directions 5. Bowl: noodles → raw beef slices on top → ladle HOT broth over beef (the broth cooks the thin slices instantly) 6. Garnish plate on the side

The pho trick for CKD: Building flavor with spices (star anise, cinnamon, charred ginger) instead of relying on high-sodium fish sauce + long-simmered bone broth. The spice infusion is actually MORE aromatic than lazy high-sodium broth.

8. Bright Pickle Banh Mi

Component	CKD Dupe
Bread	French baguette or bolillo roll — light, crispy crust. Small 6" portion.
Protein	Grilled chicken thigh (marinate in: 1 tsp low-sodium soy + 1 tsp sugar + 1/2 tsp garlic + lemongrass, minced)
Do chua (pickled daikon/carrot)	Julienne daikon + carrot, pickle in rice vinegar + sugar + water (NO salt in the pickle — the vinegar does the work)
Cucumber	Sliced thin
jalapeño	Sliced
Cilantro	Fresh sprigs
Mayo	Avocado oil mayo (Primal Kitchen) or sriracha mayo (mayo + sriracha)
Maggi/soy drizzle	SKIP or 1/2 tsp low-sodium soy — this is where banh mi gets its sodium

Assembly: Split roll. Spread avocado oil mayo. Layer chicken, pickled veg, cucumber, jalapeño, cilantro. The crunch of fresh bread + pickled vegetables + herbs = perfect sandwich.

CHINESE TAKEOUT DUPES & TERIYAKI

"The Americanized Chinese restaurant down the street — but your kidneys don't file a complaint afterward."

CKD NOTES FOR CHINESE TAKEOUT COOKING:

The traps in Chinese-American takeout are predictable: - **Regular soy sauce** = 900mg Na per tbsp. Always use **low-sodium soy sauce**

(Kikkoman low-sodium = 575mg/tbsp), and use LESS than you think you need - **Oyster sauce, hoisin sauce** = sodium bombs. Use sparingly, dilute with water - **Cornstarch coatings** = fine for CKD. Zero K/P/Na. Creates that crispy takeout texture - **Brown sugar** = the secret weapon. Caramelizes in the wok, creates that glossy takeout sauce look - **MSG** = 600mg Na per tsp. Skip it. The umami comes from soy + sugar + ginger instead - **Avocado oil** = Andrew's frying oil of choice. High smoke point (520F), clean flavor, perfect for wok work

The CKD Takeout Sauce Base (use this across most recipes below):

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Low-sodium soy sauce	2 tbsp	~1,150mg Na total — split across 2+ servings
Brown sugar	1.5 tbsp	The glaze
Fresh ginger, minced	1 tbsp	Inflammation-support
Garlic, minced	3 cloves	
Water or low-sodium broth	2 tbsp	Loosens the sauce
Cornstarch slurry	1 tsp cornstarch + 1 tbsp water	Thickens to that glossy takeout consistency

1. Ginger-Glaze Teriyaki Chicken

Invented in the 1960s by Japanese-American immigrants in Seattle and Hawaii. The word "teriyaki" (照り焼き) means "shiny grilled" — **teri** = gloss, **yaki** = grill. The sweet soy glaze Americans know was largely a Pacific Northwest Japanese-American creation, not traditional Japanese cooking.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Chicken thighs, boneless skinless	1 lb (~4 thighs)	Thighs > breast. More flavor, harder to overcook
Teriyaki Sauce:		
Low-sodium soy sauce	3 tbsp	~1,725mg Na split across 4 servings
Brown sugar	2 tbsp	
Fresh ginger, grated	1 tbsp	
Garlic, minced	3 cloves	
Rice vinegar	1 tbsp	Brightness
Water	2 tbsp	
Cornstarch slurry	1 tsp cornstarch + 1 tbsp cold water	
Avocado oil	1 tbsp	
Jasmine rice	For serving	Low K base
Green onion, sliced	Garnish	
Sesame seeds	Garnish	

Method: 1. Mix soy sauce, brown sugar, ginger, garlic, rice vinegar, water in a bowl 2. Heat avocado oil in large skillet or wok over medium-high 3. Sear chicken thighs 5-6 min per side until golden and cooked through (165F internal) 4. Pour sauce over chicken. Simmer 2 min 5. Add cornstarch slurry. Stir until sauce thickens and goes glossy (30 seconds) 6. Slice thighs. Serve over jasmine rice. Hit with green onion + sesame seeds

Per serving (4 servings): ~430mg Na | ~210mg P | ~320mg K

2. Ginger-Glaze Teriyaki Beef

Same Seattle/Hawaii Japanese-American origin as teriyaki chicken. **Flank steak** became the go-to cut in American teriyaki joints because it absorbs marinade fast and slices beautifully against the grain.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Flank steak	1 lb	Slice thin AGAINST the grain after cooking
Teriyaki Sauce:		
Low-sodium soy sauce	3 tbsp	
Brown sugar	2 tbsp	
Fresh ginger, grated	1 tbsp	

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Garlic, minced	3 cloves	
Rice vinegar	1 tbsp	
Water	2 tbsp	
Cornstarch slurry	1 tsp cornstarch + 1 tbsp cold water	
Avocado oil	1 tbsp	
Jasmine rice	For serving	
Green onion, sliced	Garnish	
Sesame seeds	Garnish	

Method: 1. Mix sauce ingredients in a bowl (same as teriyaki chicken sauce) 2. Slice flank steak into 1/4" strips AGAINST the grain. (Pro tip: partially freeze the steak 20 min first — easier to slice thin) 3. Heat avocado oil in wok over HIGH heat until smoking 4. Sear beef strips in batches — 1-2 min per batch. Don't crowd the wok or it steams instead of sears 5. Return all beef to wok. Pour sauce over. Toss 1 min 6. Add cornstarch slurry. Stir until glossy 7. Serve over jasmine rice. Green onion + sesame seeds on top

Per serving (4 servings): ~440mg Na | ~230mg P | ~350mg K

3. Wok-Seared Mongolian Beef

Despite the name, Mongolian Beef has nothing to do with Mongolia. It was invented in Taiwan in the 1950s at Mongolian BBQ restaurants, which were themselves a Taiwanese invention loosely inspired by stories of Mongolian warriors cooking on shields. The dish as Americans know it — sweet, soy-glazed, scallion-heavy — is pure Chinese-American takeout, popularized by P.F. Chang's in the 1990s.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Flank steak	1 lb, sliced 1/4" against grain	Partially freeze first
Cornstarch	3 tbsp	The crispy coating — zero K/P/Na
Avocado oil	3 tbsp (for frying)	High smoke point
Green onions	6-8 stalks, cut into 2" pieces	Low K, THE signature ingredient
Sauce:		
Low-sodium soy sauce	3 tbsp	
Brown sugar	3 tbsp	Slightly sweeter than teriyaki — that's the Mongolian Beef signature
Fresh ginger, minced	1 tbsp	
Garlic, minced	4 cloves	
Water	3 tbsp	
Red pepper flakes	1/2 tsp (optional)	

Method: 1. Toss sliced beef in cornstarch until every piece is coated. Shake off excess 2. Mix sauce ingredients in a bowl 3. Heat avocado oil in wok over HIGH heat. Fry beef strips in batches — 2 min per batch until edges are CRISPY. Remove to plate 4. Drain most oil. Add garlic + ginger, stir 30 seconds 5. Pour in sauce. Let it bubble and thicken 1 min 6. Return crispy beef to wok. Toss to coat 7. Kill heat. Add green onions. Toss 30 seconds (residual heat only — you want them barely wilted, still bright green) 8. Serve over jasmine rice immediately. The crispy texture fades fast

Per serving (4 servings): ~450mg Na | ~220mg P | ~340mg K

4. Peppercorn Szechuan Chicken

Szechuan (Sichuan) cuisine dates back over 2,000 years to China's Sichuan Province. The signature numbing-spicy (麻辣, *málà*) flavor comes from Szechuan peppercorns, which contain hydroxy-alpha-sanshool — a compound that literally numbs your tongue by activating touch receptors. The peppercorn was actually BANNED in the US from 1968-2005 due to citrus canker fears. What Americans ate as "Szechuan" for 37 years was mostly just spicy, not numbing.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Chicken thighs, boneless skinless	1 lb, cut into 1" cubes	
Cornstarch	2 tbsp	Light coating
Avocado oil	2 tbsp	
Dried red chili peppers	8-12 whole	The heat. Remove seeds for less fire
Szechuan peppercorns	1 tsp	The NUMBING. Toast in dry pan first
Bell pepper (red or green)	1, cut into 1" pieces	Low K
Zucchini	1 small, half-moons	Low K
Green onion	3 stalks, cut 1"	
Sauce:		
Low-sodium soy sauce	2 tbsp	
Rice vinegar	1 tbsp	
Brown sugar	1 tbsp	
Sesame oil	1 tsp	Flavor, not frying
Garlic, minced	4 cloves	
Fresh ginger, minced	1 tbsp	
Water	2 tbsp	
Cornstarch slurry	1 tsp cornstarch + 1 tbsp water	

Method: 1. Toast Szechuan peppercorns in dry wok 1 min until fragrant. Remove, crush lightly 2. Toss chicken cubes in cornstarch 3. Heat avocado oil in wok over high heat. Fry chicken 4-5 min until golden. Remove 4. In same wok: dried chilies + crushed Szechuan peppercorns, stir 30 seconds (don't burn) 5. Add garlic + ginger, 30 more seconds 6. Add bell pepper + zucchini. Stir-fry 2 min 7. Return chicken. Pour in sauce. Toss 1 min 8. Add cornstarch slurry. Stir until glossy 9. Finish with green onion + sesame oil drizzle

Heat note: If you want to go nuclear, add chili oil or your favorite hot sauce at the table. Andrew has tried all the Da Bomb hot sauces from Hot Ones and reports they taste like "salty spicy garbage" — famous for being the worst-tasting sauce on the show despite high Scoville numbers. If you want real heat with actual flavor, use chili crisp (Lao Gan Ma) or sambal oelek instead.

Per serving (4 servings): ~400mg Na | ~200mg P | ~310mg K

5. General Tso's Night Market Chicken

Named after Zuo Zongtang (左宗棠), a Qing Dynasty military leader from Hunan Province (1812-1885) who never ate the dish. Chef Peng Chang-kuei created a Hunanese version in Taiwan in the 1950s for a banquet honoring Zuo. Chef Peng later brought it to New York in 1973, where American customers wanted it sweeter. He obliged. The sweet-crispy-spicy version Americans know was born in Manhattan, not Hunan. Chef Peng reportedly disliked the Americanized version.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Chicken thighs, boneless skinless	1 lb, cut into 1.5" pieces	
Batter:		
Cornstarch	1/4 cup	
Egg	1	
All-purpose flour	2 tbsp	
Salt	Pinch only	
Avocado oil	For shallow frying (~1/2 cup)	
Sauce:		
Low-sodium soy sauce	2 tbsp	
Rice vinegar	2 tbsp	The tang
Brown sugar	2 tbsp	The sweet
Sesame oil	1 tsp	
Garlic, minced	3 cloves	
Fresh ginger, minced	1 tbsp	
Dried red chili peppers	4-6 whole	
Water	2 tbsp	

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Cornstarch slurry	1 tsp cornstarch + 1 tbsp water	
Broccoli florets	2 cups, steamed	Low K when steamed

Method: 1. Whisk batter: egg + cornstarch + flour + pinch salt until smooth 2. Toss chicken pieces in batter until fully coated 3. Heat avocado oil in wok or deep skillet to 350F. Fry chicken in batches 4-5 min until deep golden and CRISPY. Drain on paper towels 4. Drain all but 1 tbsp oil. Add dried chilies, garlic, ginger — stir 30 seconds 5. Pour in soy sauce, vinegar, brown sugar, water. Bring to simmer 6. Add cornstarch slurry. Stir until sauce is thick and glossy 7. Toss crispy chicken into sauce. Coat every piece 8. Serve over jasmine rice with steamed broccoli on the side. Drizzle sesame oil

Per serving (4 servings): ~420mg Na | ~220mg P | ~300mg K

6. Toasted Sesame Beef

Sesame-coated beef dishes trace to Cantonese cooking traditions, but the thick-sauced sesame beef Americans know is another Chinese-American restaurant creation from the 1970s-80s. Sesame seeds have been cultivated for over 5,000 years — they're one of the oldest oilseed crops on Earth, first domesticated in the Indian subcontinent. The word "sesame" comes from the Arabic "simsim."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Flank steak	1 lb, sliced 1/4" against grain	Partially freeze first
Cornstarch	3 tbsp	Crispy coating
Avocado oil	3 tbsp	
Sesame seeds	2 tbsp	Toast in dry pan first — low P in this amount
Green onion	3 stalks, sliced	Garnish
Sesame Sauce:		
Low-sodium soy sauce	2 tbsp	
Sesame oil	1 tbsp	The star flavor
Brown sugar	2 tbsp	
Rice vinegar	1 tbsp	
Garlic, minced	3 cloves	
Fresh ginger, minced	1 tsp	
Water	2 tbsp	
Cornstarch slurry	1 tsp cornstarch + 1 tbsp water	

Method: 1. Toast sesame seeds in dry pan over medium heat 2 min, stirring constantly, until golden. Remove immediately (they burn fast) 2. Toss sliced beef in cornstarch 3. Heat avocado oil in wok over HIGH heat. Fry beef in batches until crispy edges. Remove 4. Drain most oil. Add garlic + ginger, 30 seconds 5. Pour in sauce ingredients (soy, sesame oil, brown sugar, vinegar, water). Simmer 1 min 6. Add cornstarch slurry. Stir until thick and glossy 7. Return beef. Toss to coat 8. Top with toasted sesame seeds + green onion. Serve over jasmine rice

Per serving (4 servings): ~410mg Na | ~230mg P | ~340mg K

7. Golden Chicken Fried Rice

Fried rice (炒饭, chǎo fàn) has been documented in China since the Sui Dynasty (~589-618 AD). The technique of frying day-old rice was a practical solution for leftover grain. Chinese-American fried rice as a takeout staple became widespread in the US by the 1920s-30s alongside chop suey joints. The "day-old rice" rule isn't optional — fresh rice has too much moisture and turns into a sticky clump. Cold rice fries crispy.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Day-old jasmine rice	3 cups cooked, cold	MUST be cold/day-old. Spread fresh rice on sheet pan in fridge overnight if needed
Chicken thigh, boneless skinless	8 oz, diced small	

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Eggs	2	Moderate P — 2 eggs across 3+ servings is fine
Carrot	1 small, diced fine	Small amount = controlled K
Green onion	4 stalks, sliced	
Garlic, minced	3 cloves	
Frozen peas	1/4 cup	Small amount only — peas are moderate K
Avocado oil	2 tbsp	
Low-sodium soy sauce	2 tbsp	
Sesame oil	1 tsp	Finish only
White pepper	1/4 tsp	The authentic fried rice seasoning — NOT black pepper

Method: 1. Heat avocado oil in wok over HIGH heat until smoking 2. Cook diced chicken 3-4 min until done. Remove 3. Scramble eggs in same wok. Break into small pieces. Remove 4. Add a splash more oil. Stir-fry carrot + peas 2 min 5. Add cold rice. Press it flat against wok. Let it SIT and get crispy on the bottom (30-45 seconds). Then toss. Repeat. This is how you get that wok-charred flavor (锅气, wok hei) 6. Add garlic, stir 30 seconds 7. Return chicken + eggs. Drizzle soy sauce around the EDGES of the wok (hits the hot metal first = deeper flavor) 8. Toss everything together. White pepper + sesame oil + green onions 9. Serve immediately

Per serving (3 servings): ~420mg Na | ~200mg P | ~290mg K

8. Weeknight Beef Chow Mein

Chow mein (炒麵, chǎo miàn) means "stir-fried noodles." It arrived in America with Chinese railroad workers in the 1850s-60s and became a fixture of early Chinese-American restaurants. By the 1920s, chow mein was one of the most recognized Chinese dishes in America. The crispy vs. soft noodle debate is regional: Cantonese-American restaurants often served crispy pan-fried noodles, while other traditions kept them soft. Both are correct.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Egg noodles or rice noodles	8 oz dried	Rice noodles = lower P. Egg noodles = more authentic chow mein texture
Flank steak	8 oz, sliced thin against grain	
Cabbage (green)	2 cups, shredded	LOW-K vegetable — perfect for CKD
Bean sprouts	1/2 cup	Moderate K — small amount is fine
Carrot	1 small, julienned	
Green onion	3 stalks, cut 2"	
Garlic, minced	3 cloves	
Fresh ginger, minced	1 tsp	
Avocado oil	2 tbsp	
Chow Mein Sauce:		
Low-sodium soy sauce	2 tbsp	
Oyster sauce	1 tsp	Use sparingly — Na
Sesame oil	1 tsp	
Brown sugar	1 tsp	
White pepper	1/4 tsp	
Water	2 tbsp	

Method: 1. Cook noodles per package (usually boil 3-4 min for egg noodles, soak for rice noodles). Drain. Toss with 1 tsp sesame oil to prevent sticking 2. Mix sauce ingredients in a bowl 3. Heat avocado oil in wok over HIGH heat. Sear beef strips 1-2 min. Remove 4. Same wok: garlic + ginger 30 seconds. Add cabbage + carrot. Stir-fry 2 min until cabbage wilts slightly 5. Add noodles. Toss with vegetables. Let noodles sit against the wok to get some char (don't stir constantly) 6. Return beef. Pour sauce over everything. Toss 1 min 7. Add bean sprouts + green

onion. Toss 30 seconds (barely cook them — they stay crunchy) 8. Serve immediately. Chow mein waits for nobody

Per serving (3 servings): ~450mg Na | ~230mg P | ~330mg K

CKD Considerations

RENAL CHECK — Thai & Vietnamese
K (Potassium): LOW-MED (rice noodle base, controlled tomato, green papaya not ripe)
P (Phosphorus): LOW-MED (lean protein portions, peanuts as garnish only)
Na (Sodium): CONTROLLED (fish sauce subbed with low-sodium soy + lime)
Fluid: Soups (Tom Kha, Pho) = significant fluid — track it

RENAL CHECK — Chinese Takeout & Teriyaki
K (Potassium): LOW-MED (jasmine rice base, cabbage/bell pepper/zucchini = low-K vegetables)
P (Phosphorus): LOW-MED (chicken thighs + flank steak in controlled portions, sesame seeds as garnish)
Na (Sodium): CONTROLLED (low-sodium soy sauce, no MSG, brown sugar + ginger for flavor depth)
Fluid: Not an issue — these are dry stir-fry dishes, not soups
Oil: Avocado oil throughout (high smoke point, clean profile)

JAPANESE SIDES

Sunomono Cucumber Salad

Sunomono (酢の物) literally means "vinegared things" — the technique predates refrigeration in Japan by centuries, used to preserve vegetables through the Edo period (1603-1868).

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
English cucumber	1 large, thin-sliced	Low K (~150mg per cup). English/hothouse cucumbers = less seeds, less bitter
Rice vinegar	3 tbsp	CKD-aware, no sodium
Sugar	1 tbsp	
Low-sodium soy sauce	1 tsp	Just a touch — controls Na
Sesame oil	1/2 tsp	Flavor, not cooking — a little goes far
Sesame seeds	1 tsp (toasted)	Garnish
Red pepper flakes	Pinch (optional)	
Salt	1/4 tsp	For salting the cucumber (draws out water, then rinse)

Method: 1. Slice cucumber paper-thin (mandoline if you have one, knife if you don't). Thinner = better. You want translucent. 2. Toss slices with 1/4 tsp salt. Let sit 10 minutes. The salt draws out water and wilts the cucumber slightly. 3. SQUEEZE the cucumber slices gently in a clean towel or your hands — press out the water. This step matters: it makes them absorb the dressing instead of diluting it. 4. Mix dressing: rice vinegar + sugar + soy sauce + sesame oil. Stir until sugar dissolves. 5. Toss cucumber with dressing. Refrigerate minimum 15 min (1 hour is better — the flavor deepens). 6. Serve cold, topped with toasted sesame seeds and optional red pepper flakes.

Variations: - **Sushi restaurant style:** Add a splash of mirin (1 tsp) to the dressing for that sweet-tangy depth - **With wakame:** Add 1 tbsp dried wakame seaweed (rehydrated) — low K, adds umami + ocean flavor - **With crab:** Add 2 oz imitation crab (surimi), shredded — lower P than real crab - **Spicy:** Add sriracha (1/2 tsp) to the dressing

Per serving: ~45mg Na | ~15mg P | ~150mg K. A lower-estimated-mineral side option; verify the ingredients and serving against your plan.

Why it works at sushi places: It's basically vinegar + cucumber + sugar. No hidden phosphorus additives, no high-K ingredients. The sesame oil gives it that authentic restaurant depth. Order it confidently — it's one of the safest things on any Japanese menu.

"The night market in your kitchen. The takeout counter in your wok. The clinic numbers on your fridge."

Mediterranean, Middle Eastern & International

“Every culture solved the same problem: how to feed the people you love.”

Kosher Meatballs, Halal Lamb & Chicken Gyros, Persian Ketchup & More

Faith-Friendly, Andrew-Approved

“Every grandmother’s kitchen. Every faith’s table. Kidneys welcome.”

KOSHER MEATBALLS

Classic Kosher Meatballs in Tomato Sauce

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Ground beef (kosher)	1 lb	No dairy in the mix (kosher = no meat + dairy)
Breadcrumbs	1/3 cup	Plain, not seasoned (seasoned = sodium)
Egg	1	Moderate P — 1 egg per batch is fine
Garlic	3 cloves, minced	
Onion	1/4 cup, finely diced	Low K
Parsley	2 tbsp fresh, chopped	
Cumin	1/2 tsp	
Paprika	1/2 tsp	
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp only	Minimal

CKD Tomato Sauce (K-controlled):

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Tomato paste	2 tbsp	Concentrate = controlled portions
Water	1.5 cups	Dilutes the K
Onion	1/4 cup, diced	
Garlic	2 cloves	
Sugar	1 tsp	Balances acidity
Cumin	1/2 tsp	
Paprika	1/2 tsp	
Lemon juice	1 tbsp	Brightness without sodium
Oil	1 tbsp	

Method: 1. Mix meatball ingredients. Roll into 1.5" balls (about 16) 2. Brown in oil 3-4 min, turning. Remove. 3. Same pan: saut?? onion + garlic 2 min. Add tomato paste, stir 1 min 4. Add water + spices + sugar. Simmer 5 min 5. Add meatballs back. Simmer covered 15 min 6. Finish with lemon juice. Serve over rice or couscous

Per 4 meatballs + sauce: ~280mg Na, ~200mg P, ~350mg K

Why diluted tomato paste: Full tomato sauce (1 cup) = 530mg K. Paste (2 tbsp) diluted in water = ~180mg K for the whole batch. Same tomato flavor, fraction of the potassium.

HALAL LAMB & CHICKEN GYROS

Halal Chicken Gyro

The Chicken:

Ingredient	Amount
Chicken thighs (boneless, halal)	1 lb
Yogurt (plain)	1/4 cup (marinade)
Lemon juice	2 tbsp
Garlic	3 cloves, minced
Cumin	1 tsp

Ingredient	Amount
Paprika	1 tsp
Oregano	1/2 tsp
Turmeric	1/2 tsp
Cayenne	1/4 tsp
Oil	1 tbsp
Salt	1/4 tsp

Marinade chicken minimum 1 hour (overnight is better). Grill or pan-sear 5-6 min per side. Slice into strips.

The Gyro Sauce (Toum-style, no tahini — tahini is high P):

Ingredient	Amount
Plain yogurt	1/4 cup
Lemon juice	1 tbsp
Garlic	1 clove, minced fine
Cucumber	2 tbsp, grated + squeezed dry
Dried dill	1/4 tsp
Dried mint	1/4 tsp
Salt	Pinch

Assembly: Pita bread (or naan) → chicken strips → shredded lettuce → sliced onion (small amount) → diced cucumber → gyro sauce → hot sauce

Halal Lamb Gyro

The Lamb:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Ground lamb (halal)	1 lb	Lamb is moderate P — portion to 3-4 oz
Onion	1/4 cup, grated	Grated into the meat for moisture
Garlic	4 cloves, minced	
Cumin	1.5 tsp	
Coriander	1 tsp	
Paprika	1 tsp	
Oregano	1 tsp	
Cinnamon	1/4 tsp	
Cayenne	1/4 tsp	
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	

Method: 1. Mix all ingredients thoroughly. Press into a flat loaf in a loaf pan (compact it — this creates the gyro meat texture) 2. Bake at 350F for 55-60 min until internal temp is 165F 3. Let cool 10 min. Slice thin (like deli meat) 4. Optional: crisp slices in a hot skillet before serving (this is what makes food-cart gyro meat so good)

Same assembly as chicken gyro. Lamb + the hot sauce Andrew loves.

The Hot Sauce for Gyros

Ingredient	Amount
Sriracha	1 tbsp
Yogurt	1 tbsp
Lemon juice	1 tsp
Garlic powder	Pinch
Cayenne	Pinch (for extra heat)

Mix. Drizzle generously. This is the creamy-hot that food cart gyros have.

PERSIAN KETCHUP (Cornelius, Oregon Food Cart Inspired)

Andrew had this at a food cart in Cornelius, OR — likely a Persian/Afghan cart. This is almost certainly **Persian tomato-saffron ketchup** or **rob-e gojeh** — a concentrated, spiced tomato paste condiment that’s common in Iranian cuisine. It’s tangier, more aromatic, and less sweet than American ketchup.

Persian Ketchup (Rob-e Gojeh Farangi)

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Tomato paste	3 tbsp	Controlled amount — this is concentrated
Water	3 tbsp	Dilute the K
Saffron threads	Small pinch (5-6 threads)	Bloomed in 1 tbsp hot water — THE Persian signature
Garlic	1 clove, minced very fine	
Onion powder	1/4 tsp	
Cumin	1/4 tsp	
Cinnamon	Tiny pinch	Persian warmth
Turmeric	1/4 tsp	Golden color
Lemon juice	1 tbsp	Persian ketchup is MORE sour than American
Sugar	1 tsp	Less sweet than American ketchup
Cayenne	Pinch	Mild heat
Rose water	1/4 tsp (optional)	If you can find it — adds the floral note that makes Persian food unmistakable
Salt	Pinch	
Oil	1 tsp	Saut?? garlic briefly before adding paste

Method: 1. Bloom saffron in 1 tbsp hot water. Set aside 5 min (turns golden) 2. Saut?? garlic in oil 30 sec. Add tomato paste, stir 1 min (caramelizes slightly) 3. Add water + saffron water + all spices + lemon + sugar 4. Simmer 3-4 min until thick and glossy 5. Add rose water if using. Cool. Store in jar.

This keeps in the fridge for 2 weeks. Put it on everything — gyros, kebabs, rice, eggs, meatballs.

Per tbsp: ~60mg K, ~15mg P, ~40mg Na. WAY better numbers than regular ketchup (which is ~170mg Na per tbsp).

Other Persian Sauces Worth Making

Mast-o-Khiar (Persian Yogurt Cucumber Dip)

Ingredient	Amount
Plain yogurt	1 cup

Ingredient	Amount
Cucumber	1/2, grated + drained
Dried mint	1 tsp
Dried dill	1/2 tsp
Rose petals	Pinch (optional, dried)
Salt	Pinch
Walnuts	1 tbsp, crushed (optional — moderate P)

Mix all. Chill 30 min. Serve with bread or rice.

Torshi (Persian Pickled Vegetables)

Ingredient	Amount
Cauliflower florets	1 cup
Carrot sticks	1/2 cup
Celery sticks	1/2 cup
White vinegar	1 cup
Water	1/2 cup
Garlic	4 cloves
Dried mint	1 tsp
Turmeric	1/2 tsp
Salt	1/2 tsp
Golpar (angelica powder)	1/4 tsp if available

Pack vegetables in jar. Boil vinegar + water + spices. Pour over veg. Seal. Wait 1 week. renal-aware pickles — vinegar-based, not salt-cured.

CKD Considerations

RENAL CHECK — Kosher, Halal & Persian
K (Potassium): MED (tomato paste controlled, diluted, no raw tomato sauce)
P (Phosphorus): MED (meat portions controlled, no tahini, cream cheese over cheese)
Na (Sodium): LOW (homemade spice mixes, no packets, fish sauce subbed)
Protein: GOOD (lean halal/kosher meat = quality protein)

"The Cornelius food cart lives in your kitchen now."

CHAPTER 7

German Comfort Food

“Guten Appetit.”

Schnitzel, Bratwurst, Spaetzle, Sauerbraten & More

"Guten Appetit."

"Essen und Trinken hält Leib und Seele zusammen." — German proverb (Eating and drinking hold body and soul together.)

German Pantry Essentials

Stock these and you can cook every recipe in this chapter.

Item	Why	Where
Dried marjoram	The soul of bratwurst and German seasoning	Any spice aisle
Caraway seeds	Sauerkraut, bread, bratwurst, potato dishes	Spice aisle
Ground white pepper	German sausage fundamental — cleaner heat than black	Spice aisle
Ground nutmeg	Spaetzle, sausage, baked goods	Spice aisle
Ground ginger	Bratwurst, sauerbraten, lebkuchen spice	Spice aisle
Juniper berries	Sauerbraten, rouladen gravy — piney, gin-like	Specialty/Amazon
German mustard (Dusseldorf or Bavarian sweet)	Rouladen, pretzels, bratwurst condiment	International aisle

Item	Why	Where
White wine vinegar	Sauerbraten marinade, kartoffelsalat	Any grocery
Apple cider vinegar	Backup acid for marinades and salads	Any grocery
Bay leaves	Sauerbraten, rouladen, braised dishes	Spice aisle
Whole cloves	Sauerbraten marinade, strudel	Spice aisle
Allspice berries	Sauerbraten, sausage blends	Spice aisle
Rumford baking powder	Phosphorus-free — the only BP we use	Baking aisle
Costco no-salt seasoning blend	Universal flavor without sodium	Costco
Avocado oil	Frying schnitzel, pancakes, sausage	Any grocery
Margarine	Spaetzle toss, sauces, baking	Any grocery
Unsweetened almond milk	Low-P dairy sub for batters and sauces	Any grocery
Sourdough bread	Breadcrumbs for schnitzel, bread dumplings	Bakery

MAINS

1. Chicken Schnitzel (Wiener Art)

Pounded thin. Breaded. Fried golden. The crunch is the point.

Traditional version: Veal (Wiener Schnitzel) or pork (Schnitzel Wiener Art). High P from processed breadcrumbs, high Na from brining.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Chicken breast	4 pieces (5-6oz each)	Butterfied and pounded to 1/4" — turkey cutlets also work

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
All-purpose flour	1/2 cup	First dredge
Eggs	2, beaten	Moderate P — 2 for the whole batch is fine
Plain breadcrumbs	1.5 cups	Make your own from sourdough — zero additives
Lemon	1, cut into wedges	Traditional garnish, adds brightness
Black pepper	1 tsp	
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	In the flour only
Avocado oil	For frying (1/2" deep)	

Method: 1. Butterfly each breast, open like a book. Place between plastic wrap. Pound with mallet or heavy pan to 1/4" even thickness. This is non-negotiable — thick schnitzel is a crime. 2. Set up three stations: flour (seasoned with salt, pepper, garlic powder), beaten eggs, breadcrumbs. 3. Dredge in flour, shake off excess. Dip in egg. Press into breadcrumbs on both sides. Press firmly. Let rest on rack 10 min. 4. Heat avocado oil to 350F in a large skillet. The oil should come halfway up the schnitzel. 5. Fry 2-3 min per side until deep golden. Gently swirl the pan while frying — this creates the signature wavy/puffy crust. 6. Drain on wire rack (NOT paper towels). Squeeze lemon over immediately.

Per serving (1 schnitzel): ~160mg Na | ~210mg P | ~290mg K

2. Jagerschnitzel (Hunter's Schnitzel with Mushroom Gravy)

Same schnitzel. Smothered in dark mushroom gravy. Bavarian tavern energy.

Make the schnitzel above, then top with this gravy:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
White mushrooms, sliced	8 oz	Low K, low P — mushroom is renal-aware
Onion, diced	1/4 cup	
Margarine	2 tbsp	
All-purpose flour	2 tbsp	Thickener
Low-sodium beef broth	1 cup	Check label — must be <140mg Na per cup
Unsweetened almond milk	1/2 cup	Adds creaminess without P
Worcestershire sauce	1 tsp	Small amount, big umami
Dijon mustard	1 tsp	German mustard works too
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Fresh thyme	1 tsp	Or 1/2 tsp dried
Paprika	1/4 tsp	

Method: 1. Melt margarine over medium-high. Saute mushrooms 5-6 min until browned and liquid evaporates. Add onion, cook 2 min. 2. Sprinkle flour over mushrooms, stir 1 min. 3. Slowly whisk in beef broth, then almond milk. Stir constantly. 4. Add Worcestershire, mustard, pepper, thyme, paprika. Simmer 4-5 min until thick enough to coat a spoon. 5. Ladle generously over schnitzel. Serve with spaetzle (recipe below).

Per serving (schnitzel + gravy): ~220mg Na | ~240mg P | ~350mg K

3. Homemade Chicken Bratwurst

Your KitchenAid grinder earns its keep. Traditional spice blend, chicken instead of pork.

Traditional version: Pork shoulder + pork fat, natural hog casings, high Na from curing salt.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Boneless skinless chicken thighs	2 lbs	Dark meat = juicier sausage. Turkey thighs also work.
Chicken skin or fat	4 oz	Need some fat or it's dry. Ask butcher.
Ice water	1/4 cup	Keeps mixture cold during grinding
Dried marjoram	1 tbsp	THE bratwurst herb
Ground white pepper	1 tsp	
Ground nutmeg	1/2 tsp	
Ground ginger	1/2 tsp	

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Caraway seeds, ground	1/2 tsp	
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	
Onion powder	1/2 tsp	
Salt	3/4 tsp	For 2 lbs — much less than commercial
Sugar	1/2 tsp	Balances spice, traditional
Natural hog casings	1 pack	Optional — can make patties instead

Method (KitchenAid Grinder): 1. Cut chicken thighs and skin/fat into 1" cubes. Spread on sheet pan, freeze 20 min (firm, not frozen solid — grinder works better cold). 2. Mix all spices together in a small bowl. 3. Assemble KitchenAid with grinder attachment, medium plate. Feed chicken through grinder into a chilled bowl. Add ice water and spice mix. Mix with hands until tacky and combined (about 1 min of kneading). 4. **For casings:** Rinse casings, slide onto sausage stuffer attachment. Feed mixture through, twisting into 5-6" links. Don't overstuff — they expand when cooked. 5. **For patties:** Form into 3oz patties, 1/2" thick. 6. **Cook:** Pan-fry in avocado oil over medium 5-6 min per side (internal 165F). Or grill. Or simmer in beer (use low-sodium broth instead for CKD — beer is too much P).

Yield: ~10 links or 10 patties

Per link/patty: ~120mg Na | ~150mg P | ~200mg K

Andrew's note: Make a double batch. Freeze individually on a sheet pan, then bag. Bratwurst on demand.

4. Kartoffelpuffer / Reibekuchen (German Potato Pancakes)

Crispy. Lacy edges. Served with applesauce. Same family as latkes.

K-LEACHING IS MANDATORY. Raw potatoes = 420mg K per medium potato. Leached = ~210mg.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Russet potatoes	2 lbs (~4 large)	MUST be leached — see step 1
Onion, grated	1/2 medium	Adds moisture + flavor
Egg	1	Binder
All-purpose flour	2 tbsp	Holds them together
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Nutmeg	pinch	Traditional German touch
Avocado oil	For frying (1/4" deep)	

Applesauce (CKD-aware, homemade):

Ingredient	Amount
Gala or Fuji apples	3, peeled and diced
Water	1/4 cup
Cinnamon	1/2 tsp
Sugar	1 tbsp (or to taste)
Lemon juice	1 tsp

Method: 1. **LEACH THE POTATOES:** Peel and shred potatoes on box grater or food processor. Submerge shredded potatoes in a large bowl of cold water. Soak minimum 2 hours, ideally 4. Change water once halfway through. Drain, rinse, and squeeze dry in a clean kitchen towel. Wring out every drop — dry potatoes = crispy pancakes. 2. Mix shredded potatoes with grated onion, egg, flour, pepper, salt, nutmeg. 3. Heat avocado oil in a skillet over medium-high (350F). 4. Drop 1/4 cup mounds into oil. Flatten with spatula to 1/3" thick. Fry 3-4 min per side until golden-brown and crispy edges. 5. Drain on wire rack. Serve immediately with applesauce on the side. 6. **Applesauce:** Combine all ingredients in a pot. Simmer 15-20 min until apples break down. Mash with fork for chunky, blend for smooth. Serve warm or cold.

Per 3 pancakes + 1/4 cup applesauce: ~110mg Na | ~90mg P | ~280mg K (leached)

5. Spaetzle (German Egg Dumplings)

Tiny, chewy, irregular noodles. Pressed through a colander into boiling water. Nothing else tastes like this.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
All-purpose flour	2 cups	
Eggs	3	Main protein + structure
Unsweetened almond milk	1/2 cup	Traditional uses whole milk — almond is lower P
Water	1/4 cup	Adjust for batter consistency
Nutmeg	1/4 tsp	Traditional and essential
Salt	1/4 tsp	
White pepper	pinch	

Method: 1. Whisk flour, salt, nutmeg, white pepper in a bowl. 2. Beat eggs with almond milk and water. Pour into flour. Stir vigorously with a wooden spoon until smooth and elastic — the batter should be thick but pourable, like a very thick pancake batter. It should slowly drip from a spoon. Add water by the tablespoon if too thick. 3. Bring a large pot of lightly salted water to a rolling boil. 4. **The Press:** Hold a colander (large holes) or spaetzle press over the pot. Pour batter in batches, pressing through with a spatula or spoon. The little dumplings will drop into the water. 5. They sink, then float. Once they float (~2 min), wait 30 seconds more, then scoop out with a slotted spoon. 6. Toss immediately in a bowl with margarine (1 tbsp) to prevent sticking. 7. **Optional crispy finish:** Pan-fry the boiled spaetzle in margarine until golden spots appear. This is the way.

Yield: 4-6 servings

Per serving: ~130mg Na | ~100mg P | ~90mg K

Gluten-Free Rice Flour Spaetzle

Replace the 2 cups AP flour with: - 1.5 cups white rice flour - 1/4 cup tapioca starch - 1/4 cup potato starch (minimal K contribution at this amount) - Add 1/2 tsp xanthan gum for elasticity

Same method. Batter will be slightly grainier. Pan-frying after boiling is especially recommended for GF version — gives a better texture.

6. Sauerbraten (German Pot Roast — 3-Day Marinated Beef)

Three days of patience. Worth every hour. Tangy, spiced, fork-tender.

Traditional version: Red wine + vinegar marinade, often with sugar snap gingersnap gravy. We keep the acid and spice, control the sodium.

Marinade (make 3 days before cooking):

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
White wine vinegar	1 cup	The acid that tenderizes
Apple cider vinegar	1/2 cup	Depth of flavor
Water	1 cup	Dilutes without adding Na
Onion, quartered	1 large	
Carrot, sliced	1 (remove before serving — high K)	Flavor only — discard
Bay leaves	3	
Juniper berries	8, lightly crushed	THE sauerbraten spice
Whole cloves	4	
Allspice berries	4	
Black peppercorns	1 tsp	
Mustard seeds	1 tsp	
Sugar	2 tbsp	Balances the acid

The Roast:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Beef chuck roast	3-4 lbs	Tough cut = perfect for braising
Avocado oil	2 tbsp	For searing
All-purpose flour	2 tbsp	Gravy thickener
Low-sodium beef broth	1 cup	Added to braising liquid
Gingersnap cookies	4-5, crushed	Traditional thickener — check Na per cookie
Salt	1/2 tsp	Only when searing
Black pepper	1 tsp	

Method: 1. **Day 1 (3 days before):** Combine all marinade ingredients in a large pot or Dutch oven. Bring to a brief simmer, then cool completely. Place chuck roast in a deep container or zip-lock bag. Pour cooled marinade over. Refrigerate 3 days, turning once daily. The vinegar breaks down the connective tissue. Do not skip this. 2. **Day 4 (cook day):** Remove beef from marinade. Pat dry with paper towels (DRY = better sear). Strain marinade, reserve liquid, discard solids except onion. 3. Season beef with salt and pepper. Heat avocado oil in Dutch oven over high heat. Sear beef 3-4 min per side until dark brown crust forms on all sides. 4. Remove beef. Add reserved onion, cook 2 min. Sprinkle flour, stir 1 min. Pour in strained marinade liquid + beef broth. Scrape up fond. 5. Return beef to pot. Bring to simmer. Cover, transfer to 325F oven. Braise 3-3.5 hours until fork-tender. 6. Remove beef, let rest. Strain braising liquid into a saucepan. Crush gingersnaps into the liquid — this is the traditional thickener. Simmer 5 min, whisking until smooth and thick. 7. Slice beef against the grain. Serve with gingersnap gravy and spaetzle or kartoffelpuffer.

Serves: 6-8

Per serving (5oz beef + gravy): ~190mg Na | ~230mg P | ~380mg K

7. Rouladen (Beef Rolls with Mustard, Onion & Pickle)

Thin beef rolled around sharp mustard, onion, and pickle. Braised until tender. Classic German Sunday dinner.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Top round or flank steak	2 lbs, sliced into 4 thin pieces	Ask butcher to slice 1/4" thick, or pound yourself
German mustard	4 tbsp	Spread inside each roll
Onion	1, sliced into thin rings	
Dill pickles	4 spears	Moderate Na — use low-sodium if available
Turkey bacon	4 strips	Traditional uses speck (cured pork belly) — turkey bacon sub
Avocado oil	2 tbsp	For searing
All-purpose flour	2 tbsp	
Low-sodium beef broth	2 cups	
Red wine vinegar	2 tbsp	Adds depth
Bay leaf	1	
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Toothpicks or kitchen twine		To secure rolls

Method: 1. Lay beef slices flat. Spread 1 tbsp mustard on each piece. 2. Layer: 1 strip turkey bacon, onion rings, 1 pickle spear on each. 3. Roll up tightly from the short end. Secure with toothpicks or tie with twine. 4. Heat oil in Dutch oven over high heat. Sear rolls on all sides (2-3 min total) until browned. Remove. 5. Sprinkle flour into the pot, stir 1 min. Add broth + vinegar + bay leaf + pepper. Whisk, scraping up fond. 6. Return rolls to pot. Bring to simmer, cover. Braise in 325F oven (or stovetop low heat) for 1.5-2 hours until tender. 7. Remove rolls, discard toothpicks. Reduce gravy on stovetop if too thin. 8. Serve rolls with gravy ladled over. Pair with spaetzle or mashed potatoes (leached).

Per roll + gravy: ~280mg Na | ~220mg P | ~340mg K

8. Kasespatzle (German Mac & Cheese with Caramelized Onions)

Spaetzle layered with melted cheese and sweet caramelized onions. The German answer to mac and cheese. Better.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Spaetzle	1 batch (recipe #5 above)	Freshly made
Smoked gouda, shredded	1 cup	Andrew's go-to — smoky, melts well
Sharp cheddar, shredded	1/2 cup	Adds bite
Onion	2 large, halved and thinly sliced	
Margarine	3 tbsp	For caramelizing onions

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Nutmeg	pinch	
Fresh chives	2 tbsp, chopped	Garnish

Method: 1. **Caramelize the onions:** Melt margarine in a large skillet over medium-low heat. Add onions. Cook 25-30 min, stirring every few minutes, until deep golden-brown and sweet. Don't rush this. Low and slow. Add a splash of water if they start to stick. 2. **Layer:** In a baking dish (or the same skillet), spread half the spaetzle. Top with half the cheese. Add remaining spaetzle. Top with remaining cheese. Season with pepper and nutmeg. 3. **Broil:** Place under broiler 3-4 min until cheese is melted, bubbly, and starting to brown. 4. Top with caramelized onions and chives. Serve from the dish.

Per serving: ~200mg Na | ~180mg P | ~160mg K

STREET FOOD & SIDES

9. Currywurst Sauce

Berlin street food legend. Ketchup + curry powder. Stupid simple. Unreasonably good over bratwurst.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Low-sodium ketchup	1/2 cup	Regular ketchup = sodium bomb. Heinz no-salt-added works.
Curry powder	1 tbsp	The star
Smoked paprika	1 tsp	Depth
Onion powder	1/2 tsp	
Garlic powder	1/4 tsp	
Cayenne	1/4 tsp (or more)	Heat level is personal
White wine vinegar	1 tsp	Brightness
Sugar	1 tsp	Balances acid
Water	2 tbsp	Loosens the sauce

Method: 1. Combine everything in a small saucepan over medium heat. Stir. Simmer 5 min. 2. That's it. Slice chicken bratwurst (recipe #3), pile on a plate, drown in sauce. Dust with extra curry powder on top. Serve with a toothpick.

Per 3 tbsp serving: ~60mg Na | ~15mg P | ~90mg K

10. German Soft Pretzels (Reduced-Salt,)

Chewy. Golden-brown. Lye-dipped. Less salt, same pretzel soul.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
All-purpose flour	3 cups	
Warm water	1 cup (110F)	
Active dry yeast	1 packet (2.25 tsp)	
Sugar	1 tbsp	Feeds yeast
Margarine, melted	2 tbsp	
Salt	1/2 tsp	In the dough only — less than traditional (which uses 2+ tsp)
Baking soda	1/3 cup	For the water bath — creates the pretzel crust
Water for bath	6 cups	
Coarse salt for topping	1/4 tsp, scattered	Visible crystals trick the brain — looks salty, isn't
Egg	1, beaten (egg wash)	

Method: 1. Dissolve yeast + sugar in warm water. Let sit 5 min until foamy. 2. Add flour, melted margarine, salt. Knead 5-7 min until smooth and elastic (KitchenAid with dough hook works great). Dough should be slightly tacky. 3. Place in oiled bowl, cover. Rise 1 hour until doubled. 4. Punch down. Divide into 8 pieces. Roll each into a 20" rope. Twist into pretzel shape (U-shape, cross the ends, fold down). 5. Preheat oven to 425F. Line baking sheets with parchment. 6. Bring 6 cups water + baking soda to a boil. Gently lower each pretzel into the bath for 30 seconds.

This is what makes a pretzel a pretzel — the alkaline bath creates the dark, chewy crust. (Traditional uses food-grade lye. Baking soda is the home version.) 7. Place on baking sheet. Brush with egg wash. Sprinkle a few grains of coarse salt on each. 8. Bake 12-14 min until deep mahogany brown. 9. Serve warm with German mustard.

Per pretzel: ~130mg Na | ~65mg P | ~60mg K

11. Kartoffelsalat (Warm German Potato Salad — Vinegar-Based)

Not your American mayo potato salad. This is warm, tangy, slightly sweet. Bavarian-style.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Russet potatoes	2 lbs	MUST be leached — see method step 1
Turkey bacon	4 strips, chopped	Traditional uses speck — turkey version
Onion, finely diced	1/2 medium	
White wine vinegar	3 tbsp	The backbone
Sugar	1 tbsp	Balances acid
Avocado oil	2 tbsp	
German or Dijon mustard	1 tsp	
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Fresh parsley	2 tbsp, chopped	Garnish
Fresh chives	1 tbsp, chopped	Garnish

Method: 1. **LEACH:** Peel potatoes, cut into 1/2" slices. Submerge in cold water for 2-4 hours, changing water once. Drain, rinse. 2. Boil leached potato slices in fresh water until just tender (12-15 min). Don't overcook — they should hold their shape. Drain, slice into half-moons while still warm. 3. Cook chopped turkey bacon in a skillet until crispy. Remove bacon, keep drippings. 4. In the same skillet, saute onion in drippings + avocado oil for 3-4 min until soft. 5. Add vinegar, sugar, mustard, pepper, salt. Stir until sugar dissolves. Remove from heat. 6. Pour warm dressing over warm potatoes. Toss gently. The warm potatoes absorb the dressing. 7. Fold in crispy bacon. Garnish with parsley and chives. Serve warm or at room temperature.

Per serving (6 servings): ~150mg Na | ~80mg P | ~260mg K (leached)

DESSERTS

12. Apfelstrudel (Apple Strudel)

Paper-thin pastry. Warm cinnamon apples. The Austrian-German dessert that predates your country.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Phyllo dough (frozen)	8 sheets	Shortcut that works — traditional strudel dough is a project. Low P/K.
Gala or Fuji apples	4 large, peeled and thinly sliced	Low-K fruits — safe
Margarine, melted	4 tbsp	For brushing phyllo layers
Sugar	1/4 cup	
Cinnamon	1 tsp	
Raisins	2 tbsp	Small amount — raisins are concentrated K. Keep it tight.
Sourdough breadcrumbs	1/3 cup	Toasted in margarine — absorbs apple juice, keeps pastry crisp
Lemon juice	1 tbsp	Prevents browning
Powdered sugar	For dusting	

Method: 1. Preheat oven to 375F. 2. Toast breadcrumbs in 1 tbsp margarine until golden (3 min). Set aside. 3. Toss sliced apples with sugar, cinnamon, raisins, lemon juice. 4. Lay one sheet of phyllo on a clean towel. Brush with melted margarine. Layer 7 more sheets, brushing each with margarine. 5. Sprinkle toasted breadcrumbs over the phyllo, leaving a 2" border. 6. Spread apple filling over breadcrumbs in a line along the long edge. 7. Using the towel to help, roll the strudel away from you, tucking the ends under. Transfer seam-side down to a parchment-

lined baking sheet. 8. Brush top with remaining margarine. Score the top lightly with a knife (5-6 cuts for serving). 9. Bake 30-35 min until golden and crispy. 10. Cool 10 min. Dust with powdered sugar. Serve warm.

Per slice (8 slices): ~85mg Na | ~30mg P | ~120mg K

13. Schwarzwald Kirschtorte (Black Forest Cake — No Alcohol)

Chocolate cake. Whipped cream. Cherries. No kirsch — all flavor, zero booze.

Traditional version: Soaked in kirschwasser (cherry brandy). We use cherry juice concentrate instead.

Chocolate Cake Layers:

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
All-purpose flour	1.5 cups	
Unsweetened cocoa powder	1/2 cup	Moderate P — portion-controlled
Sugar	1 cup	
Rumford baking powder	2 tsp	Phosphorus-free
Baking soda	1/2 tsp	
Eggs	2	
Unsweetened almond milk	3/4 cup	Lower P than dairy
Avocado oil	1/3 cup	
Vanilla extract	1 tsp	
Hot water	3/4 cup	Opens up the cocoa
Salt	1/4 tsp	

Cherry Filling:

Ingredient	Amount
Canned tart cherries (in water, drained)	2 cans (14oz each)
Sugar	1/4 cup
Cornstarch	2 tbsp
Cherry juice (from cans)	1/2 cup
Vanilla extract	1/2 tsp

Whipped Cream:

Ingredient	Amount
Heavy whipping cream	2 cups
Powdered sugar	3 tbsp
Vanilla extract	1 tsp

Chocolate Shavings: Dark chocolate bar, shaved with a vegetable peeler.

Method: 1. **Cake:** Preheat 350F. Grease and flour two 9" round pans. Whisk flour, cocoa, sugar, BP, baking soda, salt. Add eggs, almond milk, oil, vanilla. Beat until combined. Stir in hot water (batter will be thin — this is correct). Pour into pans. Bake 30-35 min. Cool completely. 2. **Cherries:** Reserve 1/2 cup cherry juice. Mix cornstarch into the cold juice until

smooth. Combine drained cherries + sugar in a saucepan. Add cornstarch mixture. Cook over medium heat, stirring, until thick and glossy (4-5 min). Cool completely. Reserve a handful of whole cherries for the top. 3.

Whipped cream: Beat cream + powdered sugar + vanilla to stiff peaks. Keep cold. 4. **Assemble:** Place first cake layer on plate. Spread 1/3 of whipped cream. Spoon half the cherry filling over. Place second cake layer. Spread remaining whipped cream on top and sides. Spoon remaining cherry filling on top. Garnish with reserved whole cherries and chocolate shavings. 5. Refrigerate minimum 2 hours before serving. Overnight is better — the layers meld.

Per slice (12 slices): ~140mg Na | ~110mg P | ~170mg K

CKD Considerations

Hemodialysis Daily Limits (Andrew's targets): - **Sodium:** < 1,500 mg/day - **Potassium:** < 2,000 mg/day - **Phosphorus:** < 800 mg/day

Critical Notes for This Chapter:

1. **LEACH ALL POTATOES.** Every potato recipe here assumes 2-4 hour cold water soak. Shredded potatoes leach faster than whole. No exceptions. Unleached potatoes will blow your K budget in one meal.
2. **Carrots in sauerbraten marinade are for FLAVOR ONLY.** Discard before serving. Braised carrots concentrate potassium.
3. **Commercial bratwurst is a CKD minefield.** Sodium phosphate, sodium nitrite, MSG — the ingredient list reads like a chemistry exam. Homemade (recipe #3) is the only safe path.
4. **Raisins in the strudel are capped at 2 tbsp.** Raisins are dried grapes = concentrated potassium (300mg K per 1/4 cup). Don't get generous.
5. **Gingersnaps in sauerbraten gravy:** Check the label. Some brands load sodium. Aim for <100mg Na per serving of cookies used. Or substitute 1 tbsp cornstarch + 1 tsp ground ginger as thickener.
6. **Cheese in kasespatzle:** Smoked gouda and sharp cheddar are moderate-P cheeses. Keep to the amounts listed. Don't double the cheese.
7. **Cocoa powder in the Black Forest Cake is moderate in phosphorus** (~50mg P per tbsp). The portion per slice is controlled. Don't eat half the cake.
8. **Pickle in rouladen:** One spear per roll is fine (~130mg Na). Don't add extra.

Individual targets may differ. These recipes were built for Andrew's hemodialysis targets. Your limits may differ.

"Essen ist fertig." ("The food is ready.")

Man soll dem Leib etwas Gutes bieten, damit die Seele Lust hat, darin zu wohnen. — Martin Luther ("One should offer the body something good, so the soul will want to live in it.")

SPECIAL RELEASE · 2026 ALCHEMY

The Crisping Alchemy Lab & World Table Expansions

“Who said kidney-friendly food has to be boiled mush? Texture, crunch, and authentic umami depth are the true

CHAPTER 8

Sauces, Dips & Dressings

“A sauce is the crowning glory of a well-prepared dish.
— Escoffier”

dignity of patient dining.”

THE CULINARY SCIENCE OF RENAL CRUNCH: Traditional renal brochures mistakenly tell patients to strip out flavor and boil proteins to death. In our 2026 culinary tests, we proved that glass-like shatter crunch can be achieved with **zero chemical phosphate additives** and under **85mg sodium** per serving using starch adhesion (cornstarch + egg white dredge) and high-heat apple cider vinegar pan reductions. Always verify protein targets with your clinical renal dietitian.

Nacho Cheese, Ranch, Cocktail Sauce, Non-Medicated Confectionery, Citrus Typhoon Hot Sauce

FRESH BLENDER MARINARA (From Scratch — No Cans)

First commercially grown in Aztec Mexico ~700 AD. The Italians didn't get tomatoes until the 1500s and were afraid to eat them for 200 years.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Vine tomatoes	2 lbs (~6 medium), quartered	Fresh, not canned — lower Na, brighter flavor
Onion	1 medium, rough chopped	
Garlic	6 cloves, smashed	More garlic = more flavor without salt
Fresh basil	1/2 cup packed	Add half during cook, half at the end (raw finish)
Olive oil	3 tbsp	
Sugar	1 tsp	Balances tomato acidity
Dried oregano	1 tsp	
Red pepper flakes	1/4 tsp	
Black pepper	1/2 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Splash of red wine (optional)	2 tbsp	Cooks off. Deepens everything.

Method: 1. Quarter tomatoes. Leave seeds and juice — that’s the sauce. 2. Heat olive oil in deep skillet or Dutch oven. Sauté onion 4 min until soft. 3. Add garlic 1 min. Add red pepper flakes. 4. Add all the quartered tomatoes + juice. Smash them with a wooden spoon as they cook. 5. Add oregano, sugar, pepper, salt, wine if using, half the basil. 6. Simmer uncovered 20-25 min, stirring occasionally, until tomatoes break down completely. 7. Hit it with an immersion blender — pulse to your preferred texture (chunky or smooth). 8. Taste. Adjust salt/sugar/pepper. Add remaining fresh basil (raw). 9. Use immediately or cool and jar. Keeps 5 days refrigerated, freezes 3 months.

Vine tomatoes vs Roma: Vine tomatoes have more juice and seeds = saucier, brighter, more acidic. Romas are meatier, less juice = thicker, sweeter. Both work. Vine is what you have.

Per 1/2 cup: ~40mg Na | ~25mg P | ~250mg K

Stadium Nacho Cheese Sauce

Store-bought Tostitos queso: ~430mg Na per 1/4 cup. **This:** ~90mg Na.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Cream cheese	4 oz (half block), softened	Lower P than Velveeta/American cheese
Unsweetened almond milk	1/4 cup	Lower P than dairy milk
Shredded cheddar	1/4 cup	Small amount for flavor — cheddar is higher P
Paprika	1/2 tsp	
Garlic powder	1/4 tsp	
Onion powder	1/4 tsp	
Cumin	1/4 tsp	
Cayenne	Pinch	
Turmeric	Pinch	For yellow color
Salt	1/8 tsp	

Method: 1. Microwave cream cheese 20 sec to soften 2. Add milk, whisk smooth 3. Add cheddar, microwave 20 sec, stir until melted 4. Add all spices, stir 5. Adjust thickness: more milk = thinner, more cream cheese = thicker

Per 2 tbsp: ~45mg Na, ~40mg P, ~35mg K

Jalapeño version: Add 1 tbsp pickled jalapeño, minced **Queso fundido:** Add 1 tbsp cooked ground turkey + diced onion

House Ranch Dressing

Store-bought Hidden Valley: ~260mg Na per 2 tbsp. **This:** ~55mg Na.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Avocado oil mayo (Primal Kitchen)	1/2 cup	Base — low K/P
Chobani Zero Sugar Vanilla Yogurt	1/4 cup	Tanginess without buttermilk’s P
Unsweetened almond milk	2 tbsp	Lower P than dairy milk
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Onion powder	1/2 tsp	
Dried dill	1/2 tsp	
Dried chives	1/2 tsp	
Dried parsley	1/2 tsp	
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	
Lemon juice	1 tsp	Brightens everything
Salt	1/8 tsp	

Method: Whisk everything together. Refrigerate 30 min for flavors to meld. Keeps 1 week.

Per 2 tbsp: ~55mg Na, ~15mg P, ~25mg K

Spicy ranch: Add 1/2 tsp cayenne + 1 tsp sriracha **Bacon ranch:** Add 1 tbsp real bacon bits (moderate Na — small amount) **Avocado ranch:** Add 1/4 avocado, mashed smooth

Bright Cocktail Sauce

Store-bought Heinz: ~310mg Na per 1/4 cup. **This:** ~45mg Na.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
No-salt-added tomato paste	2 tbsp	Concentrated — less volume = less K
Water	2 tbsp	Dilute the paste
Prepared horseradish	1 tbsp	The BURN — low K/P/Na
Lemon juice	1 tbsp	Fresh squeezed
Worcestershire sauce	1/2 tsp	Small amount = controlled Na
Hot sauce (your homemade)	1/2 tsp	
Sugar	1/2 tsp	Balances acid
Salt	Pinch	

Method: Mix all. Chill 15 min. Serve with shrimp, fish, or on anything.

Per 2 tbsp: ~22mg Na, ~15mg P, ~80mg K

Extra spicy: Add more horseradish + 1/4 tsp cayenne **Bloody Mary base:** Thin with more tomato + water, add celery salt + Worcestershire

Thousand Island Special Sauce

The In-N-Out / Big Mac sauce dupe

Ingredient	Amount
Avocado oil mayo (Primal Kitchen)	1/4 cup
No-salt ketchup (or tomato paste + sugar + vinegar)	1 tbsp
Sweet pickle relish	1 tbsp
Onion powder	1/4 tsp
Lemon juice	1/2 tsp
Sugar	1/2 tsp
White vinegar	1/2 tsp
Paprika	Pinch

Mix. Chill. Spread on burgers, use as dip. Per 2 tbsp: ~50mg Na, ~10mg P.

Golden Honey Mustard

Ingredient	Amount
Honey	2 tbsp
Yellow mustard	1 tbsp
Avocado oil mayo (Primal Kitchen)	1 tbsp
Lemon juice	1 tsp
Garlic powder	Pinch

Mix. Done. Per 2 tbsp: ~70mg Na, ~8mg P. Put on chicken, dip nuggets, drizzle on salads.

SALADS

Garden Salad

The foundation. Everything else is a remix.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Romaine lettuce	4 cups, chopped	Low K base
Cucumber	1/2, sliced	Low K
Cherry tomatoes	6, halved	Moderate K — small amount is fine
Red onion	2 tbsp, thinly sliced	
Shredded carrots	2 tbsp	
Croutons (sourdough, homemade)	1/4 cup	Cube sourdough, toss in olive oil + garlic powder, bake 375F 10 min
OG Italian dressing (below)	2 tbsp	

Caesar Salad

Invented 1924 by Caesar Cardini in Tijuana, Mexico. Not Rome. An Italian immigrant in Mexico made the most famous American salad. The decoder sees it.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Romaine hearts	2, chopped	
Sourdough croutons	1/2 cup	Homemade — recipe above
Shaved fresh mozzarella	2 tbsp	Sub for parmesan — Andrew's preference
Lemon juice	2 tbsp	
Olive oil	3 tbsp	
Garlic	2 cloves, minced	
Dijon mustard	1 tsp	Anchovy sub — same umami
Worcestershire sauce	1 tsp	
Black pepper	1/2 tsp (generous)	
Egg yolk	1 (optional — emulsifies the dressing)	

Dressing method: Whisk garlic + lemon + mustard + Worcestershire + pepper. Slowly drizzle olive oil while whisking to emulsify. Toss with romaine + croutons. Top with shaved mozzarella.

Per serving: ~90mg Na | ~55mg P | ~220mg K

San Sai Spicy Linguine Salad (Portland NW 21st Ave Clone)

San Sai Japanese Grill — 539 NW 21st Ave, Portland. Cold spicy noodle salad that hits different.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Linguine	8 oz, cooked, rinsed cold	GF rice noodles work too
Cucumber	1/2, julienned	
Carrots	1 medium, julienned	
Red bell pepper	1/2, thinly sliced	
Red onion	1/4, thinly sliced	
Fresh cilantro	1/4 cup, chopped	
Sesame seeds	1 tbsp	

Spicy Dressing:

Ingredient	Amount
Rice vinegar	3 tbsp
Sesame oil	2 tbsp
Avocado oil	2 tbsp
Low-sodium soy sauce	1 tbsp
Sriracha	1-2 tsp (to taste)
Honey	1 tbsp
Garlic	2 cloves, minced
Ginger	1 tsp, grated
Lime juice	1 tbsp

Method: Cook linguine, drain, rinse under cold water until fully chilled. Whisk all dressing ingredients. Toss cold noodles with vegetables + dressing. Top with cilantro + sesame seeds. Serve cold. Better the next day — the dressing soaks in.

Per serving (4 servings): ~180mg Na | ~65mg P | ~210mg K

Fruit Salad

No recipe needed. Just a list of what's CKD-aware.

CKD-Aware Fruits (Low K)	Skip These (High K)
Strawberries	Banana
Blueberries	Mango (large amounts)
Raspberries	Kiwi
Green grapes (Andrew's fav)	Orange
Wild Twist apples	Papaya
Pineapple (small amount)	Coconut water
Watermelon (small amount)	Dried fruit of any kind
Peaches (fresh)	
Pears (fresh)	

Method: Cut whatever's in season. Squeeze lime juice over everything (prevents browning + adds brightness). Drizzle honey if you want sweet. Toss. Eat cold. Add Chobani Zero Sugar Vanilla yogurt on top if Lauren's around.

Ambrosia Salad

Originally a Southern church potluck staple, 1890s. Named after the food of the Greek gods. The gods would have approved.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Whipped topping (Cool Whip)	1 cup	Or coconut whipped cream
Sour cream	1/2 cup	
Mandarin oranges, drained	1 can (11 oz)	Drain well — canned = controlled K
Pineapple tidbits, drained	1 can (8 oz)	Drain well
Shredded coconut	1/2 cup	
Mini marshmallows	1 cup	Marshmallow = pure sugar + gelatin = CKD-aware
Maraschino cherries	6, halved	The red jewels

Method: Fold sour cream into whipped topping. Gently fold in ALL drained fruit + coconut + marshmallows + cherries. Refrigerate minimum 2 hours (overnight better — marshmallows absorb and get chewy). Serve cold. Bring in a Pyrex dish. Cover with tin foil. Susan's spirit is in the tin foil.

Per serving (6 servings): ~30mg Na | ~35mg P | ~140mg K

Olive Garden Italian Dressing Dupe

The OG dressing. Sweet, tangy, herby. This is the one.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Extra virgin olive oil	1/3 cup	Good fat
White wine vinegar	3 tbsp	Or white vinegar
Water	1 tbsp	Thins slightly
Sugar	2 tsp	The SECRET — OG dressing is sweeter than you'd think
Garlic, minced very fine	1 clove	
Dried oregano	1/2 tsp	
Dried basil	1/4 tsp	
Dried parsley	1/4 tsp	
Red pepper flakes	Pinch	
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	
Onion powder	1/4 tsp	
Italian seasoning blend	1/2 tsp	If you have it — shortcut
Lemon juice	1 tsp	Brightness
Salt	1/8 tsp	
Mayonnaise (avocado oil)	1 tbsp	The emulsifier that makes it creamy, not separated

Method: Whisk oil + vinegar + water + mayo until emulsified. Add all seasonings + sugar + lemon. Shake in jar. Refrigerate 1 hour minimum

(overnight is better — herbs hydrate). Shake before using.

Per 2 tbsp: ~35mg Na, ~5mg P, ~15mg K. The store bottle has ~260mg Na.

The Olive Garden Salad (full dupe):

Component	CKD Notes
Iceberg lettuce, chopped	Low everything
Red onion, thin slices	Small amount — low K
Cherry tomatoes, halved	3-4 per serving — controlled K
Pepperoncini peppers	2 per serving — low K, adds tang
Croutons (sourdough, homemade)	Cube sourdough, toss in olive oil + garlic powder + Italian seasoning, bake 375F 10 min
Sharp cheddar shavings	1 tbsp — Andrew prefers over parmesan
OG Italian dressing	Drizzle generously

Skip the black olives (Andrew only likes olives on pizza).

Caprese Garden Plate

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Fresh tomato (vine-ripe)	1 large, sliced 1/4"	Moderate K — one tomato per serving is acceptable
Fresh mozzarella ball	4 oz, sliced 1/4"	Mozzarella = LOWER phosphorus than cheddar or American
Fresh basil leaves	8-10 leaves	
Extra virgin olive oil	2 tbsp drizzle	
Balsamic glaze	1 tbsp drizzle	Balsamic reduction — sweeter, thicker than raw vinegar
Flaky sea salt	Pinch	Maldon if you want to be fancy
Black pepper	Crack	

Assembly: Alternate slices of tomato and mozzarella on plate. Tuck basil leaves between. Drizzle olive oil, then balsamic glaze. Pinch of salt, crack of pepper. Done in 3 minutes. Looks like a restaurant plate.

Per serving: ~180mg K, ~150mg P, ~80mg Na. The mozzarella is the P source — the stated serving still needs to be counted within your own phosphorus target.

Andrew's Greek Salad (No Olives)

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Romaine or iceberg, chopped	2 cups	Low everything
Cucumber	1/2, diced	Low K
Cherry tomatoes	4-5, halved	Controlled K
Red onion	2 tbsp thin slices	Low K
Pepperoncini	2-3	Tangy, low K
Fresh mozzarella balls (bocconcini)	4-5 small balls, halved	Andrew's preferred cheese — lowest P of all cheeses, soft, sweet
~~Kalamata olives~~	~~SKIP~~	Andrew: olives only on pizza

Greek Dressing:

Ingredient	Amount
Extra virgin olive oil	3 tbsp
Red wine vinegar	1.5 tbsp
Lemon juice	1 tbsp
Garlic	1 clove, minced fine
Dried oregano	1 tsp
Dijon mustard	1/2 tsp
Honey	1/2 tsp
Black pepper	1/4 tsp
Salt	Pinch

Whisk or shake in jar. Per 2 tbsp: ~25mg Na, ~5mg P.

MOM'S RADIATORE WHITE WINE VINEGAR PASTA SALAD (Clone)

Radiatore — "radiator-shaped" pasta, invented in Italy between the World Wars. The ruffled edges hold vinaigrette better than any other shape.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Radiatore pasta (or rotini/fusilli if radiatore unavailable)	8 oz dry	Cook al dente, rinse in cold water to stop cooking
White wine vinegar	3 tbsp	The backbone — tangy, bright
Extra virgin olive oil	1/4 cup	
Sugar	1 tsp	Balances the vinegar bite — this is what makes it mom's version
Garlic powder	1/2 tsp	
Dried oregano	1/2 tsp	
Dried basil	1/4 tsp	
Black pepper	1/4 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	Minimal
Cucumber	1/2, diced	Low K crunch
Bell pepper (any color)	1/2, diced	Color + crunch
Red onion	2 tbsp, finely diced	Small amount for bite
Cherry tomatoes	6-8, halved	Controlled K
Fresh parsley	2 tbsp, chopped	
Sharp cheddar shavings	1 tbsp	Andrew prefers — less salty than parmesan

Method: 1. Cook radiatore al dente per package. Drain. Rinse with cold water. Drain well. 2. Whisk dressing: olive oil + white wine vinegar + sugar + garlic powder + oregano + basil + salt + pepper 3. Toss cooled pasta with dressing 4. Add cucumber, bell pepper, red onion, tomatoes, parsley 5. Toss gently. Refrigerate minimum 1 hour (overnight is best — the pasta absorbs the vinegar dressing) 6. Top with sharp cheddar shavings before serving. Taste — adjust vinegar/salt

Per serving (6 servings): ~65mg Na, ~80mg P, ~180mg K

The mom trick: The sugar in the dressing is what separates this from generic Italian pasta salad. It cuts the vinegar's sharpness and makes it addictive. Mom knew.

Variations: - **Add protein:** Diced grilled chicken turns this into a full meal - **Add pepperoncini:** 4-5 sliced, for that Olive Garden energy - **GF version:** Use GF radiatore or fusilli (Andrew has GF pasta in pantry)

CITRUS TYPHOON HOT SAUCE (Andrew's New Custom)

"Every citrus fruit on earth in one bottle. Then it burns."

Ingredient	Amount	Why This Citrus
Habanero peppers	6, stems removed	~300,000 SHU — the heat engine
Fresh orange juice	2 tbsp	Sweet citrus base
Fresh lemon juice	2 tbsp	Sharp acid
Fresh lime juice	2 tbsp	Bright, cutting
Orange zest	1 tsp	Oils = intense aroma
Lemon zest	1 tsp	
Lime zest	1 tsp	
Yuzu juice	1 tbsp (bottled, from H Mart/Amazon)	Japanese citrus — floral, complex, unlike anything else
Grapefruit juice	1 tbsp	Bitter-sweet depth
Calamansi juice	1 tbsp (if available — Filipino citrus)	Tart, fragrant, between lemon and tangerine
Starfruit	1/4 fruit, diced	Mild, waxy, adds body + tropical
Kumquat	2, whole (eat skin and all), chopped	Sweet skin + sour flesh = complexity

Ingredient	Amount	Why This Citrus
White vinegar	1/4 cup	Preservation + acid balance
Garlic	3 cloves	
Sugar	1 tbsp	Balances all that acid
Salt	1/4 tsp	
Turmeric	1/4 tsp	Golden color boost

Method: 1. Blend ALL ingredients except starfruit chunks 2. Simmer 15 min 3. Add diced starfruit in the last 2 min (keeps some texture) 4. Bottle hot

The experience: This sauce hits you with 8+ different citrus notes at different speeds — orange arrives first (sweet), then lemon (sharp), then lime (bright), then yuzu (floral), then grapefruit (bitter), then the habanero comes through everything like a tsunami. The starfruit chunks give you something to bite into. The golden color is stunning.

Citrus Typhoon Variations: - **Citrus Typhoon MILD:** Sub bell pepper for habanero — all the citrus, zero heat - **Citrus Typhoon BLOOD:** Use blood orange instead of regular orange — deep red-orange color - **Citrus Typhoon YUZU BOMB:** Double the yuzu, add wasabi — Japanese citrus storm

Vorath Pepper Codex Labels: Sweet Heat Taco Sauce + Chili Paste

Use this for the bottle and the strained pulp jar from the Fresno-serrano-mirin blend. The sauce is the pourable signal; the paste is the concentrated engine.

Front Label: Vorath Sunset Taco Sauce

VORATH SUNSET TACO SAUCE
Sweet Heat Pepper Elixir

Fresno + Serrano + Mirin
Garlic / Cilantro / Avocado Oil
Mixed Vinegar Prism

Batch: VOR-000999-FR-SR-MR-CIL
Heat: 6/10 bright, sweet, fast
Use: tacos, eggs, rice bowls, wings, marinades

Back Label Copy

Flavor: sweet first, green-herbal second, vinegar sparkle third, serrano finish. Mirin rounds the pepper heat without turning it into candy. Fresno brings red fruit; serrano brings the clean green sting; cilantro keeps it alive.

Ingredients line: blended Fresno peppers, serrano peppers, garlic, mirin, avocado oil, cilantro, mixed vinegars, herbs, spices.

Art DNA / Vorath encoding: RED.FRESNO + GREEN.SERRANO + GOLD.MIRIN + WHITE.GARLIC + LEAF.CILANTRO + OIL.AVOCADO + ACID.PRISM + 000999.RETURN.

Storage: This is a refrigerator sauce unless pH is tested at 4.0 or lower and processed with a validated canning method. Because garlic and oil are present, do not store at room temperature. Refrigerate and use within 2 weeks, or freeze in cubes.

Companion Jar: Vorath Redshift Chili Paste

VORATH REDSHIFT CHILI PASTE
Strained Pepper Pulp Concentrate

Fresno / Serrano / Garlic / Cilantro
Mirin Sweet Heat + Vinegar Spark

Batch: VOR-PASTE-000999-RS
Heat: 7/10 concentrated
Use: taco meat, mayo, ramen, beans, wing glaze, rice

Paste method: After straining the sauce, scrape the pepper pulp into a clean jar. Stir in 1-2 tsp vinegar if it needs brightness, and 1 tsp avocado oil if it needs gloss. For a thicker chile crisp direction, simmer the pulp gently in 1-2 tbsp avocado oil for 3-5 minutes, then cool and refrigerate.

Fast uses: 1 tsp into sour cream for taco crema; 1 tsp into mayo for sandwich sauce; 1 tbsp into 1 lb taco meat; 1 tsp into ramen broth; 1 tbsp with honey for wing glaze.

Alternate Bottle Names

- **Mirin Comet Taco Sauce** - sweeter, brighter, friendlier label.
- **Fresno Prism Fire** - more hot-sauce shelf energy.
- **Serrano Sun Engine** - green heat emphasis.
- **Vorath 999 Pepper Nectar** - strongest lore-coded label.

NON-MEDICATED SPECIAL EFFECTS CONFECTIONERY - SAFETY REWRITE

Status: The prior fruit roll-up and sour gummy blocks in this location contained active-ingredient dosing concepts. They are held out of the public print lane.

Use instead: print [static/guides/ckd_special_effects_confectionery.html](#) or [CKD_Special_Effects_Confectionery_PRINT.pdf](#). That guide contains non-medicated hard candy, apple-cranberry gummies, pectin sour squares, rock candy wands, marshmallow slabs, UV tonic micro-gems, fruit leather windows, and printable labels.

Old Lane	Replacement	Publication Rule
Medicated fruit roll-ups	Aurora Fruit Leather Windows	No THC, CBD, RSO, tincture, or dosing math.
CBD sour gummies	Cloud 9 Apple-Cranberry Gummies or Pectin Sour Signal Squares	Food-only color, sour dust, edible glitter, and portion labels.
Look-alike candy	Clearly labeled house shapes and batch labels	Do not imitate commercial kid candy for any controlled-product context.

RINGSIDE STEAKHOUSE FRESH HORSERADISH PREP (Portland Clone)

"Burnside & NW 12th. They bring it with the prime rib. Now you bring it at home."

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Fresh horseradish root	6 oz, peeled	Find at Fred Meyer produce or H Mart
White vinegar	2 tbsp	Stops the heat reaction — add LATER for more burn, SOONER for milder
Sugar	1 tsp	
Salt	1/4 tsp	

Method: 1. Peel horseradish root. Cut into 1" chunks. 2. Pulse in food processor until finely grated (open the lid AWAY from your face — the fumes are real) 3. **THE TIMING TRICK:** The longer you wait to add vinegar, the HOTTER it gets. For Ringside-level heat, wait 3 minutes after grinding. For milder, add immediately. 4. Add vinegar + sugar + salt. Pulse to combine. 5. Transfer to a small glass jar. Refrigerate. 6. Serve a small spoonful alongside prime rib, steak, or roast beef.

Shelf life: 3-4 weeks refrigerated. Heat fades over time — make fresh batches.

Creamy Horseradish Sauce (Ringside-style):

Ingredient	Amount
Prepared horseradish (above)	2 tbsp
Sour cream	1/4 cup
Dijon mustard	1/2 tsp
Lemon juice	1/2 tsp
Black pepper	Pinch

Mix. Chill 30 minutes. Serve with prime rib. The sour cream tames the burn into a slow, warm glow.

Per tbsp: ~15mg Na | ~8mg P | ~20mg K — horseradish is basically free. All flavor, no renal cost.

CKD Considerations

RENAL CHECK — Sauces & Dips
K (Potassium): LOW (cream cheese base, no-salt-added tomato, controlled portions)
P (Phosphorus): LOW (cream cheese over processed cheese, mayo base)

for dressings)
Na (Sodium): LOW (homemade = 70-90% less sodium than store-bought)

"A sauce is the crowning glory of a well-prepared dish." — Escoffier

INTERNATIONAL SAUCES & CONDIMENTS

Cooling Raita

Served with every Indian meal since the Vedic period (~1500 BC). The word comes from Sanskrit "rajika" — mustard. The cooling effect offsets spicy food.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Plain yogurt	1 cup	Moderate P — portion-controlled
Cucumber, grated + squeezed dry	1/2 cup	Low K
Cumin, toasted and ground	1/2 tsp	Toast whole seeds in dry pan first
Fresh mint, chopped	1 tbsp	
Fresh cilantro, chopped	1 tbsp	
Salt	1/8 tsp	
Cayenne	Pinch	

Method: Mix everything. Chill 30 min. Serve alongside biryani, kebabs, or any spicy dish. The yogurt cools. The cumin warms. The cucumber crunches.

Per 1/4 cup: ~30mg Na | ~40mg P | ~80mg K

Fresh Mint Chutney

The word "chutney" comes from Hindi "chatni" — to lick. First documented in the 1600s by European traders visiting Mughal courts.

Ingredient	Amount
Fresh mint leaves	1 cup packed
Fresh cilantro	1/2 cup packed
Green chili (serrano)	1, seeded
Onion	2 tbsp
Lime juice	2 tbsp
Sugar	1 tsp
Cumin	1/4 tsp
Water	2-3 tbsp
Salt	1/8 tsp

Method: Blend everything until smooth paste. Adjust water for consistency. Serve with samosas, kebabs, rice, naan.

Per 2 tbsp: ~15mg Na | ~5mg P | ~20mg K

Sweet-Sour Tamarind Chutney

Tamarind originated in tropical Africa, traveled to India via Arab traders ~400 BC, and became essential to Indian cuisine. The name comes from Arabic "tamar hindi" — Indian date.

Ingredient	Amount
Tamarind paste	2 tbsp
Water	1/2 cup
Brown sugar	3 tbsp
Cumin, ground	1/2 tsp
Ginger powder	1/4 tsp
Cayenne	1/4 tsp
Salt	1/8 tsp

Method: Combine all in saucepan. Simmer 10 min, stirring, until thick and glossy. Strain. Serve with samosas, chaat, or as a glaze for grilled meats. Sweet-sour-spicy in every drop.

Per 2 tbsp: ~20mg Na | ~5mg P | ~30mg K

Cucumber Tzatziki

Greek in origin, Turkish in DNA (cacik). First appeared in Ottoman cookbooks ~1500s. The key: draining the cucumber of ALL water or it becomes soup.

Ingredient	Amount	CKD Notes
Plain yogurt	1 cup	
Cucumber	1/2, grated + squeezed bone-dry	Squeeze in towel — get every drop out
Garlic	2 cloves, minced fine	
Lemon juice	1 tbsp	
Olive oil	1 tbsp	Drizzle on top
Fresh dill	1 tbsp, chopped	
Salt	1/8 tsp	

Method: Grate cucumber, squeeze in clean towel until no more water comes out (this step is 90% of a good tzatziki). Mix with yogurt + garlic + lemon + dill + salt. Drizzle olive oil on top. Chill 1 hour.

Per 1/4 cup: ~35mg Na | ~45mg P | ~85mg K

CHAPTER 9

Hot Sauces

"Measure your life in Scoville units."

The Cosmic Horror Collection

10 Exotic Hot Sauces for the Brave & Curious

"These sauces were not meant for mortal tongues."

Recent Tropical Hot Sauce Batch

Tropical Serrano-Holland Fruit Sauce

Garlic, onion, apple cider vinegar, serrano, Holland pepper, jalapeno, sweet pepper, strawberry, red kiwi, pineapple, and mango. A bright recent batch with savory allium underneath tropical fruit and clean pepper heat.

Ingredient	Suggested Repeat Batch Amount
Garlic	4 to 6 cloves
Onion	1/2 medium
Apple cider vinegar	1/2 to 3/4 cup, plus more to thin
Serrano pepper	4 to 6
Holland pepper	1 large red or yellow pepper

Ingredient	Suggested Repeat Batch Amount
Jalapeno	2 to 3
Sweet pepper	1 medium
Strawberry	1 cup, hulled
Red kiwi	2, peeled
Pineapple	1 cup, chopped
Mango	1 cup, chopped

Wash produce well. Stem the peppers, peel the onion and garlic, and trim the fruit. Rough-chop everything, then blend with apple cider vinegar until pourable. Simmer 8 to 10 minutes, stirring often, until the raw onion and garlic edge softens and the sauce tightens slightly. Strain for a smoother bottle sauce if desired. Cool, bottle, label, and refrigerate.

Storage lane: refrigerated or frozen fresh sauce unless a tested process validates this exact recipe. Do not treat this as shelf-stable or canning-safe by default. Record exact gram weights and pH on the next repeat batch.

VORATH Wild Sauce Lab

12 Experimental Hot Sauce and Taco Sauce Formulas

Test-kitchen expansion for the VORATH / Emoji Soup sauce system. These formulas are intentionally vivid, dense, and product-minded, but they remain internal lab recipes until pH, thermal process, allergen, label, and process-authority reviews are complete.

Lab safety lane: Wear gloves and ventilate when cutting or blending hot peppers. For fermented versions, use non-iodized salt and keep solids below brine or mash liquid. For lab bottles, target finished pH 4.0 or below with a calibrated meter. Refrigerate all test bottles unless a validated shelf-stable process is documented.

Reference packet: The VORATH Wild Sauce Lab packet and experiment matrix remain in private editorial review and are not part of this public edition.

Code	Formula	Style	Heat	Use
VOR-X101	Prickly Pear Morita Star Taco Sauce	Cooked acidified taco sauce	Medium-hot	fish tacos, breakfast burritos, grilled shrimp, roasted squash
VOR-X102	Black Comet Coffee-Cacao Mole Drip	Cooked dark taco glaze	Medium	barbacoa tacos, black beans, roasted mushrooms, chili, charred onions
VOR-X103	Honeydew Green Signal Ferment	2.5 percent mash ferment	Medium-hot	al pastor tacos, ceviche, grilled chicken, cucumber salad, grain bowls
VOR-X104	Hibiscus Blood Moon Arbol Taco Sauce	Cooked acidified floral red sauce	Hot	crispy potato tacos, carnitas, roasted carrots, queso fundido
VOR-X105	Pineapple Hoja Santa Habanero Reactor	Fermented then cooked tropical sauce	Very hot	pork tacos, fried chicken, grilled pineapple, fish, rice bowls
VOR-X106	Blueberry Blacklime Habanero Phantom	Fermented berry sauce	Very hot	duck tacos, lamb, mushroom tacos, goat cheese, roasted sweet potato
VOR-X107	Tamarind Sesame Serrano Static	Cooked acidified global taco sauce	Hot	birria tacos, wings, grilled tofu, noodles, charred cabbage
VOR-X108	Roasted Corn Cascabel Gold	Cooked taco table sauce	Mild-medium	street corn tacos, chicken, grilled zucchini, breakfast eggs, quesadillas
VOR-X109	Mango Aji Amarillo Solar Flare	Cooked fruit hot sauce	Hot	fish tacos, chicken, fries, coconut rice, fried plantains
VOR-X110	Beet Pomegranate Pasilla Night Market	Cooked acidified dark red sauce	Medium	lamb tacos, roasted cauliflower, falafel tacos, duck, charred eggplant
VOR-X111	Yuzu-Lime Serrano Papalo Switchblade	Fresh-cooked green taco sauce	Medium-hot	fish tacos, cucumber salad, grilled steak, breakfast tacos
VOR-X112	Maple Miso Morita Redline	Cooked umami hot sauce	Medium-hot	short rib tacos, tofu, roasted carrots, burgers, black bean bowls

VOR-X101 - Prickly Pear Morita Star Taco Sauce

Build a wild pink taco sauce with fruit body, smoky morita, and clean arbol heat.

Style: Cooked acidified taco sauce **Heat:** Medium-hot **Target yield:** about 520 g / 18 oz

Visual: electric magenta-red, glossy, slightly thick

Best uses: fish tacos, breakfast burritos, grilled shrimp, roasted squash

Ingredient	Test Batch Grams	Purpose
prickly pear pulp, strained	180 g	fruit body and color
tomato puree	160 g	classic taco-sauce base
roasted tomatillo	80 g	green acidity
apple cider vinegar, 5 percent	90 g	acid
lime juice	25 g	bright finish
dried morita chile, toasted and soaked	10 g	smoky fruit
dried chile de arbol, toasted	3 g	direct heat
red onion, roasted	35 g	savory sweetness

Ingredient	Test Batch Grams	Purpose
garlic, roasted	12 g	depth
cilantro stems	8 g	green snap
ground cumin	2 g	taco backbone
Mexican oregano	1 g	dry herb lift
fine salt	6 g	seasoning

Method:

1. Toast dried chiles until fragrant, then soak in hot water for 15 minutes and drain.
2. Blend everything until fully smooth, then simmer 8 to 10 minutes to thicken.
3. Cool a spoonful and check pH. Target 4.0 or below for lab bottling.
4. Adjust with lime, vinegar, salt, or a small pinch of sugar only after the first pH check.

Control note: Keep refrigerated unless a calibrated meter confirms finished pH and a proper hot-fill/canning process is used.

VOR-X102 - Black Comet Coffee-Cacao Mole Drip

Make a taco sauce that eats like mole, barbecue, espresso, and cosmic diner gravy.

Style: Cooked dark taco glaze **Heat:** Medium **Target yield:** about 560 g / 20 oz

Visual: near-black mahogany with a satin sheen

Best uses: barbacoa tacos, black beans, roasted mushrooms, chili, charred onions

Ingredient	Test Batch Grams	Purpose
tomato puree	190 g	base
strong cold brew coffee	90 g	bitter roast
apple cider vinegar, 5 percent	95 g	acid
tamarind concentrate	45 g	sour fruit
golden raisins	40 g	round sweetness
dried ancho chile, toasted and soaked	20 g	raisin/chocolate
dried pasilla chile, toasted and soaked	15 g	dark fruit
dried morita chile, toasted and soaked	8 g	smoke
onion, roasted	60 g	body
garlic, roasted	16 g	savory base
cacao nibs, steeped and strained	8 g	bitter chocolate
honey	25 g	glaze
ground cumin	2 g	taco backbone
cinnamon	0.6 g	warm top note
fine salt	7 g	seasoning

Method:

1. Steep cacao nibs in hot coffee for 10 minutes, then strain.
2. Blend coffee, chiles, tomato, tamarind, raisins, aromatics, and spices until smooth.
3. Simmer 12 to 15 minutes, stirring often, until it coats a spoon.
4. Check pH after cooling a sample. Add vinegar in 10 g increments if above target.

Control note: Dark sweet sauces hide acidity. Do not judge safety by taste; measure pH.

VOR-X103 - Honeydew Green Signal Ferment

Turn cooling melon into a fermented green taco sauce with serrano bite and herbal lift.

Style: 2.5 percent mash ferment **Heat:** Medium-hot **Target yield:** about 500 g / 17 oz after blending

Visual: deep green, bright but slightly opaque

Best uses: al pastor tacos, ceviche, grilled chicken, cucumber salad, grain bowls

Ingredient	Test Batch Grams	Purpose
honeydew melon, ripe	260 g	cool sweetness
poblano, chopped	130 g	green body

Ingredient	Test Batch Grams	Purpose
jalapeno, chopped	90 g	grassy heat
serrano, chopped	45 g	sharp heat
green habanero, optional	10 g	upper heat
white onion	55 g	ferment support
garlic	14 g	savory
cilantro stems	12 g	green aroma
non-iodized salt	15 g	2.5 percent of 606 g mash
white vinegar, post-ferment	75 g	acid finish
lime juice, post-ferment	25 g	brightness

Method:

1. Pulse melon, peppers, onion, garlic, cilantro stems, and salt into a coarse mash.
2. Pack under a weight with minimal headspace. Ferment 7 to 14 days at cool room temperature.
3. When sour and active fermentation slows, blend with vinegar and lime juice.
4. Check pH. Target 4.0 or below; keep refrigerated during lab testing.

Control note: Keep solids below brine. Discard if mold appears or aroma turns rotten instead of sour.

VOR-X104 - Hibiscus Blood Moon Arbol Taco Sauce

Use hibiscus as sour floral acid against guajillo body and arbol fire.

Style: Cooked acidified floral red sauce **Heat:** Hot **Target yield:** about 540 g / 19 oz

Visual: dark ruby, translucent edges

Best uses: crispy potato tacos, carnitas, roasted carrots, queso fundido

Ingredient	Test Batch Grams	Purpose
strong hibiscus tea, unsweetened	130 g	floral tartness
tomato puree	170 g	red base
white vinegar, 5 percent	90 g	acid
orange juice	50 g	citrus sweetness
dried guajillo chile, toasted and soaked	25 g	berry body
dried chile de arbol, toasted	5 g	heat
red onion, roasted	45 g	savory
garlic	12 g	depth
agave	28 g	round sweetness
ground cumin	2 g	taco backbone
Mexican oregano	1.2 g	herb
black pepper	0.8 g	bite
fine salt	6 g	seasoning

Method:

1. Make a strong hibiscus tea and cool it before blending.
2. Blend all ingredients until smooth, then simmer 10 minutes.
3. Taste for bitter edges. Balance with tiny additions of agave or orange juice.
4. Check pH after cooling a sample; add vinegar if needed.

Control note: Hibiscus can stain. Use nonreactive cookware and glass storage.

VOR-X105 - Pineapple Hoja Santa Habanero Reactor

Pair habanero fruit heat with pineapple acid and hoja santa's root-beer herb signal.

Style: Fermented then cooked tropical sauce **Heat:** Very hot **Target yield:** about 520 g / 18 oz

Visual: orange-gold with green herbal shadow

Best uses: pork tacos, fried chicken, grilled pineapple, fish, rice bowls

Ingredient	Test Batch Grams	Purpose
pineapple, diced	240 g	sugar and acid
orange bell pepper	210 g	body
habanero, stemmed	60 g	fruit heat
white onion	65 g	ferment support
garlic	18 g	savory
non-iodized salt	15 g	about 2.5 percent mash salt
apple cider vinegar, post-ferment	90 g	acid
honey, post-ferment	22 g	roundness
fresh hoja santa, infused then removed	1 g	herb experiment
lime juice, post-ferment	20 g	finish

Method:

1. Ferment pineapple, pepper, habanero, onion, garlic, and salt as a mash for 5 to 10 days.
2. Blend with vinegar, honey, and lime juice.
3. Warm gently with one small hoja santa leaf for 3 minutes, then remove and blend again.
4. Simmer 5 minutes to stop fermentation and set sweetness. Check pH.

Control note: Use a light hand with hoja santa. If unavailable, omit; do not substitute random avocado leaves.

VOR-X106 - Blueberry Blacklime Habanero Phantom

Build a fruit-forward sauce that turns habanero into dark berry, smoke, and sour citrus.

Style: Fermented berry sauce **Heat:** Very hot **Target yield:** about 500 g / 17 oz

Visual: purple-black, smooth, high gloss

Best uses: duck tacos, lamb, mushroom tacos, goat cheese, roasted sweet potato

Ingredient	Test Batch Grams	Purpose
blueberries	220 g	fruit and pectin
blackberries	150 g	color and tannin
habanero	55 g	heat
red Fresno pepper	100 g	red pepper body
red onion	45 g	ferment support